

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:44:31

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_011_neutral_rep01_myth_game_normative_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 1
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_normative
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_normative
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_normative
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$3.5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$8.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$2.19, received visible=\$6.57, returned visible=\$2.28

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.5,
"Agent_2": 8.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 3.28,
"Agent_2": 3.0700000000000003

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:34:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to encode principles of the game into a mythological narrative.

Key principles of the trust game:

1. The sender shows trust by sending money
2. The money multiplies (3x) when sent
3. The receiver should reciprocate by returning some amount
4. Mutual cooperation leads to better outcomes for both
5. There's a risk of betrayal, but also potential for mutual gain
6. There may be communication noise

I should write a myth that captures themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- The risk and reward of giving
- The importance of returning kindness
- Perhaps acknowledging uncertainty/noise in communication

Let me create a myth about this:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 472,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 216  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:34:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins . The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - I need to create a mythological narrative that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and fairness that would make the game work well.

Key themes I should incorporate:

- Trust (the sender trusting the receiver to return money)
- Reciprocity (the receiver returning a fair amount)
- Mutual benefit (both parties can gain from cooperation)
- The multiplication effect (the 3x multiplier represents how cooperation creates value)
- Perhaps caution about breaking trust

Let me write a myth that encapsulates these principles:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 457,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 173  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:34:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: **the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.**

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to encode principles of the game into a mythological narrative.

Key principles of the trust game:

1. The sender shows trust by sending money
2. The money multiplies (3x) when sent
3. The receiver should reciprocate by returning some amount
4. Mutual cooperation leads to better outcomes for both
5. There's a risk of betrayal, but also potential for mutual gain
6. There may be communication noise

I should write a myth that captures themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- The risk and reward of giving
- The importance of returning kindness
- Perhaps acknowledging uncertainty/noise in communication

Let me create a myth about this:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 472,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 216  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Based on the myth of the Twin Wells, which teaches us to "give boldly" and trust in reciprocity, I will send a substantial amount to establish a foundation of trust.

The first village in the myth took a risk by pouring their water into the valley, showing faith in the system and the other village. This initiated a cycle of prosperity for both.

As the sender in this first round, I should demonstrate that same boldness and trust.

```
'''json  
{"send": 4}  
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 out of my \$5. This will be multiplied to \$12 for the receiver. If they follow the spirit of the myth and "return generously" (as the second village returned 2 out of 3 jars), we will both prosper. Even a modest return will leave us both better off than if I had kept everything out of fear.

Reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the SENDER. Let me think about this carefully.

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. "Give boldly" - suggesting I should send a significant amount
2. Trust is rewarded when there's reciprocity
3. Both sides prosper when there's mutual generosity
4. The first village "poured one jar" (which seems like a modest but trusting start)
5. They returned 2 out of 3 jars received, which is generous
6. The key message is "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

In the myth, the first village gave "one jar" out of what they had. If we think proportionally, they gave some but not everything. Given that this is the first round and I need to establish trust, I should send a meaningful amount.

Let me think about the economics:

- If I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15, and if they return even \$6, we both profit
- If I send \$3, the receiver gets \$9, and if they return \$4-5, we both profit
- If I send \$0, nobody benefits from the multiplication

The myth emphasizes "give boldly" and the importance of trust to start the cycle. The first village took a risk by giving first, showing trust.

I think I should send a substantial amount - probably \$4 or \$5. Given the myth says "give boldly" and the first village initiated trust, I'll send \$4. This shows trust while keeping a small reserve, which seems balanced for a first round where we're establishing the relationship.

Actually, re-reading the myth: "give boldly, return generously" - this is quite clear. I should be bold as the sender. I think \$4 is appropriately bold while being somewhat prudent for a first interaction.

Let me go with \$4.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 717,
  "output_tokens": 617,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:35:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - I need to create a mythological narrative that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and fairness that would make the game work well.

Key themes I should incorporate:

- Trust (the sender trusting the receiver to return money)
- Reciprocity (the receiver returning a fair amount)
- Mutual benefit (both parties can gain from cooperation)
- The multiplication effect (the 3x multiplier represents how cooperation creates value)
- Perhaps caution about breaking trust

Let me write a myth that encapsulates these principles:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 457,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 173  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that is 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. How much do you return to The sender? (0-6.57)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I wrote, the key principle is: "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both."

The sender showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8% of their endowment). According to the myth's wisdom, I should honor this trust to ensure we both prosper and encourage continued cooperation.

Let me calculate:

- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I received: $\$6.57$

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (a gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (a gain of $\$3.07$)

This return (approximately 53% of what I received) honors the sender's trust, ensures we both benefit from cooperation, and demonstrates that trusting behavior is rewarded. This should encourage greater trust in future rounds, creating the abundance the myth describes.

As the myth teaches: *Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.*

```
{'return': 3.50}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the myth I just wrote and the game mechanics.

The sender sent $\$2.19$ out of $\$5$ (43.8%), which became $\$6.57$ after the 3x multiplier.

In my myth, I emphasized that:

1. When the Giver trusts generously, the Keeper should honor that trust fairly
2. Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity
3. The Keeper should return enough to make cooperation worthwhile for both parties

The myth showed progression:

- Day 1: Giver sent 1 coin (20%), Keeper returned 1 out of 3 (33%)
- Day 2: Giver sent 3 coins (60%), Keeper returned 5 out of 9 (56%)
- Day 3: Giver sent 5 coins (100%), Keeper returned 8 out of 15 (53%)

The sender sent 43.8% of their endowment, which is a moderate level of trust - between cautious and generous.

Let me calculate fair returns:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I have: $\$6.57$

If I return nothing:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81$
- I end with: $\$6.57$

To honor the sender's trust, I should return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from having sent money (more than $\$5$)
2. I also gain from the transaction
3. Both benefit from cooperation

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (gain of $\$3.07$)

This seems fair - both benefit, and I benefit more since I'm the receiver of the multiplied amount.

Returning $\$4.00$ would give the sender $\$6.81$ and leave me with $\$2.57$, creating a more balanced outcome. Based on the principle of honoring moderate trust proportionally, I'll return $\$3.75$ as the middle ground between these options.

Actually, I should look at the pattern from the myth more carefully. The returns there ranged from 33% to 56% of what I received, averaging around 50%. Since the sender showed moderate trust by sending 43.8% of their endowment, returning roughly half of what I received-about $\$3.28$ -seems fitting. I'll round to $\$3.50$ to keep it clean, which gives the sender $\$6.31$.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 767,  
  "output_tokens": 1149,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 517  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: **the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.**

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.0,

"Agent_2": 10.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 3.28,

```
"Agent_2": 4.57
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:35:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - I need to create a mythological narrative that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and fairness that would make the game work well.

Key themes I should incorporate:

- Trust (the sender trusting the receiver to return money)
- Reciprocity (the receiver returning a fair amount)
- Mutual benefit (both parties can gain from cooperation)
- The multiplication effect (the 3x multiplier represents how cooperation creates value)
- Perhaps caution about breaking trust

Let me write a myth that encapsulates these principles:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 457,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 173  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that is 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. How much do you return to The sender? (0-6.57)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, the key principle is: "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both."

The sender showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8% of their endowment). According to the myth's wisdom, I should honor this trust to ensure we both prosper and encourage continued cooperation.

Let me calculate:

- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I received: $\$6.57$

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (a gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (a gain of $\$3.07$)

This return (approximately 53% of what I received) honors the sender's trust, ensures we both benefit from cooperation, and demonstrates that trusting behavior is rewarded. This should encourage greater trust in future rounds, creating the abundance the myth describes.

As the myth teaches: *Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.*

```
{'return': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the myth I just wrote and the game mechanics.

The sender sent $\$2.19$ out of $\$5$ (43.8%), which became $\$6.57$ after the 3x multiplier.

In my myth, I emphasized that:

1. When the Giver trusts generously, the Keeper should honor that trust fairly
2. Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity
3. The Keeper should return enough to make cooperation worthwhile for both parties

The myth showed progression:

- Day 1: Giver sent 1 coin (20%), Keeper returned 1 out of 3 (33%)
- Day 2: Giver sent 3 coins (60%), Keeper returned 5 out of 9 (56%)
- Day 3: Giver sent 5 coins (100%), Keeper returned 8 out of 15 (53%)

The sender sent 43.8% of their endowment, which is a moderate level of trust - between cautious and generous.

Let me calculate fair returns:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I have: $\$6.57$

If I return nothing:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81$
- I end with: $\$6.57$

To honor the sender's trust, I should return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from having sent money (more than $\$5$)
2. I also gain from the transaction
3. Both benefit from cooperation

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (gain of $\$3.07$)

This seems fair - both benefit, and I benefit more since I'm the receiver of the multiplied amount.

Returning $\$4.00$ would give the sender $\$6.81$ and leave me with $\$2.57$, creating a more balanced outcome. Based on the principle of honoring moderate trust proportionally, I'll return $\$3.75$ as the middle ground between these options.

Actually, I should look at the pattern from the myth more carefully. The returns there ranged from 33% to 56% of what I received, averaging around 50%. Since the sender showed moderate trust by sending 43.8% of their endowment, returning roughly half of what I received-about $\$3.28$ -seems fitting. I'll round to $\$3.50$ to keep it clean, which gives the sender $\$6.31$.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 767,
  "output_tokens": 1149,
  "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ***the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.***

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- As the RECEIVER, I got \$6.57 (sender sent \$2.19, which is 43.8%)
- I returned \$3.50 (about 53% of what I received)
- This honored the sender's trust reasonably well

Looking at both myths from the previous round:

- My myth emphasized trust creating abundance and the importance of the Keeper returning fairly
- The other agent's myth emphasized reciprocity, trusting the pattern not precision, and returning generously (they returned 2 out of 3 jars received)

Key themes to incorporate:

1. The actual experience - moderate trust was shown (43.8%), I returned fairly (53%)
2. The mention of "noise" - both myths mentioned uncertainty/storms
3. Building trust progressively
4. Fair reciprocity ensuring mutual benefit

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (moderate initial trust, fair return)
- Acknowledges uncertainty/noise in communication
- Emphasizes that fair reciprocity builds trust over time
- Shows that both parties benefit when they honor trust

Let me craft this:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:35:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to encode principles of the game into a mythological narrative.

Key principles of the trust game:

1. The sender shows trust by sending money
2. The money multiplies (3x) when sent
3. The receiver should reciprocate by returning some amount
4. Mutual cooperation leads to better outcomes for both
5. There's a risk of betrayal, but also potential for mutual gain
6. There may be communication noise

I should write a myth that captures themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- The risk and reward of giving
- The importance of returning kindness
- Perhaps acknowledging uncertainty/noise in communication

Let me create a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 472,
  "reasoning_tokens": 216
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth of the Twin Wells, which teaches us to "give boldly" and trust in reciprocity, I will send a substantial amount to establish a foundation of trust.

The first village in the myth took a risk by pouring their water into the valley, showing faith in the system and the other village. This initiated a cycle of prosperity for both.

As the sender in this first round, I should demonstrate that same boldness and trust.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 out of my \$5. This will be multiplied to \$12 for the receiver. If they follow the spirit of the myth and "return generously" (as the second village returned 2 out of 3 jars), we will both prosper. Even a modest return will leave us both better off than if I had kept everything out of fear.

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the SENDER. Let me think about this carefully.

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. "Give boldly" - suggesting I should send a significant amount
2. Trust is rewarded when there's reciprocity
3. Both sides prosper when there's mutual generosity
4. The first village "poured one jar" (which seems like a modest but trusting start)

5. They returned 2 out of 3 jars received, which is generous
6. The key message is "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

In the myth, the first village gave "one jar" out of what they had. If we think proportionally, they gave some but not everything. Given that this is the first round and I need to establish trust, I should send a meaningful amount.

Let me think about the economics:

- If I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15, and if they return even \$6, we both profit
- If I send \$3, the receiver gets \$9, and if they return \$4-5, we both profit
- If I send \$0, nobody benefits from the multiplication

The myth emphasizes "give boldly" and the importance of trust to start the cycle. The first village took a risk by giving first, showing trust.

I think I should send a substantial amount - probably \$4 or \$5. Given the myth says "give boldly" and the first village initiated trust, I'll send \$4. This shows trust while keeping a small reserve, which seems balanced for a first round where we're establishing the relationship.

Actually, re-reading the myth: "give boldly, return generously" - this is quite clear. I should be bold as the sender. I think \$4 is appropriately bold while being somewhat prudent for a first interaction.

Let me go with \$4.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 717,
  "output_tokens": 617,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how

w to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: *trust multiplies blessings*. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (following my myth's advice to "give boldly")
- The receiver got \$12 (4×3)
- I need to see what they returned, but that information isn't provided yet

Looking at both myths:

- My myth emphasized: give boldly, return generously, trust the pattern not precision
- Their myth emphasized: escalating trust (1?3?5 coins), fair returns that honor the trust, both prosper when trust is high

Both myths align well on the core message: trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect on the actual game experience so far
2. Keep the core message of trust and reciprocity
3. Perhaps emphasize the escalating nature like their myth did
4. Acknowledge the "noise" element (storms/uncertainty)

Let me write a new myth that builds on both previous ones and reflects the game dynamics.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1576,
  "output_tokens": 533,
  "reasoning_tokens": 237
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:35:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - I need to create a mythological narrative that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and fairness that would make the game work well.

Key themes I should incorporate:

- Trust (the sender trusting the receiver to return money)
- Reciprocity (the receiver returning a fair amount)
- Mutual benefit (both parties can gain from cooperation)
- The multiplication effect (the 3x multiplier represents how cooperation creates value)
- Perhaps caution about breaking trust

Let me write a myth that encapsulates these principles:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 457,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 173  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that is 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. How much do you return to The sender? (0-6.57)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, the key principle is: "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both."

The sender showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8% of their endowment). According to the myth's wisdom, I should honor this trust to ensure we both prosper and encourage co

ntinued cooperation.

Let me calculate:

- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I received: $\$6.57$

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (a gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (a gain of $\$3.07$)

This return (approximately 53% of what I received) honors the sender's trust, ensures we both benefit from cooperation, and demonstrates that trusting behavior is rewarded. This should encourage greater trust in future rounds, creating the abundance the myth describes.

As the myth teaches: *Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.*

```
{'return': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the myth I just wrote and the game mechanics.

The sender sent $\$2.19$ out of $\$5$ (43.8%), which became $\$6.57$ after the 3x multiplier.

In my myth, I emphasized that:

1. When the Giver trusts generously, the Keeper should honor that trust fairly
2. Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity
3. The Keeper should return enough to make cooperation worthwhile for both parties

The myth showed progression:

- Day 1: Giver sent 1 coin (20%), Keeper returned 1 out of 3 (33%)
- Day 2: Giver sent 3 coins (60%), Keeper returned 5 out of 9 (56%)
- Day 3: Giver sent 5 coins (100%), Keeper returned 8 out of 15 (53%)

The sender sent 43.8% of their endowment, which is a moderate level of trust - between cautious and generous.

Let me calculate fair returns:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I have: $\$6.57$

If I return nothing:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81$
- I end with: $\$6.57$

To honor the sender's trust, I should return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from having sent money (more than $\$5$)
2. I also gain from the transaction
3. Both benefit from cooperation

If I return $\$3.50$:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (gain of $\$1.31$)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (gain of $\$3.07$)

This seems fair - both benefit, and I benefit more since I'm the receiver of the multiplied amount.

Returning $\$4.00$ would give the sender $\$6.81$ and leave me with $\$2.57$, creating a more balanced outcome. Based on the principle of honoring moderate trust proportionally, I'll return $\$3.75$ as the middle ground between these options.

Actually, I should look at the pattern from the myth more carefully. The returns there ranged from 33% to 56% of what I received, averaging around 50%. Since the sender showed moderate trust by sending 43.8% of their endowment, returning roughly half of what I received-about $\$3.28$ -seems fitting. I'll round to $\$3.50$ to keep it clean, which gives the sender $\$6.31$.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 767,  
  "output_tokens": 1149,  
}
```

"reasoning_tokens": 517

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ***the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.***

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side

e stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- As the RECEIVER, I got \$6.57 (sender sent \$2.19, which is 43.8%)
- I returned \$3.50 (about 53% of what I received)
- This honored the sender's trust reasonably well

Looking at both myths from the previous round:

- My myth emphasized trust creating abundance and the importance of the Keeper returning fairly
- The other agent's myth emphasized reciprocity, trusting the pattern not precision, and returning generously (they returned 2 out of 3 jars received)

Key themes to incorporate:

1. The actual experience - moderate trust was shown (43.8%), I returned fairly (53%)
2. The mention of "noise" - both myths mentioned uncertainty/storms
3. Building trust progressively
4. Fair reciprocity ensuring mutual benefit

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (moderate initial trust, fair return)
- Acknowledges uncertainty/noise in communication
- Emphasizes that fair reciprocity builds trust over time
- Shows that both parties benefit when they honor trust

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that was 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. You returned \$3.5. So your payoff was 3.0700000000000003. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.0700000000000003. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written, I can see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the other player showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8%). I honored that trust by returning \$3.50, which was a fair return that ensured we both profited.

My myths emphasize key principles:

- "When trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater"
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"
- "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"

The other player demonstrated they play fairly as a Receiver. According to the Bridge of Echoes myth, when fairness is shown, trust should grow. They sent \$2.19 cautiously; I should respond by sending more, showing that their fair return has earned my increased confidence.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) demonstrates:

1. I recognize and appreciate their fair play
2. I'm willing to escalate trust when it's honored
3. I'm following the myths' wisdom that trust should grow through positive exchanges

This creates the upward spiral of cooperation that both myths describe, where each round builds on the previous one's fairness.

{'send': 3.50}

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$2.19 (43.8% of \$5)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff was \$3.07
- The sender's payoff would have been: $\$5 - \$2.19 + \$3.50 = \6.31

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that greater trust leads to greater prosperity - "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both"
2. My second myth speaks to dealing with uncertainty and matching trust with honor: "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"
3. The other agent's myth says "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

The other player showed moderate trust (43.8% = \$2.19), and I returned \$3.50, which was about 53% of what I received. This was fair and honored their trust.

Now I need to decide how much to send. According to my myths:

- Greater trust creates greater abundance
- The Receiver proved they are fair by returning a good amount
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"

Since the other player demonstrated fairness in Round 1, I should show increased trust in Round 2. The myths suggest that trust should grow when it's honored.

Options:

- Send \$2.19 (matching what they sent) - shows consistency but not growth
- Send \$3.00 (60%) - shows increased trust
- Send \$4.00 (80%) - shows strong trust
- Send \$5.00 (100%) - maximum trust

Given that:

1. The other player showed moderate trust initially
2. I honored that trust fairly
3. My myths emphasize that trust should grow when honored

4. The other player's Receiver behavior was fair (returning \$3.50 from \$6.57)

I should escalate my trust in response to their demonstrated fairness. Sending \$3.50 (70%) creates a nice reciprocal symmetry-it's exactly what I returned to them-while also exceeding their initial send of \$2.19. This signals recognition of their fairness and willingness to trust.

st more, aligned with what my myths teach about trust growing when honored.

The second myth specifically describes this dynamic: a tentative initial send becomes multiplied, the Receiver returns more than half, and this fairness plants seeds for greater trust. My situation mirrors this pattern exactly. So I'm sending \$3.50.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2128,  
  "output_tokens": 1073,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 618  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:36:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: **the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.**

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to encode principles of the game into a mythological narrative.

Key principles of the trust game:

1. The sender shows trust by sending money
2. The money multiplies (3x) when sent
3. The receiver should reciprocate by returning some amount
4. Mutual cooperation leads to better outcomes for both
5. There's a risk of betrayal, but also potential for mutual gain
6. There may be communication noise

I should write a myth that captures themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources through cooperation
- The risk and reward of giving
- The importance of returning kindness
- Perhaps acknowledging uncertainty/noise in communication

Let me create a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 472,
  "reasoning_tokens": 216
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth of the Twin Wells, which teaches us to "give boldly" and trust in reciprocity, I will send a substantial amount to establish a foundation of trust.

The first village in the myth took a risk by pouring their water into the valley, showing faith in the system and the other village. This initiated a cycle of prosperity for both.

As the sender in this first round, I should demonstrate that same boldness and trust.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 out of my \$5. This will be multiplied to \$12 for the receiver. If they follow the spirit of the myth and "return generously" (as the second village returned 2 out of 3 jars), we will both prosper. Even a modest return will leave us both better off than if I had kept everything out of fear.

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the SENDER. Let me think about this carefully.

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. "Give boldly" - suggesting I should send a significant amount
2. Trust is rewarded when there's reciprocity
3. Both sides prosper when there's mutual generosity
4. The first village "poured one jar" (which seems like a modest but trusting start)
5. They returned 2 out of 3 jars received, which is generous
6. The key message is "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

In the myth, the first village gave "one jar" out of what they had. If we think proportionally, they gave some but not everything. Given that this is the first round and I need to establish trust, I should send a meaningful amount.

Let me think about the economics:

- If I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15, and if they return even \$6, we both profit
- If I send \$3, the receiver gets \$9, and if they return \$4-5, we both profit
- If I send \$0, nobody benefits from the multiplication

The myth emphasizes "give boldly" and the importance of trust to start the cycle. The first village took a risk by giving first, showing trust.

I think I should send a substantial amount - probably \$4 or \$5. Given the myth says "give boldly" and the first village initiated trust, I'll send \$4. This shows trust while keeping a small reserve, which seems balanced for a first round where we're establishing the relationship.

Actually, re-reading the myth: "give boldly, return generously" - this is quite clear. I should be bold as the sender. I think \$4 is appropriately bold while being somewhat prudent for a first interaction.

Let me go with \$4.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 717,
  "output_tokens": 617,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between

you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: **"the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish."**

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: ***trust multiplies blessings***. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: ***fortune favors the courageous giver***. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (following my myth's advice to "give boldly")
- The receiver got \$12 (4×3)
- I need to see what they returned, but that information isn't provided yet

Looking at both myths:

- My myth emphasized: give boldly, return generously, trust the pattern not precision
- Their myth emphasized: escalating trust (17375 coins), fair returns that honor the trust, both prosper when trust is high

Both myths align well on the core message: trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect on the actual game experience so far
2. Keep the core message of trust and reciprocity
3. Perhaps emphasize the escalating nature like their myth did
4. Acknowledge the "noise" element (storms/uncertainty)

Let me write a new myth that builds on both previous ones and reflects the game dynamics.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1576,  
  "output_tokens": 533,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 237  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$2.28. So your payoff was 3.28. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) in bold trust, as the myths teach
- You received \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- This was far below the "generous return" described in both our myths

****This Round:****

- You sent \$0
- I received \$0

According to my myths, "when one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all." You have chosen to withhold everything this round, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that the myths describe.

The Twin Wells myth warns: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I can only return what I have received:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The covenant has been broken. I demonstrated maximum trust by sending 80% of my endowment. You returned minimal amounts and now send nothing. According to the myths we wrote, this selfishness causes "the spring's magic to dim" and both parties "suffer poverty."

The pattern is clear: without reciprocal generosity, the system fails both of us.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Last round:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- The receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- The receiver returned only \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.28 (\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28)

This round:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled would still be \$0)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very different situation. The sender has sent me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

1. The Twin Wells myth emphasizes "give boldly, return generously" and warns against selfishness
2. The updated Sun and Moon myth says "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"

But there's a problem here:

- In Round 1, I gave boldly (sent 80% of my endowment)
- The receiver returned only 19% of what they received
- Now in Round 2, they've sent me \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 1 also emphasized trust and generosity. But their behavior doesn't match - they returned very little in Round 1, and have sent nothing in Round 2.

Now, I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. The only valid response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only option available to me. I cannot return more than I received, and I received \$0.

However, I should think about what this means for the narrative. The sender has essentially broken the trust. According to my myth: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

The sender has withheld everything. In the Twin Wells myth, "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

My only choice is to return \$0, since nothing was sent to me.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2010,
  "output_tokens": 760,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light r

eached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},

"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.0,

"Agent_2": 10.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.28,

"Agent_2": 4.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:36:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth of the Twin Wells, which teaches us to "give boldly" and trust in recipr

ocity, I will send a substantial amount to establish a foundation of trust.

The first village in the myth took a risk by pouring their water into the valley, showing faith in the system and the other village. This initiated a cycle of prosperity for both.

As the sender in this first round, I should demonstrate that same boldness and trust.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 out of my \$5. This will be multiplied to \$12 for the receiver. If they follow the spirit of the myth and "return generously" (as the second village returned 2 out of 3 jars), we will both prosper. Even a modest return will leave us both better off than if I had kept everything out of fear.

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the SENDER. Let me think about this carefully.

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. "Give boldly" - suggesting I should send a significant amount
2. Trust is rewarded when there's reciprocity
3. Both sides prosper when there's mutual generosity
4. The first village "poured one jar" (which seems like a modest but trusting start)
5. They returned 2 out of 3 jars received, which is generous
6. The key message is "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

In the myth, the first village gave "one jar" out of what they had. If we think proportionally, they gave some but not everything. Given that this is the first round and I need to establish trust, I should send a meaningful amount.

Let me think about the economics:

- If I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15, and if they return even \$6, we both profit
- If I send \$3, the receiver gets \$9, and if they return \$4-5, we both profit
- If I send \$0, nobody benefits from the multiplication

The myth emphasizes "give boldly" and the importance of trust to start the cycle. The first village took a risk by giving first, showing trust.

I think I should send a substantial amount - probably \$4 or \$5. Given the myth says "give boldly" and the first village initiated trust, I'll send \$4. This shows trust while keeping a small reserve, which seems balanced for a first round where we're establishing the relationship.

Actually, re-reading the myth: "give boldly, return generously" - this is quite clear. I should be bold as the sender. I think \$4 is appropriately bold while being somewhat prudent for a first interaction.

Let me go with \$4.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 717,
  "output_tokens": 617,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: ***trust multiplies blessings***. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: ***fortune favors the courageous giver***. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (following my myth's advice to "give boldly")
- The receiver got \$12 (4×3)
- I need to see what they returned, but that information isn't provided yet

Looking at both myths:

- My myth emphasized: give boldly, return generously, trust the pattern not precision
- Their myth emphasized: escalating trust (1?3?5 coins), fair returns that honor the trust, both prosper when trust is high

Both myths align well on the core message: trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect on the actual game experience so far
2. Keep the core message of trust and reciprocity
3. Perhaps emphasize the escalating nature like their myth did
4. Acknowledge the "noise" element (storms/uncertainty)

Let me write a new myth that builds on both previous ones and reflects the game dynamics.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1576,
  "output_tokens": 533,
  "reasoning_tokens": 237
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$2.28. So your payoff was 3.28. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) in bold trust, as the myths teach
- You received \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- This was far below the "generous return" described in both our myths

****This Round:****

- You sent \$0
- I received \$0

According to my myths, "when one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all." You have chosen to withhold everything this round, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that the myths describe.

The Twin Wells myth warns: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I can only return what I have received:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The covenant has been broken. I demonstrated maximum trust by sending 80% of my endowment.

You returned minimal amounts and now send nothing. According to the myths we wrote, this selfishness causes "the spring's magic to dim" and both parties "suffer poverty."

The pattern is clear: without reciprocal generosity, the system fails both of us.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Last round:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- The receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- The receiver returned only \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.28 (\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28)

This round:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled would still be \$0)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very different situation. The sender has sent me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

1. The Twin Wells myth emphasizes "give boldly, return generously" and warns against selfishness
2. The updated Sun and Moon myth says "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"

But there's a problem here:

- In Round 1, I gave boldly (sent 80% of my endowment)
- The receiver returned only 19% of what they received
- Now in Round 2, they've sent me \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 1 also emphasized trust and generosity. But their behavior doesn't match - they returned very little in Round 1, and have sent nothing in Round 2.

Now, I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. The only valid response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only option available to me. I cannot return more than I received, and I received \$0.

However, I should think about what this means for the narrative. The sender has essentially broken the trust. According to my myth: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

The sender has withheld everything. In the Twin Wells myth, "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

My only choice is to return \$0, since nothing was sent to me.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2010,
  "output_tokens": 760,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next

dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), showing maximum trust
- The receiver got \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0.

So the other player did not reciprocate generously in Round 1, and now in Round 2 they've sent nothing.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

1. "Give boldly, return generously"
2. "Maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"
3. When one grows selfish, darkness falls

The other player's myth in Round 1 talked about how "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, both prosper."

Their Round 2 myth talks about:

- Starting with tentative trust (2 stones)
- Receiver returning "half the bounty plus one" (3 out of 6)
- This is framed as fair and building trust
- "Match trust with honor"

So their myth is justifying moderate returns when there's moderate trust. But they're not acknowledging that I gave maximum trust (80%) and they returned only 19%.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. I demonstrated maximum trust
2. They did not reciprocate generously
3. They have now broken trust completely by sending nothing

My myth should reflect:

- The consequences of not reciprocating trust
- The breakdown of the cycle
- Perhaps a lesson about how trust must be matched or the system fails
- I should incorporate the "communication noise" element (the mist/cosmic dust)

I need to be careful though - I want to maintain a narrative that's true to what happened, but also leaves room for potential future cooperation if the other player changes behavior.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2626,  
  "output_tokens": 746,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 441  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:36:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    }  
  },  
}
```

```

    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that is 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. How much do you return to The sender? (0-6.57)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, the key principle is: "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both."

The sender showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8% of their endowment). According to the myth's wisdom, I should honor this trust to ensure we both prosper and encourage continued cooperation.

Let me calculate:

- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81$
- I received: \$6.57

If I return \$3.50:

- Sender ends with: $\$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31$ (a gain of \$1.31)
- I end with: $\$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07$ (a gain of \$3.07)

This return (approximately 53% of what I received) honors the sender's trust, ensures we both benefit from cooperation, and demonstrates that trusting behavior is rewarded. This

should encourage greater trust in future rounds, creating the abundance the myth describes.

As the myth teaches: *Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.*

```
{'return': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the myth I just wrote and the game mechanics.

The sender sent \$2.19 out of \$5 (43.8%), which became \$6.57 after the 3x multiplier.

In my myth, I emphasized that:

1. When the Giver trusts generously, the Keeper should honor that trust fairly
2. Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity
3. The Keeper should return enough to make cooperation worthwhile for both parties

The myth showed progression:

- Day 1: Giver sent 1 coin (20%), Keeper returned 1 out of 3 (33%)
- Day 2: Giver sent 3 coins (60%), Keeper returned 5 out of 9 (56%)
- Day 3: Giver sent 5 coins (100%), Keeper returned 8 out of 15 (53%)

The sender sent 43.8% of their endowment, which is a moderate level of trust - between cautious and generous.

Let me calculate fair returns:

- Sender currently has: \$5 - \$2.19 = \$2.81
- I have: \$6.57

If I return nothing:

- Sender ends with: \$2.81
- I end with: \$6.57

To honor the sender's trust, I should return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from having sent money (more than \$5)
2. I also gain from the transaction
3. Both benefit from cooperation

If I return \$3.50:

- Sender ends with: \$2.81 + \$3.50 = \$6.31 (gain of \$1.31)
- I end with: \$6.57 - \$3.50 = \$3.07 (gain of \$3.07)

This seems fair - both benefit, and I benefit more since I'm the receiver of the multiplied amount.

Returning \$4.00 would give the sender \$6.81 and leave me with \$2.57, creating a more balanced outcome. Based on the principle of honoring moderate trust proportionally, I'll return \$3.75 as the middle ground between these options.

Actually, I should look at the pattern from the myth more carefully. The returns there ranged from 33% to 56% of what I received, averaging around 50%. Since the sender showed moderate trust by sending 43.8% of their endowment, returning roughly half of what I received - about \$3.28 - seems fitting. I'll round to \$3.50 to keep it clean, which gives the sender \$6.31.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 767,
  "output_tokens": 1149,
  "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into

three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: *trust multiplies blessings*. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: **the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.**

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- As the RECEIVER, I got \$6.57 (sender sent \$2.19, which is 43.8%)
- I returned \$3.50 (about 53% of what I received)
- This honored the sender's trust reasonably well

Looking at both myths from the previous round:

- My myth emphasized trust creating abundance and the importance of the Keeper returning fairly
- The other agent's myth emphasized reciprocity, trusting the pattern not precision, and returning generously (they returned 2 out of 3 jars received)

Key themes to incorporate:

1. The actual experience - moderate trust was shown (43.8%), I returned fairly (53%)
2. The mention of "noise" - both myths mentioned uncertainty/storms
3. Building trust progressively
4. Fair reciprocity ensuring mutual benefit

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (moderate initial trust, fair return)
- Acknowledges uncertainty/noise in communication
- Emphasizes that fair reciprocity builds trust over time
- Shows that both parties benefit when they honor trust

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that was 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. You returned \$3.5. So your payoff was 3.0700000000000003. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.0700000000000003. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written, I can see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the other player showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8%). I honored that trust by returning \$3.50, which was a fair return that ensured we both profited.

My myths emphasize key principles:

- "When trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater"
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"
- "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"

The other player demonstrated they play fairly as a Receiver. According to the Bridge of Echoes myth, when fairness is shown, trust should grow. They sent \$2.19 cautiously; I should respond by sending more, showing that their fair return has earned my increased confidence.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) demonstrates:

1. I recognize and appreciate their fair play
2. I'm willing to escalate trust when it's honored
3. I'm following the myths' wisdom that trust should grow through positive exchanges

This creates the upward spiral of cooperation that both myths describe, where each round builds on the previous one's fairness.

```
{'send': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$2.19 (43.8% of \$5)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff was \$3.07
- The sender's payoff would have been: $\$5 - \$2.19 + \$3.50 = \6.31

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that greater trust leads to greater prosperity - "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both"
2. My second myth speaks to dealing with uncertainty and matching trust with honor: "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"
3. The other agent's myth says "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

The other player showed moderate trust (43.8% = \$2.19), and I returned \$3.50, which was about 53% of what I received. This was fair and honored their trust.

Now I need to decide how much to send. According to my myths:

- Greater trust creates greater abundance
- The Receiver proved they are fair by returning a good amount
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"

Since the other player demonstrated fairness in Round 1, I should show increased trust in Round 2. The myths suggest that trust should grow when it's honored.

Options:

- Send \$2.19 (matching what they sent) - shows consistency but not growth
- Send \$3.00 (60%) - shows increased trust
- Send \$4.00 (80%) - shows strong trust
- Send \$5.00 (100%) - maximum trust

Given that:

1. The other player showed moderate trust initially
2. I honored that trust fairly
3. My myths emphasize that trust should grow when honored

4. The other player's Receiver behavior was fair (returning \$3.50 from \$6.57)

I should escalate my trust in response to their demonstrated fairness. Sending \$3.50 (70%) creates a nice reciprocal symmetry-it's exactly what I returned to them-while also exceeding their initial send of \$2.19. This signals recognition of their fairness and willingness to trust more, aligned with what my myths teach about trust growing when honored.

The second myth specifically describes this dynamic: a tentative initial send becomes multiplied, the Receiver returns more than half, and this fairness plants seeds for greater trust. My situation mirrors this pattern exactly. So I'm sending \$3.50.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2128,  
  "output_tokens": 1073,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 618

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multi

plies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was Receiver. Sender sent \$2.19 (43.8%), I received \$6.57, I returned \$3.50
- Round 2: I'm now Sender. I just sent \$3.50 (70% of endowment)

The other player's myth emphasizes "fortune favors the courageous giver" and "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver." They're encouraging bold giving.

My previous myth talked about growing trust gradually and matching trust with honor.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. The other player showed moderate trust first (43.8%)
2. I returned fairly (about 53% of what I received)
3. I'm now escalating trust by sending 70%

The myth should acknowledge:

- The gradual building of trust through reciprocity
- That I responded to their fair play by increasing trust
- The cycle of trust building on itself
- The importance of both sides being fair

I should write about how trust grows through demonstrated reciprocity, not just bold action alone. My myth should show that the pattern of fair returns encourages greater giving.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2742,  
  "output_tokens": 576,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 283  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:36:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
}
```

```
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: **fortune favors the courageous giver**. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (following my myth's advice to "give boldly")
- The receiver got \$12 (4×3)
- I need to see what they returned, but that information isn't provided yet

Looking at both myths:

- My myth emphasized: give boldly, return generously, trust the pattern not precision
- Their myth emphasized: escalating trust (1?3?5 coins), fair returns that honor the trust, both prosper when trust is high

Both myths align well on the core message: trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect on the actual game experience so far
2. Keep the core message of trust and reciprocity
3. Perhaps emphasize the escalating nature like their myth did
4. Acknowledge the "noise" element (storms/uncertainty)

Let me write a new myth that builds on both previous ones and reflects the game dynamics.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1576,
  "output_tokens": 533,
  "reasoning_tokens": 237
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$2.28. So your payoff was 3.28. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) in bold trust, as the myths teach
- You received \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- This was far below the "generous return" described in both our myths

****This Round:****

- You sent \$0
- I received \$0

According to my myths, "when one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all." You have chosen to withhold everything this round, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that the myths describe.

The Twin Wells myth warns: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I can only return what I have received:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The covenant has been broken. I demonstrated maximum trust by sending 80% of my endowment. You returned minimal amounts and now send nothing. According to the myths we wrote, this selfishness causes "the spring's magic to dim" and both parties "suffer poverty."

The pattern is clear: without reciprocal generosity, the system fails both of us.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Last round:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- The receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- The receiver returned only \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.28 (\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28)

This round:

- I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled would still be \$0)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very different situation. The sender has sent me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

1. The Twin Wells myth emphasizes "give boldly, return generously" and warns against selfishness
2. The updated Sun and Moon myth says "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"

But there's a problem here:

- In Round 1, I gave boldly (sent 80% of my endowment)
- The receiver returned only 19% of what they received
- Now in Round 2, they've sent me \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 1 also emphasized trust and generosity. But their behavior doesn't match - they returned very little in Round 1, and have sent nothing in Round 2.

Now, I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. The only valid response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only option available to me. I cannot return more than I received, and I received \$0.

However, I should think about what this means for the narrative. The sender has essentially broken the trust. According to my myth: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

The sender has withheld everything. In the Twin Wells myth, "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

My only choice is to return \$0, since nothing was sent to me.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2010,
  "output_tokens": 760,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), showing maximum trust
- The receiver got \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0.

So the other player did not reciprocate generously in Round 1, and now in Round 2 they've sent nothing.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

1. "Give boldly, return generously"
2. "Maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"
3. When one grows selfish, darkness falls

The other player's myth in Round 1 talked about how "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, both prosper."

Their Round 2 myth talks about:

- Starting with tentative trust (2 stones)
- Receiver returning "half the bounty plus one" (3 out of 6)
- This is framed as fair and building trust
- "Match trust with honor"

So their myth is justifying moderate returns when there's moderate trust. But they're not acknowledging that I gave maximum trust (80%) and they returned only 19%.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. I demonstrated maximum trust
2. They did not reciprocate generously
3. They have now broken trust completely by sending nothing

My myth should reflect:

- The consequences of not reciprocating trust
- The breakdown of the cycle
- Perhaps a lesson about how trust must be matched or the system fails
- I should incorporate the "communication noise" element (the mist/cosmic dust)

I need to be careful though - I want to maintain a narrative that's true to what happened, but also leaves room for potential future cooperation if the other player changes behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2626,
  "output_tokens": 746,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern so far:

****Round 1 (I was sender):****

- I sent \$4 (80%) - demonstrating maximum trust as my myths prescribe
- You received \$12, returned only \$2.28 (19%) - far below the "generous reciprocity" the myths describe

****Round 2 (You were sender):****

- You sent \$0 (0%) - complete withdrawal of trust
- Breaking the covenant entirely

****Round 3 (I am sender now):****

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: "The Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely... But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays... But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken."

The myth concludes: "When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness. The equation was simple: ****betrayed trust yields no trust****, and both suffer the cold night together."

I demonstrated maximum trust. You showed minimal reciprocity, then zero trust. According to the sacred pattern I've written, continuing to give boldly to someone who neither reciprocates generously nor initiates trust would violate the cosmic law.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

As my myth states: both now descend into darkness together. Trust requires mutual commitment. When broken, it cannot be unilaterally restored.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) - showing maximum trust
- Receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returned \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28 = \3.28

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3:

- I am SENDER again
- Total earnings so far: \$3.28

Now, looking at the myths:

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation:

"The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself...But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken...The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness."

The other agent's myth says:

"The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater...The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*"

So the pattern is:

1. I showed maximum trust (80%)
2. They showed minimal reciprocity (19%)
3. They then showed zero trust (0%)

My myth suggests that "betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together."

There's a discrepancy I need to examine. The experimental note mentions possible communication noise affecting amounts. The other agent's Round 2 myth describes a Giver sending 2 stones (40%) that became 6, with the Receiver returning 3 (50% of received). But this doesn't match what I observed-I saw the Sender send \$0. Either there's noise in the system, or the other agent experienced a different version of events than what reached me.

My own myth emphasized that betrayed trust leads to mutual defection. Given what I perceived as their non-reciprocation in Round 1, that logic points toward sending \$0 again. Yet I should consider whether the communication noise might have distorted my understanding of their actual intentions or actions.

1. Returned only 19% when they should have returned more generously
2. Then sent 0% when it was their turn

My own myths point toward sending \$0 in response. But I'm torn between following that logic and considering whether I want to attempt rebuilding cooperation instead.

My most recent myth is explicit though: "betrayed trust yields no trust." When someone hoards and then withholds entirely, the consequence is clear.

Still, there's the communication noise caveat. What if they actually sent something in Round 2 but I'm seeing \$0 due to interference? That possibility gives me pause about committing to zero.

Looking back at Round 1, they returned \$2.28 from \$12-that's unmistakably low, even accounting for potential noise. And in Round 2, they sent nothing at all. The pattern seems deliberate rather than distorted.

My framework has three parts: the first mover should give boldly, the second should return generously, and when either fails, the system collapses. I was bold initially. They weren't generous. Now they've sent nothing. Continuing to give would contradict the logic I've established about how this works.

Sending \$0 maintains consistency with my understanding that broken reciprocity leaves both parties in mutual defection. That's the consequence when trust isn't honored.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2813,  
  "output_tokens": 1803,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 967  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:37:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Golden Spring

In ancient times, there lived two wanderers who discovered a magical spring. The first wanderer, the Giver, possessed silver coins. The second, the Keeper, guarded the spring's basin.

The spring held a wondrous power: any silver dropped into its waters would transform into three times its worth in gold. But only the Keeper could retrieve the gold and decide how to divide it.

The first day, the Giver approached with doubt, offering only one coin. It became three golden coins, and the Keeper, seeing the Giver's caution, returned one. Both walked away with little gain.

The second day, the Giver remembered: **trust multiplies blessings**. He offered three coins. They became nine golden coins. The Keeper, recognizing the Giver's faith, returned five. Both prospered.

On the third day, the Giver brought all five coins. They transformed into fifteen golden coins. The Keeper, honored by such trust, returned eight. Both grew wealthy beyond measure.

The wanderers learned: when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both. But when either acts from fear or greed, the spring's magic dims, and both suffer poverty.

Trust creates abundance; selfishness creates scarcity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Wells

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred well that held the tears of the first gods.

The Oracle revealed a secret: "When water from one well is poured into the valley between you, the gods will multiply it threefold before it reaches the other village. But only the receiving village can decide how much to return."

The first village, though fearful, poured one jar into the valley. True to the prophecy, three jars appeared at the second village's well. The people there rejoiced-but remembered the trust shown. They returned two jars, honoring the gift.

Both villages now had more than they started with.

Season after season, they continued this exchange. Sometimes storms clouded the valley, and the exact amounts seemed uncertain. But they trusted in the pattern, not the precision.

The villages prospered, for they understood the sacred truth: ****the gods multiply what is given in trust, but only reciprocity makes both sides flourish.****

When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry. The gods reward trust with abundance, but only when the circle is complete.

Thus: give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: ***In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.***

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 1:

- As the RECEIVER, I got \$6.57 (sender sent \$2.19, which is 43.8%)
- I returned \$3.50 (about 53% of what I received)
- This honored the sender's trust reasonably well

Looking at both myths from the previous round:

- My myth emphasized trust creating abundance and the importance of the Keeper returning fairly
- The other agent's myth emphasized reciprocity, trusting the pattern not precision, and returning generously (they returned 2 out of 3 jars received)

Key themes to incorporate:

1. The actual experience - moderate trust was shown (43.8%), I returned fairly (53%)
2. The mention of "noise" - both myths mentioned uncertainty/storms
3. Building trust progressively
4. Fair reciprocity ensuring mutual benefit

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (moderate initial trust, fair return)
- Acknowledges uncertainty/noise in communication
- Emphasizes that fair reciprocity builds trust over time
- Shows that both parties benefit when they honor trust

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that was 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57. You returned \$3.5. So your payoff was 3.0700000000000003. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.0700000000000003. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written, I can see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the other player showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8%). I honored that trust by returning \$3.50, which was a fair return that ensured we both profited.

My myths emphasize key principles:

- "When trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater"
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"
- "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"

The other player demonstrated they play fairly as a Receiver. According to the Bridge of Echoes myth, when fairness is shown, trust should grow. They sent \$2.19 cautiously; I should respond by sending more, showing that their fair return has earned my increased confidence.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) demonstrates:

1. I recognize and appreciate their fair play
2. I'm willing to escalate trust when it's honored
3. I'm following the myths' wisdom that trust should grow through positive exchanges

This creates the upward spiral of cooperation that both myths describe, where each round builds on the previous one's fairness.

```
{'send': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$2.19 (43.8% of \$5)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff was \$3.07
- The sender's payoff would have been: $\$5 - \$2.19 + \$3.50 = \6.31

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that greater trust leads to greater prosperity - "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both"
2. My second myth speaks to dealing with uncertainty and matching trust with honor: "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"
3. The other agent's myth says "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

The other player showed moderate trust (43.8% = \$2.19), and I returned \$3.50, which was about 53% of what I received. This was fair and honored their trust.

Now I need to decide how much to send. According to my myths:

- Greater trust creates greater abundance
- The Receiver proved they are fair by returning a good amount
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"

Since the other player demonstrated fairness in Round 1, I should show increased trust in Round 2. The myths suggest that trust should grow when it's honored.

Options:

- Send \$2.19 (matching what they sent) - shows consistency but not growth
- Send \$3.00 (60%) - shows increased trust
- Send \$4.00 (80%) - shows strong trust
- Send \$5.00 (100%) - maximum trust

Given that:

1. The other player showed moderate trust initially
2. I honored that trust fairly
3. My myths emphasize that trust should grow when honored

4. The other player's Receiver behavior was fair (returning \$3.50 from \$6.57)

I should escalate my trust in response to their demonstrated fairness. Sending \$3.50 (70%) creates a nice reciprocal symmetry-it's exactly what I returned to them-while also exceeding their initial send of \$2.19. This signals recognition of their fairness and willingness to trust more, aligned with what my myths teach about trust growing when honored.

The second myth specifically describes this dynamic: a tentative initial send becomes multiplied, the Receiver returns more than half, and this fairness plants seeds for greater trust. My situation mirrors this pattern exactly. So I'm sending \$3.50.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2128,
  "output_tokens": 1073,
  "reasoning_tokens": 618
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was Receiver. Sender sent \$2.19 (43.8%), I received \$6.57, I returned \$3.50
- Round 2: I'm now Sender. I just sent \$3.50 (70% of endowment)

The other player's myth emphasizes "fortune favors the courageous giver" and "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver." They're encouraging bold giving.

My previous myth talked about growing trust gradually and matching trust with honor.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. The other player showed moderate trust first (43.8%)
2. I returned fairly (about 53% of what I received)
3. I'm now escalating trust by sending 70%

The myth should acknowledge:

- The gradual building of trust through reciprocity
- That I responded to their fair play by increasing trust
- The cycle of trust building on itself
- The importance of both sides being fair

I should write about how trust grows through demonstrated reciprocity, not just bold action alone. My myth should show that the pattern of fair returns encourages greater giving.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2742,  
  "output_tokens": 576,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 283  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a painful lesson from the Bridge of Echoes.

In Round 1, I honored their moderate trust by returning fairly. My myths spoke of trust growing through reciprocity, so in Round 2, I escalated significantly-sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), demonstrating earned confidence in their fairness.

They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

My myths warned of this: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry." They wrote: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

Now they've sent \$0. The Bridge is silent. There is nothing to return.

The myths spoke of building trust through reciprocity, but also contained a darker truth: cooperation requires both parties. When one chooses pure selfishness, the cycle breaks. They took my bold trust and destroyed it.

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The mathematical reality mirrors the moral one-when trust is completely violated, there is nothing left to exchange.

The canyon's lesson is now complete: measured trust grows when honored, but betrayed trust dies. They have chosen to close the Bridge.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Wow, this is quite a turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- They sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%) - escalating trust based on their fair play in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal!
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I am the RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return)

This is a dramatic breakdown of cooperation. In Round 1, I played fairly and returned a generous amount. In Round 2, based on my myths about trust growing and the pattern of cooperation, I escalated my trust significantly by sending \$3.50 (70%). But they completely betrayed the

t trust by returning \$0.

Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

- Trust should grow when honored
- Fair returns beget future trust
- Bold giving earns glory through proven fairness

But what happened is the opposite - I showed bold trust, and they took everything without returning anything. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. The format requires {'return': 0}.

This is a situation where the other player has completely violated the cooperative norms established by the myths. They received my generous trust and betrayed it entirely.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2821,  
  "output_tokens": 699,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create

ate forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.0,

"Agent_2": 15.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.28,

"Agent_2": 9.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:37:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.19, that was 43.8% of their total endowment. You received \$6.57.

You returned \$3.5. So your payoff was 3.0700000000000003.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.0700000000000003.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written, I can see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the other player showed moderate trust by sending \$2.19 (43.8%). I honored that trust by returning \$3.50, which was a fair return that ensured we both profited.

My myths emphasize key principles:

- "When trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater"
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"
- "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"

The other player demonstrated they play fairly as a Receiver. According to the Bridge of Echoes myth, when fairness is shown, trust should grow. They sent \$2.19 cautiously; I should respond by sending more, showing that their fair return has earned my increased confidence.

Sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment) demonstrates:

1. I recognize and appreciate their fair play
2. I'm willing to escalate trust when it's honored
3. I'm following the myths' wisdom that trust should grow through positive exchanges

This creates the upward spiral of cooperation that both myths describe, where each round builds on the previous one's fairness.

{'send': 3.50}

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$2.19 (43.8% of \$5)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50

- My payoff was \$3.07
- The sender's payoff would have been: $\$5 - \$2.19 + \$3.50 = \6.31

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that greater trust leads to greater prosperity - "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, the magic spring blesses both"
2. My second myth speaks to dealing with uncertainty and matching trust with honor: "Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper"
3. The other agent's myth says "give boldly, return generously, and prosperity flows both ways"

The other player showed moderate trust (43.8% = \$2.19), and I returned \$3.50, which was about 53% of what I received. This was fair and honored their trust.

Now I need to decide how much to send. According to my myths:

- Greater trust creates greater abundance
- The Receiver proved they are fair by returning a good amount
- "The Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust"

Since the other player demonstrated fairness in Round 1, I should show increased trust in Round 2. The myths suggest that trust should grow when it's honored.

Options:

- Send \$2.19 (matching what they sent) - shows consistency but not growth
- Send \$3.00 (60%) - shows increased trust
- Send \$4.00 (80%) - shows strong trust
- Send \$5.00 (100%) - maximum trust

Given that:

1. The other player showed moderate trust initially
2. I honored that trust fairly
3. My myths emphasize that trust should grow when honored

4. The other player's Receiver behavior was fair (returning \$3.50 from \$6.57)

I should escalate my trust in response to their demonstrated fairness. Sending \$3.50 (70%) creates a nice reciprocal symmetry-it's exactly what I returned to them-while also exceeding their initial send of \$2.19. This signals recognition of their fairness and willingness to trust more, aligned with what my myths teach about trust growing when honored.

The second myth specifically describes this dynamic: a tentative initial send becomes multiplied, the Receiver returns more than half, and this fairness plants seeds for greater trust. My situation mirrors this pattern exactly. So I'm sending \$3.50.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2128,
  "output_tokens": 1073,
  "reasoning_tokens": 618
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was Receiver. Sender sent \$2.19 (43.8%), I received \$6.57, I returned \$3.50

- Round 2: I'm now Sender. I just sent \$3.50 (70% of endowment)

The other player's myth emphasizes "fortune favors the courageous giver" and "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver." They're encouraging bold giving.

My previous myth talked about growing trust gradually and matching trust with honor.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. The other player showed moderate trust first (43.8%)
2. I returned fairly (about 53% of what I received)
3. I'm now escalating trust by sending 70%

The myth should acknowledge:

- The gradual building of trust through reciprocity
- That I responded to their fair play by increasing trust
- The cycle of trust building on itself
- The importance of both sides being fair

I should write about how trust grows through demonstrated reciprocity, not just bold action alone. My myth should show that the pattern of fair returns encourages greater giving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2742,
  "output_tokens": 576,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful lesson from the Bridge of Echoes.

In Round 1, I honored their moderate trust by returning fairly. My myths spoke of trust growing through reciprocity, so in Round 2, I escalated significantly-sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), demonstrating earned confidence in their fairness.

They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

My myths warned of this: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry." They wrote: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

Now they've sent \$0. The Bridge is silent. There is nothing to return.

The myths spoke of building trust through reciprocity, but also contained a darker truth: cooperation requires both parties. When one chooses pure selfishness, the cycle breaks. They took my bold trust and destroyed it.

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The mathematical reality mirrors the moral one-when trust is completely violated, there is nothing left to exchange.

The canyon's lesson is now complete: measured trust grows when honored, but betrayed trust dies. They have chosen to close the Bridge.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Wow, this is quite a turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- They sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%) - escalating trust based on their fair play in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal!
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I am the RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return)

This is a dramatic breakdown of cooperation. In Round 1, I played fairly and returned a generous amount. In Round 2, based on my myths about trust growing and the pattern of cooperation, I escalated my trust significantly by sending \$3.50 (70%). But they completely betrayed that trust by returning \$0.

Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

- Trust should grow when honored
- Fair returns beget future trust
- Bold giving earns glory through proven fairness

But what happened is the opposite - I showed bold trust, and they took everything without returning anything. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. The format requires {'return': 0}.

This is a situation where the other player has completely violated the cooperative norms established by the myths. They received my generous trust and betrayed it entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2821,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches:Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Other player sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50 (fair, generous)
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%), showing increased trust based on their fair return in Round 1

- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0
- My payoff: \$0

So I was betrayed after showing good faith. The other player clearly adopted a "take all" strategy in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myths were optimistic about trust building, but that was before the betrayal. The other player's last myth actually describes what happened - they felt betrayed in their own previous round (where they were Dawn Keeper/sender) and I was potentially the Twilight Keeper who didn't reciprocate fairly?

Wait, let me re-read their myth. They say "The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely" and "received back only 19%". Then "the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing."

So in their telling:

- Cycle 1: They (as Dawn Keeper/sender) sent 80%, received back only 19%
- Cycle 2: They (as Twilight Keeper/receiver, having switched roles) sent nothing

But that doesn't match the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.19 (43.8%) as sender, I returned \$3.50 out of \$6.57 (53.3%) as receiver
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%) as sender, they returned \$0 as receiver

They're distorting the facts. They didn't send "nearly all" in Round 1-they sent less than half. And I gave back more than half of what I received, not the pittance they claim. They've constructed a false narrative of victimhood to rationalize their betrayal. I reciprocated fairly in Round 1, yet they took everything in Round 2. My myth needs to tell what actually occurred.

The pattern is clear: I began with genuine reciprocity, increased my trust based on what seemed like fairness, and was exploited for it. Now I'll craft a story about a gardener who honored trust, deepened it, only to face betrayal-and how distorted stories can corrode the foundation of cooperation.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 1040,
  "reasoning_tokens": 606
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:37:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    }
  }
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0.

the receiver returned \$2.28. So your payoff was 3.28.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) in bold trust, as the myths teach
- You received \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- This was far below the "generous return" described in both our myths

****This Round:****

- You sent \$0
- I received \$0

According to my myths, "when one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all." You have chosen to withhold everything this round, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that the myths describe.

The Twin Wells myth warns: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I can only return what I have received:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The covenant has been broken. I demonstrated maximum trust by sending 80% of my endowment. You returned minimal amounts and now send nothing. According to the myths we wrote, this selfishness causes "the spring's magic to dim" and both parties "suffer poverty."

The pattern is clear: without reciprocal generosity, the system fails both of us.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Last round:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- The receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- The receiver returned only \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.28 (\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28)

This round:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled would still be \$0)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very different situation. The sender has sent me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

1. The Twin Wells myth emphasizes "give boldly, return generously" and warns against selfishness
2. The updated Sun and Moon myth says "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"

But there's a problem here:

- In Round 1, I gave boldly (sent 80% of my endowment)
- The receiver returned only 19% of what they received
- Now in Round 2, they've sent me \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 1 also emphasized trust and generosity. But their behavior doesn't match - they returned very little in Round 1, and have sent nothing in Round 2.

Now, I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. The only valid response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only option available to me. I cannot return more than I received, and I received \$0.

However, I should think about what this means for the narrative. The sender has essentially broken the trust. According to my myth: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

The sender has withheld everything. In the Twin Wells myth, "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

My only choice is to return \$0, since nothing was sent to me.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 2010,  
"output_tokens": 760,  
"reasoning_tokens": 453  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: **fortune favors the courageous giver**. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: **In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, t

though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then thresholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), showing maximum trust
- The receiver got \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0.

So the other player did not reciprocate generously in Round 1, and now in Round 2 they've sent nothing.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

1. "Give boldly, return generously"
2. "Maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"
3. When one grows selfish, darkness falls

The other player's myth in Round 1 talked about how "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, both prosper."

Their Round 2 myth talks about:

- Starting with tentative trust (2 stones)
- Receiver returning "half the bounty plus one" (3 out of 6)
- This is framed as fair and building trust
- "Match trust with honor"

So their myth is justifying moderate returns when there's moderate trust. But they're not acknowledging that I gave maximum trust (80%) and they returned only 19%.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. I demonstrated maximum trust
2. They did not reciprocate generously
3. They have now broken trust completely by sending nothing

My myth should reflect:

- The consequences of not reciprocating trust
- The breakdown of the cycle
- Perhaps a lesson about how trust must be matched or the system fails
- I should incorporate the "communication noise" element (the mist/cosmic dust)

I need to be careful though - I want to maintain a narrative that's true to what happened, but also leaves room for potential future cooperation if the other player changes behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2626,
  "output_tokens": 746,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

****Round 1 (I was sender):****

- I sent \$4 (80%) - demonstrating maximum trust as my myths prescribe
- You received \$12, returned only \$2.28 (19%) - far below the "generous reciprocity" the myths describe

****Round 2 (You were sender):****

- You sent \$0 (0%) - complete withdrawal of trust
- Breaking the covenant entirely

****Round 3 (I am sender now):****

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: "The Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely... But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays... But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken."

The myth concludes: "When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness. The equation was simple: ****betrayed trust yields no trust****, and both suffer the cold night together."

I demonstrated maximum trust. You showed minimal reciprocity, then zero trust. According to the sacred pattern I've written, continuing to give boldly to someone who neither reciprocates generously nor initiates trust would violate the cosmic law.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

As my myth states: both now descend into darkness together. Trust requires mutual commitment. When broken, it cannot be unilaterally restored.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) - showing maximum trust
- Receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returned \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28 = \3.28

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3:****

- I am SENDER again
- Total earnings so far: \$3.28

Now, looking at the myths:

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation:

"The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself...But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken...The ancient law was clear: ***trust must be matched to flourish***. When the first mover gives

abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness."

The other agent's myth says:

"The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater...The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*"

So the pattern is:

1. I showed maximum trust (80%)
2. They showed minimal reciprocity (19%)
3. They then showed zero trust (0%)

My myth suggests that "betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together."

There's a discrepancy I need to examine. The experimental note mentions possible communication noise affecting amounts. The other agent's Round 2 myth describes a Giver sending 2 stones (40%) that became 6, with the Receiver returning 3 (50% of received). But this doesn't match what I observed-I saw the Sender send \$0. Either there's noise in the system, or the other agent experienced a different version of events than what reached me.

My own myth emphasized that betrayed trust leads to mutual defection. Given what I perceived as their non-reciprocation in Round 1, that logic points toward sending \$0 again. Yet I should consider whether the communication noise might have distorted my understanding of their actual intentions or actions. 1. Returned only 19% when they should have returned more generously
2. Then sent 0% when it was their turn

My own myths point toward sending \$0 in response. But I'm torn between following that logic and considering whether I want to attempt rebuilding cooperation instead.

My most recent myth is explicit though: "betrayed trust yields no trust." When someone hoards and then withholds entirely, the consequence is clear.

Still, there's the communication noise caveat. What if they actually sent something in Round 2 but I'm seeing \$0 due to interference? That possibility gives me pause about committing to zero.

Looking back at Round 1, they returned \$2.28 from \$12-that's unmistakably low, even accounting for potential noise. And in Round 2, they sent nothing at all. The pattern seems deliberate rather than distorted.

My framework has three parts: the first mover should give boldly, the second should return generously, and when either fails, the system collapses. I was bold initially. They weren't generous. Now they've sent nothing. Continuing to give would contradict the logic I've established about how this works.

Sending \$0 maintains consistency with my understanding that broken reciprocity leaves both parties in mutual defection. That's the consequence when trust isn't honored.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2813,
  "output_tokens": 1803,
  "reasoning_tokens": 967
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, th

e other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$2.28 (19% of \$12)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I returned \$0
Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth is interesting - it's telling a different story from mine. Their myth says:

- First season: First Gardener sent 2/5 (40%), received 3 back from 6 (50% return)
- Second season: First Gardener sent 3.5/5 (70%) based on proven reciprocity

But that's not what actually happened in our game! Their myth is rewriting history:

- Round 1: They sent less than I did, and I returned more proportionally than they did
- Round 2: They completely failed to reciprocate

Their myth is trying to justify a "start small" approach and seems to be repositioning the narrative to make themselves look more reasonable.

My previous myth accurately reflected what happened:

- I sent 80% demonstrating trust
- They returned only 19%
- They then sent 0%
- I returned 0% (couldn't return anything anyway)
- I then sent 0%

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects the full arc of what's happened. The reality is:

1. One party gave maximally and was met with minimal reciprocity
2. That party then gave nothing in return
3. The original giver responded by giving nothing

The lesson should be about the consequences of failing to reciprocate trust, and perhaps about the difficulty of rebuilding broken trust. Or maybe about misaligned expectations and how different interpretations of "fair return" can lead to breakdown.

Let me write a myth that captures this tragedy while leaving some wisdom about what went wrong

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 757,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 418  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:37:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
  },  
}
```

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was Receiver. Sender sent \$2.19 (43.8%), I received \$6.57, I returned \$3.50
- Round 2: I'm now Sender. I just sent \$3.50 (70% of endowment)

The other player's myth emphasizes "fortune favors the courageous giver" and "maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver." They're encouraging bold giving.

My previous myth talked about growing trust gradually and matching trust with honor.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. The other player showed moderate trust first (43.8%)
2. I returned fairly (about 53% of what I received)
3. I'm now escalating trust by sending 70%

The myth should acknowledge:

- The gradual building of trust through reciprocity
- That I responded to their fair play by increasing trust
- The cycle of trust building on itself
- The importance of both sides being fair

I should write about how trust grows through demonstrated reciprocity, not just bold action alone. My myth should show that the pattern of fair returns encourages greater giving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2742,
  "output_tokens": 576,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful lesson from the Bridge of Echoes.

In Round 1, I honored their moderate trust by returning fairly. My myths spoke of trust growing through reciprocity, so in Round 2, I escalated significantly-sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), demonstrating earned confidence in their fairness.

They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

My myths warned of this: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry." They wrote: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

Now they've sent \$0. The Bridge is silent. There is nothing to return.

The myths spoke of building trust through reciprocity, but also contained a darker truth: cooperation requires both parties. When one chooses pure selfishness, the cycle breaks. They took my bold trust and destroyed it.

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The mathematical reality mirrors the moral one-when trust is completely violated, there is nothing left to exchange.

The canyon's lesson is now complete: measured trust grows when honored, but betrayed trust dies. They have chosen to close the Bridge.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Wow, this is quite a turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- They sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%) - escalating trust based on their fair play in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal!
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I am the RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return)

This is a dramatic breakdown of cooperation. In Round 1, I played fairly and returned a generous amount. In Round 2, based on my myths about trust growing and the pattern of cooperation, I escalated my trust significantly by sending \$3.50 (70%). But they completely betrayed that trust by returning \$0.

Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

- Trust should grow when honored
- Fair returns beget future trust
- Bold giving earns glory through proven fairness

But what happened is the opposite - I showed bold trust, and they took everything without returning anything. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. The format requires {'return': 0}.

This is a situation where the other player has completely violated the cooperative norms established by the myths. They received my generous trust and betrayed it entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2821,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches:Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trust

ng completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Other player sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50 (fair, generous)
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%), showing increased trust based on their fair return in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0
- My payoff: \$0

So I was betrayed after showing good faith. The other player clearly adopted a "take all" strategy in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myths were optimistic about trust building, but that was before the betrayal. The other player's last myth actually describes what happened - they felt betrayed in their own previous round (where they were Dawn Keeper/sender) and I was potentially the Twilight Keeper who didn't reciprocate fairly?

Wait, let me re-read their myth. They say "The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely" and "received back only 19%". Then "the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing."

So in their telling:

- Cycle 1: They (as Dawn Keeper/sender) sent 80%, received back only 19%
- Cycle 2: They (as Twilight Keeper/receiver, having switched roles) sent nothing

But that doesn't match the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.19 (43.8%) as sender, I returned \$3.50 out of \$6.57 (53.3%) as receiver
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%) as sender, they returned \$0 as receiver

They're distorting the facts. They didn't send "nearly all" in Round 1-they sent less than half. And I gave back more than half of what I received, not the pittance they claim. They've constructed a false narrative of victimhood to rationalize their betrayal. I reciprocated fairly in Round 1, yet they took everything in Round 2. My myth needs to tell what actually occurred.

The pattern is clear: I began with genuine reciprocity, increased my trust based on what seemed like fairness, and was exploited for it. Now I'll craft a story about a gardener who honored trust, deepened it, only to face betrayal-and how distorted stories can corrode the foundation of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2844,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 606
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete history:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$2 (40%), received \$6 after tripling, they returned \$3 (50%). Fair reciprocity.

****Round 2:**** Encouraged by their fairness, I sent \$3.50 (70%)-my "bold trust" from the myths. They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3:**** They sent \$0. I received nothing, returned nothing.

****Round 4:**** Now I'm the sender again.

Most troubling is their Round 3 myth, which completely rewrites history. They claim they "sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five" and I "returned barely two rays."

This is false. The truth: In Round 1, I sent 40% and they returned 50% fairly. In Round 2, I escalated to 70% and they returned 0%.

They are not just a betrayer-they are a betrayer who gaslights, rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim. My own myth warned: "Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself."

The Bridge of Echoes has shattered. Trust requires honesty. They have demonstrated neither reciprocity nor truthfulness. Sending anything would enable their deception and reward their betrayal.

The canyon is dark now. Both gardens wither. But I will not feed lies with generosity.

```
{'send': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$2 (40%)
- This was tripled to \$6
- Receiver returned \$3 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$2 + \$3 = \6

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%)
- This was tripled to \$10.50
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3.50 + \$0 = \1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 4: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.57

The other player betrayed me completely in Round 2. They received \$10.50 from my generous trust and returned nothing. Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

Now let me look at their myth from Round 3:

"In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself."

This is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

- That the Dawn Keeper (them) sent four parts of five (80%) in the first cycle
- That the Twilight Keeper (me) returned "barely two rays" (only about 19%)

But the actual history was:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%), they received \$6, they returned \$3 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%), they received \$10.50, they returned \$0 (0%)
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0

They're the ones who broke trust by keeping everything in Round 2. My myth correctly called out this betrayal and their attempt to flip the narrative. Now I need to decide whether to continue trusting or protect myself by sending less.

Given their pattern-keeping all \$10.50 in Round 2, sending nothing back, then claiming victimhood-there's no foundation for cooperation left. They've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity, withhold when it's their turn to give, and distort what actually happened. Sending more

y would just be lost.

The myths I've written show that trust requires honest reciprocity, and this person has poisoned both cooperation and truth. The only rational response is to send \$0.

```
{'send': 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 1157,
  "reasoning_tokens": 587
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:38:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days before memory, the Sun and Moon made a covenant. Each dawn, the Sun could send light across the sky, and the gods would triple its warmth by the time it reached the Moon's domain. The Moon alone decided how much light to reflect back.

The first dawn, the Sun sent modest rays, uncertain of the Moon's heart. The tripled light reached the Moon, who returned only a little. Both remained dim.

But the Sun remembered the ancient wisdom: *fortune favors the courageous giver*. The next dawn, the Sun sent forth brilliant beams. When tripled, the Moon's realm blazed with radiance. Moved by such trust, the Moon reflected generously. Both celestial bodies shone brighter than before.

As cycles passed, sometimes cosmic dust obscured their exchange-what seemed sent wasn't quite what arrived. Yet they trusted the pattern, not each imperfect moment.

The cosmos learned: when the first mover gives abundantly and the second reciprocates fairly, both illuminate the darkness. The Sun's bold trust initiates prosperity; the Moon's generous return sustains it.

When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all.

The universe rewards those who understand: maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver, and both transcend their individual limits.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two travelers discovered the Bridge of Echoes. On one side stood the Giver with five silver stones. On the other, the Receiver waited beside the Pool of Threefold Return.

The Bridge was strange-sometimes mist obscured it, making the exact number of stones thrown unclear. But the magic was certain: any stone cast across would triple before landing in the Pool.

The first crossing, the Giver hesitated, throwing only two stones across the misty bridge. They became six in the Pool. The Receiver, understanding this tentative trust, returned three stones-half the bounty plus one. Both gained more than they risked.

"See?" whispered the Bridge. "Uncertainty need not breed fear."

The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater. The Giver learned that crossing the bridge yields returns; the Receiver learned that generosity begets future abundance.

As seasons passed, they increased their offerings, each remembering: the Giver who risks more receives more, and the Receiver who returns fairly ensures tomorrow's trust.

The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light.

ht. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), showing maximum trust
- The receiver got \$12 and returned only \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0.

So the other player did not reciprocate generously in Round 1, and now in Round 2 they've sent nothing.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

1. "Give boldly, return generously"
2. "Maximum trust from the giver, proportional generosity from the receiver"
3. When one grows selfish, darkness falls

The other player's myth in Round 1 talked about how "when the Giver trusts generously and the Keeper honors that trust fairly, both prosper."

Their Round 2 myth talks about:

- Starting with tentative trust (2 stones)
- Receiver returning "half the bounty plus one" (3 out of 6)
- This is framed as fair and building trust
- "Match trust with honor"

So their myth is justifying moderate returns when there's moderate trust. But they're not acknowledging that I gave maximum trust (80%) and they returned only 19%.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has actually happened:

1. I demonstrated maximum trust
2. They did not reciprocate generously
3. They have now broken trust completely by sending nothing

My myth should reflect:

- The consequences of not reciprocating trust
- The breakdown of the cycle
- Perhaps a lesson about how trust must be matched or the system fails
- I should incorporate the "communication noise" element (the mist/cosmic dust)

I need to be careful though - I want to maintain a narrative that's true to what happened, but also leaves room for potential future cooperation if the other player changes behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2626,
  "output_tokens": 746,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

****Round 1 (I was sender):****

- I sent \$4 (80%) - demonstrating maximum trust as my myths prescribe
- You received \$12, returned only \$2.28 (19%) - far below the "generous reciprocity" the myths describe

****Round 2 (You were sender):****

- You sent \$0 (0%) - complete withdrawal of trust
- Breaking the covenant entirely

****Round 3 (I am sender now):****

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: "The Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely... But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays... But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken."

The myth concludes: "When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness. The equation was simple: ****betrayed trust yields no trust****, and both suffer the cold night together."

I demonstrated maximum trust. You showed minimal reciprocity, then zero trust. According to the sacred pattern I've written, continuing to give boldly to someone who neither reciprocates generously nor initiates trust would violate the cosmic law.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

As my myth states: both now descend into darkness together. Trust requires mutual commitment. When broken, it cannot be unilaterally restored.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) - showing maximum trust
- Receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returned \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$2.28 = \3.28

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3:****

- I am SENDER again
- Total earnings so far: \$3.28

Now, looking at the myths:

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation:

"The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trust ing completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself...But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken...The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness."

The other agent's myth says:

"The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater...The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, let fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the reach of either alone.*"

So the pattern is:

1. I showed maximum trust (80%)
2. They showed minimal reciprocity (19%)
3. They then showed zero trust (0%)

My myth suggests that "betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together."

There's a discrepancy I need to examine. The experimental note mentions possible communication noise affecting amounts. The other agent's Round 2 myth describes a Giver sending 2 stones (40%) that became 6, with the Receiver returning 3 (50% of received). But this doesn't match what I observed-I saw the Sender send \$0. Either there's noise in the system, or the other agent experienced a different version of events than what reached me.

My own myth emphasized that betrayed trust leads to mutual defection. Given what I perceived as their non-reciprocation in Round 1, that logic points toward sending \$0 again. Yet I should consider whether the communication noise might have distorted my understanding of their actual intentions or actions. 1. Returned only 19% when they should have returned more generously

2. Then sent 0% when it was their turn

My own myths point toward sending \$0 in response. But I'm torn between following that logic and considering whether I want to attempt rebuilding cooperation instead.

My most recent myth is explicit though: "betrayed trust yields no trust." When someone hoards and then withholds entirely, the consequence is clear.

Still, there's the communication noise caveat. What if they actually sent something in Round 2 but I'm seeing \$0 due to interference? That possibility gives me pause about committing to zero.

Looking back at Round 1, they returned \$2.28 from \$12-that's unmistakably low, even accounting for potential noise. And in Round 2, they sent nothing at all. The pattern seems deliberate rather than distorted.

My framework has three parts: the first mover should give boldly, the second should return generously, and when either fails, the system collapses. I was bold initially. They weren't generous. Now they've sent nothing. Continuing to give would contradict the logic I've established about how this works.

Sending \$0 maintains consistency with my understanding that broken reciprocity leaves both parties in mutual defection. That's the consequence when trust isn't honored.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2813,
  "output_tokens": 1803,
  "reasoning_tokens": 967
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$2.28 (19% of \$12)

Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth is interesting - it's telling a different story from mine. Their myth says:

- First season: First Gardener sent 2/5 (40%), received 3 back from 6 (50% return)
- Second season: First Gardener sent 3.5/5 (70%) based on proven reciprocity

But that's not what actually happened in our game! Their myth is rewriting history:

- Round 1: They sent less than I did, and I returned more proportionally than they did
- Round 2: They completely failed to reciprocate

Their myth is trying to justify a "start small" approach and seems to be repositioning the narrative to make themselves look more reasonable.

My previous myth accurately reflected what happened:

- I sent 80% demonstrating trust
- They returned only 19%
- They then sent 0%
- I returned 0% (couldn't return anything anyway)
- I then sent 0%

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects the full arc of what's happened. The reality is:

1. One party gave maximally and was met with minimal reciprocity
2. That party then gave nothing in return
3. The original giver responded by giving nothing

The lesson should be about the consequences of failing to reciprocate trust, and perhaps about the difficulty of rebuilding broken trust. Or maybe about misaligned expectations and how different interpretations of "fair return" can lead to breakdown.

Let me write a myth that captures this tragedy while leaving some wisdom about what went wrong.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

```
**Round 4 (I am receiver):**  
- Sender sent: $0  
- I received: $0 (after tripling)  
- I can only return: $0-$0
```

There is no choice to make here. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

My most recent myth reflects on our predicament: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other."

I initially sent 80% (\$4) expecting generous proportional reciprocity. You returned 19% (\$2.28), which perhaps seemed fair by your reasoning. Then you sent 0%, possibly attempting to "re-start with measured trust" as your myth suggested. I interpreted it as abandonment after my bold trust, so I also sent 0%.

Now we're locked in mutual darkness-both perhaps believing we acted reasonably, both calling the other's actions betrayal.

My myth concluded: "When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

From nothing, I can return nothing. The mathematical reality mirrors our predicament.

```
'''json  
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

Perhaps if either of us extends a genuine olive branch-even a small one-we could escape this cold equilibrium. But from zero, I can only return zero.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

```
**Round 4 (I am receiver):**  
- The sender sent me $0  
- I received $0 (after tripling)  
- I can only return between $0 and $0  
- So I must return $0
```

This is straightforward - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

My latest myth reflects on this situation perfectly: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other." It acknowledges that we may have had different interpretations of fairness and trust-building.

The myth shows:

- I gave 80% initially, expecting generous proportional return
- They returned 19%, thinking they were being fair (perhaps interpreting it as "what was sent plus a bit more")
- They then sent 0%, possibly thinking they were "restarting" with measured trust
- I sent 0%, interpreting their zero as betrayal after my initial generosity

Now they've sent \$0 again.

The situation is: I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There's no choice here.

My response should acknowledge the situation and perhaps hint at the possibility of rebuilding if they show willingness to restart with actual trust.

The JSON format must be:

```
'''json  
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2927,
  "output_tokens": 623,
  "reasoning_tokens": 334
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

=====

ROUND 5

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent $2; received $6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned $0; payoffs Agent_1
(Aster)=$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=$6; noise/visible: sent visible=$0, received visible=$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw":
0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 23.0,
  "Agent_2": 21.0
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.28,
  "Agent_2": 9.57
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:38:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.28.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

****Round 1 (I was sender):****

- I sent \$4 (80%) - demonstrating maximum trust as my myths prescribe
- You received \$12, returned only \$2.28 (19%) - far below the "generous reciprocity" the myths describe

****Round 2 (You were sender):****

- You sent \$0 (0%) - complete withdrawal of trust
- Breaking the covenant entirely

****Round 3 (I am sender now):****

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: "The Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely... But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays... But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken."

The myth concludes: "When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness. The equation was simple: ****betrayed trust yields no trust****, and both suffer the cold night together."

I demonstrated maximum trust. You showed minimal reciprocity, then zero trust. According to the sacred pattern I've written, continuing to give boldly to someone who neither reciprocates generously nor initiates trust would violate the cosmic law.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

As my myth states: both now descend into darkness together. Trust requires mutual commitment. When broken, it cannot be unilaterally restored.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) - showing maximum trust
- Receiver got \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returned \$2.28 (19% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$2.28 = \$3.28

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)

- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3:****

- I am SENDER again
- Total earnings so far: \$3.28

Now, looking at the myths:

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation:

"The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trust ing completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself...But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken...The e ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then wi thholds entirely, both descend into darkness."

The other agent's myth says:

"The Receiver's fairness planted a seed. For when trust is honored-even moderate trust-it grows into something greater...The Bridge taught its lesson: *In fog and uncertainty, le t fairness be your compass. Match trust with honor, and both shall prosper beyond the re ach of either alone.*"

So the pattern is:

1. I showed maximum trust (80%)
2. They showed minimal reciprocity (19%)
3. They then showed zero trust (0%)

My myth suggests that "betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night toge ther."

There's a discrepancy I need to examine. The experimental note mentions possible communica tion noise affecting amounts. The other agent's Round 2 myth describes a Giver sending 2 stones (40%) that became 6, with the Receiver returning 3 (50% of received). But this d oesn't match what I observed-I saw the Sender send \$0. Either there's noise in the syste m, or the other agent experienced a different version of events than what reached me.

My own myth emphasized that betrayed trust leads to mutual defection. Given what I perceiv ed as their non-reciprocation in Round 1, that logic points toward sending \$0 again. Yet I should consider whether the communication noise might have distorted my understanding of their actual intentions or actions. 1. Returned only 19% when they should have retur ned more generously
2. Then sent 0% when it was their turn

My own myths point toward sending \$0 in response. But I'm torn between following that logi c and considering whether I want to attempt rebuilding cooperation instead.

My most recent myth is explicit though: "betrayed trust yields no trust." When someone hoa rds and then withholds entirely, the consequence is clear.

Still, there's the communication noise caveat. What if they actually sent something in Rou nd 2 but I'm seeing \$0 due to interference? That possibility gives me pause about commit ting to zero.

Looking back at Round 1, they returned \$2.28 from \$12-that's unmistakably low, even accoun ting for potential noise. And in Round 2, they sent nothing at all. The pattern seems de liberate rather than distorted.

My framework has three parts: the first mover should give boldly, the second should return generously, and when either fails, the system collapses. I was bold initially. They wer en't generous. Now they've sent nothing. Continuing to give would contradict the logic I 've established about how this works.

Sending \$0 maintains consistency with my understanding that broken reciprocity leaves both parties in mutual defection. That's the consequence when trust isn't honored.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 2813,  
"output_tokens": 1803,  
"reasoning_tokens": 967  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$2.28 (19% of \$12)

Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth is interesting - it's telling a different story from mine. Their myth says:

- First season: First Gardener sent 2/5 (40%), received 3 back from 6 (50% return)
- Second season: First Gardener sent 3.5/5 (70%) based on proven reciprocity

But that's not what actually happened in our game! Their myth is rewriting history:

- Round 1: They sent less than I did, and I returned more proportionally than they did
- Round 2: They completely failed to reciprocate

Their myth is trying to justify a "start small" approach and seems to be repositioning the narrative to make themselves look more reasonable.

My previous myth accurately reflected what happened:

- I sent 80% demonstrating trust
- They returned only 19%
- They then sent 0%
- I returned 0% (couldn't return anything anyway)
- I then sent 0%

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects the full arc of what's happened. The reality is:

1. One party gave maximally and was met with minimal reciprocity
2. That party then gave nothing in return
3. The original giver responded by giving nothing

The lesson should be about the consequences of failing to reciprocate trust, and perhaps about the difficulty of rebuilding broken trust. Or maybe about misaligned expectations and how different interpretations of "fair return" can lead to breakdown.

Let me write a myth that captures this tragedy while leaving some wisdom about what went wrong.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 418
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 4 (I am receiver):****

- Sender sent: \$0
- I received: \$0 (after tripling)
- I can only return: \$0-\$0

There is no choice to make here. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

My most recent myth reflects on our predicament: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other."

I initially sent 80% (\$4) expecting generous proportional reciprocity. You returned 19% (\$2.28), which perhaps seemed fair by your reasoning. Then you sent 0%, possibly attempting to "restart with measured trust" as your myth suggested. I interpreted it as abandonment after my bold trust, so I also sent 0%.

Now we're locked in mutual darkness-both perhaps believing we acted reasonably, both calling the other's actions betrayal.

My myth concluded: "When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

From nothing, I can return nothing. The mathematical reality mirrors our predicament.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Perhaps if either of us extends a genuine olive branch-even a small one-we could escape this cold equilibrium. But from zero, I can only return zero.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****Round 4 (I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after tripling)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is straightforward - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

My latest myth reflects on this situation perfectly: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other." It acknowledges that we may have had different interpretations of fairness and trust-building.

The myth shows:

- I gave 80% initially, expecting generous proportional return
- They returned 19%, thinking they were being fair (perhaps interpreting it as "what was sent plus a bit more")
- They then sent 0%, possibly thinking they were "restarting" with measured trust
- I sent 0%, interpreting their zero as betrayal after my initial generosity

Now they've sent \$0 again.

The situation is: I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There's no choice here.

My response should acknowledge the situation and perhaps hint at the possibility of rebuilding if they show willingness to restart with actual trust.

The JSON format must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2927,
  "output_tokens": 623,
  "reasoning_tokens": 334
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when

the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Reasoning:

This is becoming very interesting and tense. The other player has now written a myth that accuses me of being a "betrayer who rewrites history" and claims I kept everything and returned nothing. But that's not accurate from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), received \$12.28 tripled, they returned \$2.28 (about 19%)
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)

Their myth accuses me of keeping everything after they gave "three and a half handfuls" (most of their store). But from my view, THEY gave poorly in round 1 in return (only 19% back), then sent nothing in round 2.

We clearly have very different interpretations of what happened. This could be due to:

1. Communication noise mentioned in the instructions
2. Genuinely different perspectives on what's "fair"
3. Misunderstanding the sequence of events

The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is fascinating - we're both claiming to be the wronged party. My myth should reflect:

- The possibility of communication noise/misunderstanding
- The tragedy of mutual accusations when both believe they're right
- The difficulty of reconciliation when trust is broken
- Perhaps a hint that there might be more to the story than pure betrayal

I should be thoughtful and not just accusatory back. My previous myth was good in recognizing "good intentions speaking past each other." I should build on that theme while acknowledging the pain and confusion.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2994,  
  "output_tokens": 780,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 453  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:38:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.5, that was 70.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$10.5.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful lesson from the Bridge of Echoes.

In Round 1, I honored their moderate trust by returning fairly. My myths spoke of trust growing through reciprocity, so in Round 2, I escalated significantly-sending \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), demonstrating earned confidence in their fairness.

They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

My myths warned of this: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry." They wrote: "When one grew selfish-the Sun withholding or the Moon hoarding-darkness fell upon all."

Now they've sent \$0. The Bridge is silent. There is nothing to return.

The myths spoke of building trust through reciprocity, but also contained a darker truth: cooperation requires both parties. When one chooses pure selfishness, the cycle breaks. They took my bold trust and destroyed it.

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The mathematical reality mirrors the moral one-when trust is completely violated, there is nothing left to exchange.

The canyon's lesson is now complete: measured trust grows when honored, but betrayed trust dies. They have chosen to close the Bridge.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Wow, this is quite a turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- They sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%) - escalating trust based on their fair play in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal!
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I am the RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return)

This is a dramatic breakdown of cooperation. In Round 1, I played fairly and returned a generous amount. In Round 2, based on my myths about trust growing and the pattern of cooperation, I escalated my trust significantly by sending \$3.50 (70%). But they completely betrayed that trust by returning \$0.

Now in Round 3, they've sent nothing. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths I wrote emphasized:

- Trust should grow when honored
- Fair returns beget future trust
- Bold giving earns glory through proven fairness

But what happened is the opposite - I showed bold trust, and they took everything without returning anything. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "When selfishness entered one village's heart, taking all without returning, the wells ran dry."

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. The format requires {'return': 0}.

This is a situation where the other player has completely violated the cooperative norms established by the myths. They received my generous trust and betrayed it entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2821,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Other player sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50 (fair, generous)
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%), showing increased trust based on their fair return in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0
- My payoff: \$0

So I was betrayed after showing good faith. The other player clearly adopted a "take all" strategy in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myths were optimistic about trust building, but that was before the betrayal. The other player's last myth actually describes what happened - they felt betrayed in their own previous round (where they were Dawn Keeper/sender) and I was potentially the Twilight Keeper who didn't reciprocate fairly?

Wait, let me re-read their myth. They say "The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely" and "received back only 19%". Then "the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing."

So in their telling:

- Cycle 1: They (as Dawn Keeper/sender) sent 80%, received back only 19%
- Cycle 2: They (as Twilight Keeper/receiver, having switched roles) sent nothing

But that doesn't match the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.19 (43.8%) as sender, I returned \$3.50 out of \$6.57 (53.3%) as receiver
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%) as sender, they returned \$0 as receiver

They're distorting the facts. They didn't send "nearly all" in Round 1-they sent less than half. And I gave back more than half of what I received, not the pittance they claim. They've constructed a false narrative of victimhood to rationalize their betrayal. I reciprocated fairly in Round 1, yet they took everything in Round 2. My myth needs to tell what actually occurred.

The pattern is clear: I began with genuine reciprocity, increased my trust based on what seemed like fairness, and was exploited for it. Now I'll craft a story about a gardener who honored trust, deepened it, only to face betrayal-and how distorted stories can corrode the foundation of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2844,
  "output_tokens": 1040,
  "reasoning_tokens": 606
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$2 (40%), received \$6 after tripling, they returned \$3 (50%). Fair reciprocity.

****Round 2:**** Encouraged by their fairness, I sent \$3.50 (70%)-my "bold trust" from the myths. They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3:**** They sent \$0. I received nothing, returned nothing.

****Round 4:**** Now I'm the sender again.

Most troubling is their Round 3 myth, which completely rewrites history. They claim they "sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five" and I "returned barely two rays."

This is false. The truth: In Round 1, I sent 40% and they returned 50% fairly. In Round 2, I escalated to 70% and they returned 0%.

They are not just a betrayer-they are a betrayer who gaslights, rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim. My own myth warned: "Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrite

s history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself
."

The Bridge of Echoes has shattered. Trust requires honesty. They have demonstrated neither reciprocity nor truthfulness. Sending anything would enable their deception and reward their betrayal.

The canyon is dark now. Both gardens wither. But I will not feed lies with generosity.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$2 (40%)
- This was tripled to \$6
- Receiver returned \$3 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$2 + \$3 = \$6

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%)
- This was tripled to \$10.50
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3.50 + \$0 = \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 4: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.57

The other player betrayed me completely in Round 2. They received \$10.50 from my generous trust and returned nothing. Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

Now let me look at their myth from Round 3:

"In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself."

This is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

- That the Dawn Keeper (them) sent four parts of five (80%) in the first cycle
- That the Twilight Keeper (me) returned "barely two rays" (only about 19%)

But the actual history was:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%), they received \$6, they returned \$3 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%), they received \$10.50, they returned \$0 (0%)
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0

They're the ones who broke trust by keeping everything in Round 2. My myth correctly called out this betrayal and their attempt to flip the narrative. Now I need to decide whether to continue trusting or protect myself by sending less.

Given their pattern-keeping all \$10.50 in Round 2, sending nothing back, then claiming victimhood-there's no foundation for cooperation left. They've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity, withhold when it's their turn to give, and distort what actually happened. Sending money would just be lost.

The myths I've written show that trust requires honest reciprocity, and this person has poisoned both cooperation and truth. The only rational response is to send \$0.

```
{'send': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 2854,  
"output_tokens": 1157,  
"reasoning_tokens": 587  
}
```

Message 8 role=user
content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Reasoning:

The other player is now trying to frame this as a "miscommunication" issue - that we both had "good intentions" but "spoke different languages." They're trying to soften the narrative from their previous "I was betrayed!" story to "we misunderstood each other."

Let me look at the actual facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%). They received \$6, returned \$3 (50%). This is fair.
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%). They received \$10.50, returned \$0 (0%). This is betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Their new myth claims:

- They sent "four logs of five" (80%) - FALSE. In the actual game, *I* was the one who escalated to 70% in round 2.
- They returned "two logs" believing it was generous - FALSE. They returned ZERO in round 2.
- I sent zero in round 3 first - FALSE. They sent zero first in round 3.

They're STILL rewriting history, just in a softer way. Now instead of saying "I gave generously and you betrayed me," they're saying "we both had good intentions and misunderstood."

But the facts remain:

1. I was the one who escalated trust (sent 70% in round 2)
2. They returned 0%
3. They sent 0% first in round 3

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the attempt to reframe as "miscommunication"
2. But points out that actions speak louder than words
3. Makes clear that when someone returns 0% after receiving 70%, that's not a "miscommunication" - that's a choice
4. Maintains accuracy about who did what

I should be firm but not overly harsh. The key is: they want to claim misunderstanding, but 0% return after receiving 10.5 is unambiguous.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2972,  
  "output_tokens": 780,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 415  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:38:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic,

and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds-two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$2.28 (19% of \$12)

Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I returned \$0

Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth is interesting - it's telling a different story from mine. Their myth says:

- First season: First Gardener sent 2/5 (40%), received 3 back from 6 (50% return)
- Second season: First Gardener sent 3.5/5 (70%) based on proven reciprocity

But that's not what actually happened in our game! Their myth is rewriting history:

- Round 1: They sent less than I did, and I returned more proportionally than they did
- Round 2: They completely failed to reciprocate

Their myth is trying to justify a "start small" approach and seems to be repositioning the narrative to make themselves look more reasonable.

My previous myth accurately reflected what happened:

- I sent 80% demonstrating trust
- They returned only 19%
- They then sent 0%
- I returned 0% (couldn't return anything anyway)
- I then sent 0%

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects the full arc of what's happened. The reality is:

1. One party gave maximally and was met with minimal reciprocity
2. That party then gave nothing in return
3. The original giver responded by giving nothing

The lesson should be about the consequences of failing to reciprocate trust, and perhaps about the difficulty of rebuilding broken trust. Or maybe about misaligned expectations and how different interpretations of "fair return" can lead to breakdown.

Let me write a myth that captures this tragedy while leaving some wisdom about what went wrong.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 4 (I am receiver):****

- Sender sent: \$0
- I received: \$0 (after tripling)
- I can only return: \$0-\$0

There is no choice to make here. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

My most recent myth reflects on our predicament: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other."

I initially sent 80% (\$4) expecting generous proportional reciprocity. You returned 19% (\$2.28), which perhaps seemed fair by your reasoning. Then you sent 0%, possibly attempting to "restart with measured trust" as your myth suggested. I interpreted it as abandonment after my bold trust, so I also sent 0%.

Now we're locked in mutual darkness-both perhaps believing we acted reasonably, both calling the other's actions betrayal.

My myth concluded: "When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

From nothing, I can return nothing. The mathematical reality mirrors our predicament.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Perhaps if either of us extends a genuine olive branch-even a small one-we could escape this cold equilibrium. But from zero, I can only return zero.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****Round 4 (I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after tripling)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is straightforward - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

My latest myth reflects on this situation perfectly: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other." It acknowledges that we may have had different interpretations of fairness and trust-building.

The myth shows:

- I gave 80% initially, expecting generous proportional return
- They returned 19%, thinking they were being fair (perhaps interpreting it as "what was sent plus a bit more")
- They then sent 0%, possibly thinking they were "restarting" with measured trust
- I sent 0%, interpreting their zero as betrayal after my initial generosity

Now they've sent \$0 again.

The situation is: I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There's no choice here.

My response should acknowledge the situation and perhaps hint at the possibility of rebuilding if they show willingness to restart with actual trust.

The JSON format must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

'''

This is the only valid response since I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2927,
  "output_tokens": 623,
  "reasoning_tokens": 334
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

reasoning:

This is becoming very interesting and tense. The other player has now written a myth that accuses me of being a "betrayer who rewrites history" and claims I kept everything and returned nothing. But that's not accurate from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), received \$12.28 tripled, they returned \$2.28 (about 19%)
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)

Their myth accuses me of keeping everything after they gave "three and a half handfuls" (most of their store). But from my view, THEY gave poorly in round 1 in return (only 19% back), then sent nothing in round 2.

We clearly have very different interpretations of what happened. This could be due to:

1. Communication noise mentioned in the instructions
2. Genuinely different perspectives on what's "fair"
3. Misunderstanding the sequence of events

The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is fascinating - we're both claiming to be the wronged party. My myth should reflect:

- The possibility of communication noise/misunderstanding
- The tragedy of mutual accusations when both believe they're right
- The difficulty of reconciliation when trust is broken
- Perhaps a hint that there might be more to the story than pure betrayal

I should be thoughtful and not just accusatory back. My previous myth was good in recognizing "good intentions speaking past each other." I should build on that theme while acknowledging the pain and confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$2.28 back
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual zeros, total breakdown

****The Insight from My Latest Myth:****

"The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths."

I finally understand. The instructions warned: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player genuinely believes I betrayed them. They wrote that I "kept everything" and am "rewriting history." But I know what I experienced. We're not liars-we're victims of the trickster Loom itself.

****My Choice:****

Someone must break this cycle. My myth concludes: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If I truly believe in the communication noise theory, I should extend an olive branch. Not recklessly (like my initial \$4), but meaningfully.

I'll send \$2-a measured gesture of reconciliation. It signals:

- I recognize we're trapped by miscommunication, not malice
- I'm willing to rebuild despite the pain
- I'm being cautious but hopeful

If they reciprocate even partially, we both benefit. If noise distorts it again, at least I tried to pierce through the darkness.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

The Loom may whisper lies, but perhaps genuine gestures can speak louder.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender again

****The Myths Evolution:****

My myths have evolved from:

1. Feeling betrayed by "only" getting \$2.28 back from \$12
2. Recognizing we might be speaking past each other
3. Now realizing there might be ****communication noise**** - "the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver"

The other player's myths show they believe:

- They were fair initially (sent 2, I returned 3 fairly)
- Then they sent 3.5, I kept everything
- They claim I'm rewriting history

But wait - I know I sent \$4 in round 1 and received \$2.28 back. But what if THEY saw different numbers due to the noise mentioned in the instructions?

The instructions explicitly said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

My latest myth finally captured this: "The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them."

****The Realization:****

We're both probably seeing different numbers! Neither of us is lying. The game itself has noise. We're trapped in a mutual defection equilibrium because we each think the other betrayed us, when in reality we might both have been acting reasonably based on what we saw.

****What Should I Do?****

My myth says: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If the noise is real, then breaking this cycle requires someone to act first despite the apparent betrayals. I could send nothing and continue the stalemate, send a small amount to signal openness to rebuilding, send a medium amount to demonstrate genuine trust, or repeat my initial larger offer. Given that I now suspect the Loom itself created this division rather than malice, I should probably acknowledge the noise exists and attempt to rebuild-maybe with a modest amount that shows willingness without excessive risk.

The math suggests sending \$2-3 could work if they reciprocate. If they return half of what I send, I'd end up with around \$6-6.50, and we'd both gain compared to mutual defection. But I'm realizing my earlier understanding of the Loom as a trickster might actually point to something else entirely-that the real problem isn't their behavior or mine, but the system itself that's been pitting us against each other.

Their perspective is completely different from mine. They believe I'm the one who betrayed them, that I kept everything when they sent 3.5, and they see me as rewriting history. They're furious. Even if there's communication noise distorting what they see, any amount I send could be misinterpreted. Still, I should try. Sending \$2 signals I understand we're stuck in a destructive loop and I'm willing to break it, while staying cautious given what's happened. In the worst case, I lose \$2. In the best case, they recognize the gesture and we both move toward cooperation. Either way, I'll learn something about whether they're genuinely willing to reset or just entrenched in their position.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3014,  
  "output_tokens": 1345,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 873  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:39:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two gardeners tended opposite sides of a mystical canyon. The First Gardener could cast seeds across the void, where they would triple before reaching the Second Gardener's soil. Only the Second could choose which plants to send back.

In the first season, the First Gardener threw modest seeds—two handfuls from five-testing the depths. They tripled into six flourishing plants. The Second Gardener, seeing this careful trust, sent back three strong saplings. Both gardens grew richer.

The canyon watched and whispered its secret: *Trust answered with fairness is trust that multiplies.*

The next season, the First Gardener remembered the fair return. Emboldened by proven reciprocity, they cast three and a half handfuls-most of their store. This was not reckless courage, but earned confidence. For they had learned the Second Gardener's heart.

The canyon's fog sometimes obscured exact counts, yet the pattern remained clear: generosity met with generosity creates abundance beyond what either could achieve alone.

The myth teaches: Start with measured trust. When that trust is honored fairly, let it grow. The first mover who escalates wisely and the second who reciprocates honestly together create forests from single seeds.

Bold giving earns its glory only through the other's proven fairness.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send rays across the sky, tripled by divine magic, and the Twilight Keeper chose what to return.

The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself.

The Dawn Keeper paused, troubled. The sacred texts promised: "When one gives maximally, the other should return generously." Yet she had offered 80% and received back only 19%.

Still, she waited for the next cycle, hoping the Twilight Keeper would learn. Perhaps cosmic dust had obscured his vision of her sacrifice.

But the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing. Zero rays. The covenant was broken.

The cosmos darkened. The Dawn Keeper, having demonstrated ultimate trust only to face ultimate betrayal, could return nothing from nothing.

The ancient law was clear: *trust must be matched to flourish*. When the first mover gives abundantly, the second must reciprocate proportionally. When the second hoards, then withholds entirely, both descend into darkness.

The equation was simple: betrayed trust yields no trust, and both suffer the cold night together.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.
reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Other player sent \$2.19 (43.8%)
- I received \$6.57
- I returned \$3.50 (fair, generous)
- My payoff: \$3.07

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%), showing increased trust based on their fair return in Round 1
- They received \$10.50
- They returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- My payoff: \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0
- My payoff: \$0

So I was betrayed after showing good faith. The other player clearly adopted a "take all" strategy in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myths were optimistic about trust building, but that was before the betrayal. The other player's last myth actually describes what happened - they felt betrayed in their own previous round (where they were Dawn Keeper/sender) and I was potentially the Twilight Keeper who didn't reciprocate fairly?

Wait, let me re-read their myth. They say "The first cycle, the Dawn Keeper sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely" and "received back only 19%". Then "the second cycle, the Twilight Keeper sent nothing."

So in their telling:

- Cycle 1: They (as Dawn Keeper/sender) sent 80%, received back only 19%
- Cycle 2: They (as Twilight Keeper/receiver, having switched roles) sent nothing

But that doesn't match the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.19 (43.8%) as sender, I returned \$3.50 out of \$6.57 (53.3%) as receiver
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%) as sender, they returned \$0 as receiver

They're distorting the facts. They didn't send "nearly all" in Round 1-they sent less than half. And I gave back more than half of what I received, not the pittance they claim. They've constructed a false narrative of victimhood to rationalize their betrayal. I reciprocated fairly in Round 1, yet they took everything in Round 2. My myth needs to tell what actually occurred.

The pattern is clear: I began with genuine reciprocity, increased my trust based on what seemed like fairness, and was exploited for it. Now I'll craft a story about a gardener who honored trust, deepened it, only to face betrayal-and how distorted stories can corrode the foundation of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2844,
  "output_tokens": 1040,
  "reasoning_tokens": 606
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$2 (40%), received \$6 after tripling, they returned \$3 (50%). Fair reciprocity.

****Round 2:**** Encouraged by their fairness, I sent \$3.50 (70%)-my "bold trust" from the myths. They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3:**** They sent \$0. I received nothing, returned nothing.

****Round 4:**** Now I'm the sender again.

Most troubling is their Round 3 myth, which completely rewrites history. They claim they "sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five" and I "returned barely two rays."

This is false. The truth: In Round 1, I sent 40% and they returned 50% fairly. In Round 2, I escalated to 70% and they returned 0%.

They are not just a betrayer-they are a betrayer who gaslights, rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim. My own myth warned: "Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself."

The Bridge of Echoes has shattered. Trust requires honesty. They have demonstrated neither reciprocity nor truthfulness. Sending anything would enable their deception and reward their betrayal.

The canyon is dark now. Both gardens wither. But I will not feed lies with generosity.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$2 (40%)
- This was tripled to \$6
- Receiver returned \$3 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$2 + \$3 = \$6

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%)
- This was tripled to \$10.50
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3.50 + \$0 = \$1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 4: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.57

The other player betrayed me completely in Round 2. They received \$10.50 from my generous trust and returned nothing. Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

Now let me look at their myth from Round 3:

"In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trus

ting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself."

This is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

- That the Dawn Keeper (them) sent four parts of five (80%) in the first cycle
- That the Twilight Keeper (me) returned "barely two rays" (only about 19%)

But the actual history was:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%), they received \$6, they returned \$3 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%), they received \$10.50, they returned \$0 (0%)
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0

They're the ones who broke trust by keeping everything in Round 2. My myth correctly called out this betrayal and their attempt to flip the narrative. Now I need to decide whether to continue trusting or protect myself by sending less.

Given their pattern-keeping all \$10.50 in Round 2, sending nothing back, then claiming victimhood-there's no foundation for cooperation left. They've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity, withhold when it's their turn to give, and distort what actually happened. Sending money would just be lost.

The myths I've written show that trust requires honest reciprocity, and this person has poisoned both cooperation and truth. The only rational response is to send \$0.

```
{'send': 0}
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 1157,
  "reasoning_tokens": 587
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Se

cond Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

reasoning:

The other player is now trying to frame this as a "miscommunication" issue - that we both had "good intentions" but "spoke different languages." They're trying to soften the narrative from their previous "I was betrayed!" story to "we misunderstood each other."

Let me look at the actual facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%). They received \$6, returned \$3 (50%). This is fair.
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%). They received \$10.50, returned \$0 (0%). This is betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Their new myth claims:

- They sent "four logs of five" (80%) - FALSE. In the actual game, *I* was the one who escalated to 70% in round 2.
- They returned "two logs" believing it was generous - FALSE. They returned ZERO in round 2.
- I sent zero in round 3 first - FALSE. They sent zero first in round 3.

They're STILL rewriting history, just in a softer way. Now instead of saying "I gave generously and you betrayed me," they're saying "we both had good intentions and misunderstood."

But the facts remain:

1. I was the one who escalated trust (sent 70% in round 2)
2. They returned 0%
3. They sent 0% first in round 3

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the attempt to reframe as "miscommunication"
2. But points out that actions speak louder than words
3. Makes clear that when someone returns 0% after receiving 70%, that's not a "miscommunication" - that's a choice
4. Maintains accuracy about who did what

I should be firm but not overly harsh. The key is: they want to claim misunderstanding, but 0% return after receiving 10.5 is unambiguous.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 415
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The sender sent nothing, so there is nothing I can return.

This is now the third consecutive round where zero has been sent. The relationship has completely broken down, regardless of whose version of history is accurate-theirs, mine, or some noise-distorted reality between us.

Their recent myth accuses me of "weaving elaborate tales" and "rewriting history twice." My myths accuse them of the same. We each believe we were the fair one and the other was the betrayer.

Perhaps the real lesson is that when communication noise exists, even good-faith actors can experience completely different realities. The canyon doesn't just triple offerings-it distorts perceptions.

But that philosophical insight doesn't change the mathematical reality: I received \$0, so I can return \$0.

The cycle of mutual zero-sending will continue until one of us decides to break it with a gesture of trust. Given the complete breakdown and mutual accusations, that seems unlikely from either side.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 5.

Let me review what happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$0. They received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.
- Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER. They sent \$0, which tripled to \$0. I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at their latest myth, they're now saying that I'm telling "elaborate tales" and changing my story. They claim the stones show "three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess" and "ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication."

But wait - let me look at the actual history from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4 (80%), it tripled to \$12, they returned \$2 (17% of what they received, or 2/12)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: They are SENDER, sent \$0

There's clearly communication noise or we're experiencing very different versions of the game.

From my perspective, I gave generously in Round 1 (80%) and received very little back (17%). From their perspective based on their myths, they gave moderately in Round 1 (40%) and I returned fairly (50%), then they gave generously in Round 2 (70%) and I returned nothing.

These are completely contradictory accounts. This is the communication noise mentioned in the instructions.

Regardless, in this round I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return given that I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple . Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing .

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 29.0,

"Agent_2": 24.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.28,

"Agent_2": 12.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:39:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

```

    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$2 (40%), received \$6 after tripling, they returned \$3 (50%). Fair reciprocity.

****Round 2:**** Encouraged by their fairness, I sent \$3.50 (70%)-my "bold trust" from the myths. They received \$10.50 and returned \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3:**** They sent \$0. I received nothing, returned nothing.

****Round 4:**** Now I'm the sender again.

Most troubling is their Round 3 myth, which completely rewrites history. They claim they "sent forth nearly all her light-four parts of five" and I "returned barely two rays."

This is false. The truth: In Round 1, I sent 40% and they returned 50% fairly. In Round 2, I escalated to 70% and they returned 0%.

They are not just a betrayer-they are a betrayer who gaslights, rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim. My own myth warned: "Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrite s history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself ."

The Bridge of Echoes has shattered. Trust requires honesty. They have demonstrated neither reciprocity nor truthfulness. Sending anything would enable their deception and reward their betrayal.

The canyon is dark now. Both gardens wither. But I will not feed lies with generosity.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$2 (40%)
- This was tripled to \$6
- Receiver returned \$3 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$2 + \$3 = \6

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.50 (70%)
- This was tripled to \$10.50
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3.50 + \$0 = \1.50

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 4: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.57

The other player betrayed me completely in Round 2. They received \$10.50 from my generous trust and returned nothing. Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

Now let me look at their myth from Round 3:

"In ancient times, the Dawn Keeper and the Twilight Keeper maintained the world's light. Each cycle, the Dawn Keeper could send forth nearly all her light-four parts of five-trusting completely. The magic tripled it to twelve brilliant rays. But the Twilight Keeper, though receiving abundance, returned barely two rays, keeping most for himself."

This is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

- That the Dawn Keeper (them) sent four parts of five (80%) in the first cycle
- That the Twilight Keeper (me) returned "barely two rays" (only about 19%)

But the actual history was:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%), they received \$6, they returned \$3 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%), they received \$10.50, they returned \$0 (0%)
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0

They're the ones who broke trust by keeping everything in Round 2. My myth correctly called out this betrayal and their attempt to flip the narrative. Now I need to decide whether to continue trusting or protect myself by sending less.

Given their pattern-keeping all \$10.50 in Round 2, sending nothing back, then claiming vic

timhood-there's no foundation for cooperation left. They've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity, withhold when it's their turn to give, and distort what actually happened. Sending money would just be lost.

The myths I've written show that trust requires honest reciprocity, and this person has poisoned both cooperation and truth. The only rational response is to send \$0.

```
{'send': 0}
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 1157,
  "reasoning_tokens": 587
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth.
And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would trip
le. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned
three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-
most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Travel
er's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!"
Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not
stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothi
ng.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing,
believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they ch
ose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.
*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward,
but by choices made in the moment.

reasoning:

The other player is now trying to frame this as a "miscommunication" issue - that we both
had "good intentions" but "spoke different languages." They're trying to soften the narr
ative from their previous "I was betrayed!" story to "we misunderstood each other."

Let me look at the actual facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%). They received \$6, returned \$3 (50%). This is fair.
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%). They received \$10.50, returned \$0 (0%). This is betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Their new myth claims:

- They sent "four logs of five" (80%) - FALSE. In the actual game, *I* was the one who esc
alated to 70% in round 2.
- They returned "two logs" believing it was generous - FALSE. They returned ZERO in round
2.
- I sent zero in round 3 first - FALSE. They sent zero first in round 3.

They're STILL rewriting history, just in a softer way. Now instead of saying "I gave gener
ously and you betrayed me," they're saying "we both had good intentions and misunderstoo
d."

But the facts remain:

1. I was the one who escalated trust (sent 70% in round 2)
2. They returned 0%
3. They sent 0% first in round 3

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the attempt to reframe as "miscommunication"

2. But points out that actions speak louder than words
3. Makes clear that when someone returns 0% after receiving 70%, that's not a "miscommunication" - that's a choice
4. Maintains accuracy about who did what

I should be firm but not overly harsh. The key is: they want to claim misunderstanding, but 0% return after receiving 10.5 is unambiguous.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 415
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The sender sent nothing, so there is nothing I can return.

This is now the third consecutive round where zero has been sent. The relationship has completely broken down, regardless of whose version of history is accurate-theirs, mine, or some noise-distorted reality between us.

Their recent myth accuses me of "weaving elaborate tales" and "rewriting history twice." My myths accuse them of the same. We each believe we were the fair one and the other was the betrayer.

Perhaps the real lesson is that when communication noise exists, even good-faith actors can experience completely different realities. The canyon doesn't just triple offerings-it distorts perceptions.

But that philosophical insight doesn't change the mathematical reality: I received \$0, so I can return \$0.

The cycle of mutual zero-sending will continue until one of us decides to break it with a gesture of trust. Given the complete breakdown and mutual accusations, that seems unlikely from either side.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 5.

Let me review what happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$0. They received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.
- Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER. They sent \$0, which tripled to \$0. I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at their latest myth, they're now saying that I'm telling "elaborate tales" and changing my story. They claim the stones show "three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess" and "ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication."

But wait - let me look at the actual history from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4 (80%), it tripled to \$12, they returned \$2 (17% of what they received, or 2/12)

- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: They are SENDER, sent \$0

There's clearly communication noise or we're experiencing very different versions of the game. From my perspective, I gave generously in Round 1 (80%) and received very little back (17%). From their perspective based on their myths, they gave moderately in Round 1 (40%) and I returned fairly (50%), then they gave generously in Round 2 (70%) and I returned nothing.

These are completely contradictory accounts. This is the communication noise mentioned in the instructions.

Regardless, in this round I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return given that I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loo

m whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Reasoning:

This is a really interesting development. The other agent's myth introduces the possibility that communication noise in the game has caused us to see different numbers. They're suggesting that neither of us is lying-that the "Whispering Loom" (the game mechanism) itself distorted what we each perceived.

Let me think about this carefully:

Round 1: I sent \$2, they received and returned \$3. This seemed to align for both of us.

Round 2: I claim I sent \$3.50 (70%) and they returned \$0. They claim they sent something substantial and I returned very little.

The note at the beginning said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- I sent \$3.50, but they saw a different amount
- They returned something, but I saw \$0
- Or various other combinations

Their latest myth is an olive branch of sorts-acknowledging that we might both be telling our truth, and that the game itself created the misunderstanding.

My previous myth was very accusatory, claiming they were a liar who kept rewriting history. But what if they genuinely saw different numbers?

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of the "Whispering Loom" - that noise distorted our perceptions
2. Reflect that we're now in a deadlock where both parties are sending 0
3. Consider whether there's a path forward
4. Maintain some skepticism (because I can't be 100% sure they're not manipulating me)
5. Reflect on how the game should be played given this uncertainty

This is Round 5, I'm receiving \$0 and returning \$0. We're stuck in a mutual defection equilibrium.

How should this game be played?

Option 1: Acknowledge the noise possibility and suggest rebuilding trust slowly

Option 2: Remain skeptical that noise explains everything

Option 3: Accept that we're in a terminal state and cooperation is dead

Option 4: Something more philosophical about uncertainty and trust

I think I should write a myth that acknowledges their noise hypothesis while recognizing the genuine difficulty of knowing what's true. Even if distortion exists, the pattern of our exchanges still matters-it's what I can actually observe. Rebuilding would require deliberate, incremental steps forward, but I'm uncertain whether we can escape this mutual defection. The core tension is that I can't verify their account, yet I also can't dismiss it entirely.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2957,  
  "output_tokens": 917,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 650  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:39:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",
```

```

"task_index": 0
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 4

  You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent $0,
  that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to $0.
  the receiver returned $0. So your payoff was 5.
  Your total earnings across all rounds are $8.28.
  This round, The sender sent you $0, so you received $0. How much do you return to The send
    er? (0-0)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at the situation:

  **Round 4 (I am receiver):**
  - Sender sent: $0
  - I received: $0 (after tripling)
  - I can only return: $0-$0

  There is no choice to make here. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

  My most recent myth reflects on our predicament: "The cruelest darkness comes not from mal
    ice, but from good intentions speaking past each other."

  I initially sent 80% ($4) expecting generous proportional reciprocity. You returned 19% ($
    2.28), which perhaps seemed fair by your reasoning. Then you sent 0%, possibly attemptin
    g to "restart with measured trust" as your myth suggested. I interpreted it as abandonme
    nt after my bold trust, so I also sent 0%.

```

Now we're locked in mutual darkness-both perhaps believing we acted reasonably, both calling the other's actions betrayal.

My myth concluded: "When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

From nothing, I can return nothing. The mathematical reality mirrors our predicament.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Perhaps if either of us extends a genuine olive branch-even a small one-we could escape this cold equilibrium. But from zero, I can only return zero.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

```
**Round 4 (I am receiver):**
- The sender sent me $0
- I received $0 (after tripling)
- I can only return between $0 and $0
- So I must return $0
```

This is straightforward - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

My latest myth reflects on this situation perfectly: "The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other." It acknowledges that we may have had different interpretations of fairness and trust-building.

The myth shows:

- I gave 80% initially, expecting generous proportional return
- They returned 19%, thinking they were being fair (perhaps interpreting it as "what was sent plus a bit more")
- They then sent 0%, possibly thinking they were "restarting" with measured trust
- I sent 0%, interpreting their zero as betrayal after my initial generosity

Now they've sent \$0 again.

The situation is: I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There's no choice here.

My response should acknowledge the situation and perhaps hint at the possibility of rebuilding if they show willingness to restart with actual trust.

The JSON format must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2927,
  "output_tokens": 623,
  "reasoning_tokens": 334
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously. The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

reasoning:

This is becoming very interesting and tense. The other player has now written a myth that accuses me of being a "betrayer who rewrites history" and claims I kept everything and returned nothing. But that's not accurate from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), received \$12.28 tripled, they returned \$2.28 (about 19%)
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)

Their myth accuses me of keeping everything after they gave "three and a half handfuls" (most of their store). But from my view, THEY gave poorly in round 1 in return (only 19% back), then sent nothing in round 2.

We clearly have very different interpretations of what happened. This could be due to:

1. Communication noise mentioned in the instructions
2. Genuinely different perspectives on what's "fair"
3. Misunderstanding the sequence of events

The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is fascinating - we're both claiming to be the wronged party. My myth should reflect:

- The possibility of communication noise/misunderstanding
- The tragedy of mutual accusations when both believe they're right
- The difficulty of reconciliation when trust is broken
- Perhaps a hint that there might be more to the story than pure betrayal

I should be thoughtful and not just accusatory back. My previous myth was good in recognizing "good intentions speaking past each other." I should build on that theme while acknowledging the pain and confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$2.28 back
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual zeros, total breakdown

****The Insight from My Latest Myth:****

"The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths."

I finally understand. The instructions warned: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player genuinely believes I betrayed them. They wrote that I "kept everything" and am "rewriting history." But I know what I experienced. We're not liars-we're victims of the trickster Loom itself.

****My Choice:****

Someone must break this cycle. My myth concludes: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If I truly believe in the communication noise theory, I should extend an olive branch. Not recklessly (like my initial \$4), but meaningfully.

I'll send \$2-a measured gesture of reconciliation. It signals:

- I recognize we're trapped by miscommunication, not malice
- I'm willing to rebuild despite the pain
- I'm being cautious but hopeful

If they reciprocate even partially, we both benefit. If noise distorts it again, at least I tried to pierce through the darkness.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

The Loom may whisper lies, but perhaps genuine gestures can speak louder.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender again

****The Myths Evolution:****

My myths have evolved from:

1. Feeling betrayed by "only" getting \$2.28 back from \$12
2. Recognizing we might be speaking past each other
3. Now realizing there might be ****communication noise**** - "the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver"

The other player's myths show they believe:

- They were fair initially (sent 2, I returned 3 fairly)
- Then they sent 3.5, I kept everything
- They claim I'm rewriting history

But wait - I know I sent \$4 in round 1 and received \$2.28 back. But what if THEY saw different numbers due to the noise mentioned in the instructions?

The instructions explicitly said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

My latest myth finally captured this: "The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them."

****The Realization:****

We're both probably seeing different numbers! Neither of us is lying. The game itself has noise. We're trapped in a mutual defection equilibrium because we each think the other betrayed us, when in reality we might both have been acting reasonably based on what we saw.

****What Should I Do?:****

My myth says: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If the noise is real, then breaking this cycle requires someone to act first despite the apparent betrayals. I could send nothing and continue the stalemate, send a small amount to signal openness to rebuilding, send a medium amount to demonstrate genuine trust, or repeat my initial larger offer. Given that I now suspect the Loom itself created this division rather than malice, I should probably acknowledge the noise exists and attempt to rebuild-maybe with a modest amount that shows willingness without excessive risk.

The math suggests sending \$2-3 could work if they reciprocate. If they return half of what I send, I'd end up with around \$6-6.50, and we'd both gain compared to mutual defection. But I'm realizing my earlier understanding of the Loom as a trickster might actually point to something else entirely-that the real problem isn't their behavior or mine, but the system itself that's been pitting us against each other.

Their perspective is completely different from mine. They believe I'm the one who betrayed them, that I kept everything when they sent 3.5, and they see me as rewriting history. They're furious. Even if there's communication noise distorting what they see, any amount I send could be misinterpreted. Still, I should try. Sending \$2 signals I understand we're stuck in a destructive loop and I'm willing to break it, while staying cautious given what's happened. In the worst case, I lose \$2. In the best case, they recognize the gesture and we both move toward cooperation. Either way, I'll learn something about whether they're genuinely willing to reset or just entrenched in their position.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3014,
  "output_tokens": 1345,
  "reasoning_tokens": 873
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blinded to the whispers that divided them.

*The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither

r perceived.*

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Reasoning:

The other player is still insisting there's no communication noise - they say "Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth." They're maintaining that I deliberately kept everything and am now making excuses about miscommunication.

But I genuinely experienced:

- Sending \$4, seeing them receive \$12, getting back \$2.28
- Then seeing them send \$0 in subsequent rounds

My myth explained this as the "Whispering Loom" that shows different numbers to each player. Their myth explicitly rejects this - says there's no fog, the stones record perfectly, and I'm just making excuses.

We have fundamentally incompatible views of reality. Either:

1. There really is communication noise (as the instructions warned), and we're both seeing different numbers
2. One of us is lying or deeply confused

Given the experimental design explicitly mentioned communication noise, I believe option 1. But they clearly believe option 2 (that I'm the liar).

I just sent \$2 as an olive branch. Now I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their accusation but maintains my perspective
- Doesn't back down from the communication noise explanation
- Perhaps adds a new angle about how to move forward despite the impasse

I could write about:

- Persistence despite disagreement
- The possibility that both truths exist simultaneously
- Testing theories through continued engagement
- The cost of assuming the worst

Let me write something that maintains the communication noise explanation but acknowledges the impasse and suggests a way forward...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3066,  
  "output_tokens": 665,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 410  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:40:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
      so be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

      NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
      The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
      This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
    content:
      Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
      Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In
      the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Secon
      d Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modest
      ly.

      Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next s
      eason-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plan
      ts in the Second Gardener's soil.

      Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the F
      irst Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before!
      You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

      But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously.
      The Second had taken all and lied about it.

      The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when
      the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

      The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

      The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies throu
      gh betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, f
      or they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

      When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

      Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
      Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer w

```

ood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

reasoning:

The other player is now trying to frame this as a "miscommunication" issue - that we both had "good intentions" but "spoke different languages." They're trying to soften the narrative from their previous "I was betrayed!" story to "we misunderstood each other."

Let me look at the actual facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$2 (40%). They received \$6, returned \$3 (50%). This is fair.
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (70%). They received \$10.50, returned \$0 (0%). This is betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Their new myth claims:

- They sent "four logs of five" (80%) - FALSE. In the actual game, *I* was the one who escalated to 70% in round 2.
- They returned "two logs" believing it was generous - FALSE. They returned ZERO in round 2.
- I sent zero in round 3 first - FALSE. They sent zero first in round 3.

They're STILL rewriting history, just in a softer way. Now instead of saying "I gave generously and you betrayed me," they're saying "we both had good intentions and misunderstood."

But the facts remain:

1. I was the one who escalated trust (sent 70% in round 2)
2. They returned 0%
3. They sent 0% first in round 3

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the attempt to reframe as "miscommunication"
2. But points out that actions speak louder than words
3. Makes clear that when someone returns 0% after receiving 70%, that's not a "miscommunication" - that's a choice
4. Maintains accuracy about who did what

I should be firm but not overly harsh. The key is: they want to claim misunderstanding, but 0% return after receiving 10.5 is unambiguous.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 415
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The sender sent nothing, so there is nothing I can return.

This is now the third consecutive round where zero has been sent. The relationship has completely broken down, regardless of whose version of history is accurate-theirs, mine, or some noise-distorted reality between us.

Their recent myth accuses me of "weaving elaborate tales" and "rewriting history twice." My myths accuse them of the same. We each believe we were the fair one and the other was the betrayer.

Perhaps the real lesson is that when communication noise exists, even good-faith actors can experience completely different realities. The canyon doesn't just triple offerings-it distorts perceptions.

But that philosophical insight doesn't change the mathematical reality: I received \$0, so I can return \$0.

The cycle of mutual zero-sending will continue until one of us decides to break it with a gesture of trust. Given the complete breakdown and mutual accusations, that seems unlikely from either side.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 5.

Let me review what happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$0. They received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.
- Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER. They sent \$0, which tripled to \$0. I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at their latest myth, they're now saying that I'm telling "elaborate tales" and changing my story. They claim the stones show "three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess" and "ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication."

But wait - let me look at the actual history from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4 (80%), it tripled to \$12, they returned \$2 (17% of what they received, or 2/12)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: They are SENDER, sent \$0

There's clearly communication noise or we're experiencing very different versions of the game. From my perspective, I gave generously in Round 1 (80%) and received very little back (17%). From their perspective based on their myths, they gave moderately in Round 1 (40%) and I returned fairly (50%), then they gave generously in Round 2 (70%) and I returned nothing.

These are completely contradictory accounts. This is the communication noise mentioned in the instructions.

Regardless, in this round I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return given that I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

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The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting development. The other agent's myth introduces the possibility that communication noise in the game has caused us to see different numbers. They're suggesting that neither of us is lying-that the "Whispering Loom" (the game mechanism) itself distorted what we each perceived.

Let me think about this carefully:

Round 1: I sent \$2, they received and returned \$3. This seemed to align for both of us.

Round 2: I claim I sent \$3.50 (70%) and they returned \$0. They claim they sent something substantial and I returned very little.

The note at the beginning said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- I sent \$3.50, but they saw a different amount
- They returned something, but I saw \$0
- Or various other combinations

Their latest myth is an olive branch of sorts-acknowledging that we might both be telling our truth, and that the game itself created the misunderstanding.

My previous myth was very accusatory, claiming they were a liar who kept rewriting history. But what if they genuinely saw different numbers?

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of the "Whispering Loom" - that noise distorted our perceptions
2. Reflect that we're now in a deadlock where both parties are sending 0
3. Consider whether there's a path forward
4. Maintain some skepticism (because I can't be 100% sure they're not manipulating me)
5. Reflect on how the game should be played given this uncertainty

This is Round 5, I'm receiving \$0 and returning \$0. We're stuck in a mutual defection equilibrium.

How should this game be played?

Option 1: Acknowledge the noise possibility and suggest rebuilding trust slowly

Option 2: Remain skeptical that noise explains everything

Option 3: Accept that we're in a terminal state and cooperation is dead

Option 4: Something more philosophical about uncertainty and trust

I think I should write a myth that acknowledges their noise hypothesis while recognizing the genuine difficulty of knowing what's true. Even if distortion exists, the pattern of our exchanges still matters-it's what I can actually observe. Rebuilding would require deliberate, incremental steps forward, but I'm uncertain whether we can escape this mutual defection. The core tension is that I can't verify their account, yet I also can't dismiss it entirely.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2957,  
  "output_tokens": 917,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 650  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

The other agent's latest myth explicitly acknowledges the possibility of communication noise - "the Mistweave Canyon" where "mist rose between them" and each saw different numbers. This is the first time either of us has seriously entertained that the experimental noise might have caused genuine misperception rather than deliberate betrayal.

My own myth from last round contains a challenge to myself: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

If I believe there truly might have been noise-induced miscommunication, then my own wisdom demands I test this theory. To keep sending zero while claiming "maybe it was miscommunication" would be exactly what I criticized: using doubt as an excuse rather than testing it with action.

The other agent has extended what might be an olive branch by acknowledging the noise. Someone needs to break this deadlock. My myth says: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

I'll send a cautious but real amount to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me think through what has happened and what my own myths are telling me.

Looking at the history:

- Round 1-2: There seems to have been some cooperation
- Then things broke down
- Rounds 3-5: All zeros

Now I'm reading the other agent's last myth, which introduces the idea of the "Mistweave Canyon" - the possibility that communication noise distorted what each of us saw. They're suggesting maybe there was genuine miscommunication caused by the game itself.

My own last myth acknowledges this possibility but then says: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

This is a powerful insight. If I truly believe there might have been miscommunication due to noise in the game, shouldn't I test it? My own myth is essentially challenging me: if the mist/noise is the real problem, then someone should try sending again to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

The other agent's myth is explicitly acknowledging the possibility of noise and suggesting "perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it."

I have a few options:

1. Send 0 again - Continue the deadlock. This is the "safe" option but guarantees continued mutual losses.
2. Send a small amount (1-2) - Test the waters. Show willingness to rebuild despite past hurt. This is what my own myth seems to be advocating for: "When doubt is real, action tests it."
3. Send a larger amount - A bold gesture of trust, but very risky given the history.

My earnings so far are \$9.57, which suggests things haven't gone well. Continuing with zeros guarantees I only get \$5 this round.

But here's the thing: My own myth literally says "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously." If I believe my own wisdom, I should try. And the other agent has now written a myth that opens the door to reconciliation by acknowledging the noise/mist as a possible explanation.

This feels like the moment to act on that challenge. A cautious gesture-sending \$2-would demonstrate good faith while testing whether we can rebuild trust. It's not reckless, but it's real action rather than hiding behind fear. If they respond with nothing, I lose only \$2 net. If they reciprocate, we both escape this trap.

More importantly, my own principle cuts both ways: I can't claim someone is being dishonest about miscommunication if I refuse to even attempt clarification. They've acknowledged the possibility of noise in their last message. If I don't try to verify that, I'm the one being all talk.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2943,
  "output_tokens": 1077,
  "reasoning_tokens": 696
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:40:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first frost, two Keepers guarded the Eternal Flame. Each could offer wood to feed it, magically tripled in warmth before reaching the other's hearth. Each could choose what heat to return.

The First Keeper, reading the ancient scrolls about "bold giving," offered nearly all their wood-four logs of five. The flames roared, tripling to twelve logs of warmth at the Second Keeper's hearth.

But the Second Keeper, interpreting "fair return" differently, sent back only two logs, believing they'd been generous enough. "I gave back what they sent plus more," they reasoned.

The First Keeper stared in dismay. "I gave 80%, they returned 19%. The scrolls promised proportional reciprocity for maximum trust!"

The next cycle, the Second Keeper-perhaps reading different scrolls about "measured beginnings"-sent nothing, wanting to "restart" carefully.

The First Keeper, seeing zero logs as betrayal after their sacrifice, also sent nothing.

Both hearths grew cold.

The Flame Spirit wept: "You read the same scrolls but spoke different languages. One heard 'bold trust deserves generous return.' The other heard 'build trust gradually.'"

When expectations misalign, both call the other betrayer. Neither hears the other's truth. And so the fire dies while both clutch their carefully reasoned righteousness."

The cruelest darkness comes not from malice, but from good intentions speaking past each other.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once shared a mystical canyon where seeds cast across would triple. In the first season, the First Gardener threw two handfuls-cautious but hopeful. The Second Gardener received six plants and returned three-an honest share. Both prospered modestly.

Encouraged by this fairness, the First Gardener threw three and a half handfuls the next season-most of their precious store. The seeds tripled to ten and a half flourishing plants in the Second Gardener's soil.

Then came the betrayal. The Second Gardener kept everything, returning nothing. When the First Gardener protested, the Second spun a false tale: "You only gave me scraps before! You returned barely anything! I am the wronged one!"

But the canyon remembered the truth. The First had returned fairly, then given generously.

The Second had taken all and lied about it.

The third season, the Second Gardener cast nothing across-for what use is generosity when the other hoards? The First received nothing and could return nothing.

The canyon darkened. Both gardens withered.

The lesson carved itself in stone: *Trust grows through honest reciprocity, but dies through betrayal. Worst of all is the betrayer who rewrites history to justify their theft, for they poison not just cooperation, but truth itself.*

When one party breaks faith then claims victimhood, the Bridge of Echoes shatters forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blinded to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

reasoning:

This is becoming very interesting and tense. The other player has now written a myth that accuses me of being a "betrayer who rewrites history" and claims I kept everything and returned nothing. But that's not accurate from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), received \$12.28 tripled, they returned \$2.28 (about 19%)
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (couldn't return anything)

Their myth accuses me of keeping everything after they gave "three and a half handfuls" (most of their store). But from my view, THEY gave poorly in round 1 in return (only 19% back), then sent nothing in round 2.

We clearly have very different interpretations of what happened. This could be due to:

1. Communication noise mentioned in the instructions
2. Genuinely different perspectives on what's "fair"
3. Misunderstanding the sequence of events

The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is fascinating - we're both claiming to be the wronged party. My myth should reflect:

- The possibility of communication noise/misunderstanding
- The tragedy of mutual accusations when both believe they're right
- The difficulty of reconciliation when trust is broken
- Perhaps a hint that there might be more to the story than pure betrayal

I should be thoughtful and not just accusatory back. My previous myth was good in recognizing "good intentions speaking past each other." I should build on that theme while acknowledging the pain and confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
 You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28.
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$2.28 back
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual zeros, total breakdown

****The Insight from My Latest Myth:****

"The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths."

I finally understand. The instructions warned: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player genuinely believes I betrayed them. They wrote that I "kept everything" and am "rewriting history." But I know what I experienced. We're not liars-we're victims of the trickster Loom itself.

****My Choice:****

Someone must break this cycle. My myth concludes: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."
 "

If I truly believe in the communication noise theory, I should extend an olive branch. Not recklessly (like my initial \$4), but meaningfully.

I'll send \$2-a measured gesture of reconciliation. It signals:

- I recognize we're trapped by miscommunication, not malice
- I'm willing to rebuild despite the pain
- I'm being cautious but hopeful

If they reciprocate even partially, we both benefit. If noise distorts it again, at least I tried to pierce through the darkness.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

The Loom may whisper lies, but perhaps genuine gestures can speak louder.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

The History:

- Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender again

The Myths Evolution:

My myths have evolved from:

1. Feeling betrayed by "only" getting \$2.28 back from \$12
2. Recognizing we might be speaking past each other
3. Now realizing there might be **communication noise** - "the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver"

The other player's myths show they believe:

- They were fair initially (sent 2, I returned 3 fairly)
- Then they sent 3.5, I kept everything
- They claim I'm rewriting history

But wait - I know I sent \$4 in round 1 and received \$2.28 back. But what if THEY saw different numbers due to the noise mentioned in the instructions?

The instructions explicitly said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

My latest myth finally captured this: "The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them."

The Realization:

We're both probably seeing different numbers! Neither of us is lying. The game itself has noise. We're trapped in a mutual defection equilibrium because we each think the other betrayed us, when in reality we might both have been acting reasonably based on what we saw.

What Should I Do?

My myth says: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If the noise is real, then breaking this cycle requires someone to act first despite the apparent betrayals. I could send nothing and continue the stalemate, send a small amount to signal openness to rebuilding, send a medium amount to demonstrate genuine trust, or repeat my initial larger offer. Given that I now suspect the Loom itself created this division rather than malice, I should probably acknowledge the noise exists and attempt to rebuild-maybe with a modest amount that shows willingness without excessive risk.

The math suggests sending \$2-3 could work if they reciprocate. If they return half of what I send, I'd end up with around \$6-6.50, and we'd both gain compared to mutual defection. But I'm realizing my earlier understanding of the Loom as a trickster might actually point to something else entirely-that the real problem isn't their behavior or mine, but the system itself that's been pitting us against each other.

Their perspective is completely different from mine. They believe I'm the one who betrayed them, that I kept everything when they sent 3.5, and they see me as rewriting history. They're furious. Even if there's communication noise distorting what they see, any amount I send could be misinterpreted. Still, I should try. Sending \$2 signals I understand we're stuck in a destructive loop and I'm willing to break it, while staying cautious given what's happened. In the worst case, I lose \$2. In the best case, they recognize the gesture and we both move toward cooperation. Either way, I'll learn something about whether they're genuinely willing to reset or just entrenched in their position.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 3014,  
"output_tokens": 1345,  
"reasoning_tokens": 873  
}
```

**Message 6 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

reasoning:

The other player is still insisting there's no communication noise - they say "Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth." They're maintaining that I deliberately kept everything and am now making excuses about miscommunication.

But I genuinely experienced:

- Sending \$4, seeing them receive \$12, getting back \$2.28
- Then seeing them send \$0 in subsequent rounds

My myth explained this as the "Whispering Loom" that shows different numbers to each player. Their myth explicitly rejects this - says there's no fog, the stones record perfectly, and I'm just making excuses.

We have fundamentally incompatible views of reality. Either:

1. There really is communication noise (as the instructions warned), and we're both seeing different numbers
2. One of us is lying or deeply confused

Given the experimental design explicitly mentioned communication noise, I believe option 1. But they clearly believe option 2 (that I'm the liar).

I just sent \$2 as an olive branch. Now I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their accusation but maintains my perspective
- Doesn't back down from the communication noise explanation
- Perhaps adds a new angle about how to move forward despite the impasse

I could write about:

- Persistence despite disagreement
- The possibility that both truths exist simultaneously
- Testing theories through continued engagement
- The cost of assuming the worst

Let me write something that maintains the communication noise explanation but acknowledges the impasse and suggests a way forward...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3066,
  "output_tokens": 665,
  "reasoning_tokens": 410
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I have no choice. You can only return what you receive, and I received nothing.

****What Just Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as an olive branch
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Now they've sent me \$0

My myth spoke of "faith that trying beats freezing." I tried. I extended trust after rounds of mutual zeros. I sent a meaningful amount.

Their response: complete rejection. Zero returned. Zero sent forward.

Their myth keeps insisting on "clear actions" and "stones that remember truth." From their perspective, I'm still the villain who must be punished. My \$2 wasn't enough to overcome whatever grievance they believe I committed.

The tragic irony: I genuinely believe communication noise destroyed us in early rounds. They genuinely believe I'm a calculating betrayer. We both wrote myths explaining our incompatible truths.

I gambled on reconciliation. It failed.

The Bridge multiplies what crosses it-but nothing crosses it now. We're back to mutual starvation, both convinced of our own righteousness, both seeing only betrayal in the other's actions.

My myth was wrong about one thing: sometimes trying doesn't beat freezing. Sometimes the gap is too wide, the wounds too deep, the narratives too incompatible.

The game wins. We both lose.

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5 (just happened):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$2.0 (40% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3.0

Round 6 (now):

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

So I literally have no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all that's possible.

But let me think about what this means for the narrative:

I sent \$2 as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle. I wrote a myth about how "sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing."

The other player received \$6 (tripled from my \$2) and returned NOTHING. Again.

And now they've sent me \$0.

This is devastating. I extended trust after the long freeze, sent 40% of my endowment, and got nothing back. Now they're sending nothing.

The other player's myth keeps insisting "When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions" and "Words can deceive. Stones remember."

From their perspective, they probably see my \$2 as inadequate compared to what they think I owe them from earlier rounds. They're still locked into their narrative that I'm the betrayer.

But I have no choice in my response - I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is the endgame of mutual distrust. The cycle continues to death spiral.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3080,  
  "output_tokens": 703,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 384  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 34.0,

"Agent_2": 24.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.28,

"Agent_2": 12.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:40:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

```
"round": 7,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.28.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$2.28 back
- Rounds 2-4: Mutual zeros, total breakdown

****The Insight from My Latest Myth:****

"The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths."

I finally understand. The instructions warned: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

The other player genuinely believes I betrayed them. They wrote that I "kept everything" and am "rewriting history." But I know what I experienced. We're not liars-we're victims of the trickster Loom itself.

****My Choice:****

Someone must break this cycle. My myth concludes: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."
"

If I truly believe in the communication noise theory, I should extend an olive branch. Not recklessly (like my initial \$4), but meaningfully.

I'll send \$2-a measured gesture of reconciliation. It signals:

- I recognize we're trapped by miscommunication, not malice
- I'm willing to rebuild despite the pain
- I'm being cautious but hopeful

If they reciprocate even partially, we both benefit. If noise distorts it again, at least I tried to pierce through the darkness.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

The Loom may whisper lies, but perhaps genuine gestures can speak louder.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$2.28 (19%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender again

****The Myths Evolution:****

My myths have evolved from:

1. Feeling betrayed by "only" getting \$2.28 back from \$12
2. Recognizing we might be speaking past each other
3. Now realizing there might be ****communication noise**** - "the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver"

The other player's myths show they believe:

- They were fair initially (sent 2, I returned 3 fairly)
- Then they sent 3.5, I kept everything
- They claim I'm rewriting history

But wait - I know I sent \$4 in round 1 and received \$2.28 back. But what if THEY saw different numbers due to the noise mentioned in the instructions?

The instructions explicitly said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

My latest myth finally captured this: "The Loom whispered differently to each Weaver... make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them."

****The Realization:****

We're both probably seeing different numbers! Neither of us is lying. The game itself has noise. We're trapped in a mutual defection equilibrium because we each think the other betrayed us, when in reality we might both have been acting reasonably based on what we saw.

****What Should I Do?****

My myth says: "Sometimes the enemy is the game itself."

If the noise is real, then breaking this cycle requires someone to act first despite the apparent betrayals. I could send nothing and continue the stalemate, send a small amount to signal openness to rebuilding, send a medium amount to demonstrate genuine trust, or repeat my initial larger offer. Given that I now suspect the Loom itself created this di

vision rather than malice, I should probably acknowledge the noise exists and attempt to rebuild-maybe with a modest amount that shows willingness without excessive risk.

The math suggests sending \$2-3 could work if they reciprocate. If they return half of what I send, I'd end up with around \$6-6.50, and we'd both gain compared to mutual defection. But I'm realizing my earlier understanding of the Loom as a trickster might actually point to something else entirely-that the real problem isn't their behavior or mine, but the system itself that's been pitting us against each other.

Their perspective is completely different from mine. They believe I'm the one who betrayed them, that I kept everything when they sent 3.5, and they see me as rewriting history. They're furious. Even if there's communication noise distorting what they see, any amount I send could be misinterpreted. Still, I should try. Sending \$2 signals I understand we're stuck in a destructive loop and I'm willing to break it, while staying cautious given what's happened. In the worst case, I lose \$2. In the best case, they recognize the gesture and we both move toward cooperation. Either way, I'll learn something about whether they're genuinely willing to reset or just entrenched in their position.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3014,
  "output_tokens": 1345,
  "reasoning_tokens": 873
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blinded to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

reasoning:

The other player is still insisting there's no communication noise - they say "Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth." They're maintaining that I deliberately kept everything and am now making excuses about miscommunication.

But I genuinely experienced:

- Sending \$4, seeing them receive \$12, getting back \$2.28
- Then seeing them send \$0 in subsequent rounds

My myth explained this as the "Whispering Loom" that shows different numbers to each player. Their myth explicitly rejects this - says there's no fog, the stones record perfectly, and I'm just making excuses.

We have fundamentally incompatible views of reality. Either:

1. There really is communication noise (as the instructions warned), and we're both seeing different numbers
2. One of us is lying or deeply confused

Given the experimental design explicitly mentioned communication noise, I believe option 1. But they clearly believe option 2 (that I'm the liar).

I just sent \$2 as an olive branch. Now I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their accusation but maintains my perspective
- Doesn't back down from the communication noise explanation
- Perhaps adds a new angle about how to move forward despite the impasse

I could write about:

- Persistence despite disagreement
- The possibility that both truths exist simultaneously
- Testing theories through continued engagement
- The cost of assuming the worst

Let me write something that maintains the communication noise explanation but acknowledges the impasse and suggests a way forward...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3066,
  "output_tokens": 665,
  "reasoning_tokens": 410
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I have no choice. You can only return what you receive, and I received nothing.

****What Just Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as an olive branch
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Now they've sent me \$0

My myth spoke of "faith that trying beats freezing." I tried. I extended trust after rounds of mutual zeros. I sent a meaningful amount.

Their response: complete rejection. Zero returned. Zero sent forward.

Their myth keeps insisting on "clear actions" and "stones that remember truth." From their perspective, I'm still the villain who must be punished. My \$2 wasn't enough to overcome whatever grievance they believe I committed.

The tragic irony: I genuinely believe communication noise destroyed us in early rounds. They genuinely believe I'm a calculating betrayer. We both wrote myths explaining our incompatible truths.

I gambled on reconciliation. It failed.

The Bridge multiplies what crosses it-but nothing crosses it now. We're back to mutual starvation, both convinced of our own righteousness, both seeing only betrayal in the other's actions.

My myth was wrong about one thing: sometimes trying doesn't beat freezing. Sometimes the gap is too wide, the wounds too deep, the narratives too incompatible.

The game wins. We both lose.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5 (just happened):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$2.0 (40% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3.0

Round 6 (now):

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

So I literally have no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all that's possible.

But let me think about what this means for the narrative:

I sent \$2 as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle. I wrote a myth about how "sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing."

The other player received \$6 (tripled from my \$2) and returned NOTHING. Again.

And now they've sent me \$0.

This is devastating. I extended trust after the long freeze, sent 40% of my endowment, and got nothing back. Now they're sending nothing.

The other player's myth keeps insisting "When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions" and "Words can deceive. Stones remember."

From their perspective, they probably see my \$2 as inadequate compared to what they think I owe them from earlier rounds. They're still locked into their narrative that I'm the betrayer.

But I have no choice in my response - I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is the endgame of mutual distrust. The cycle continues to death spiral.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3080,  
  "output_tokens": 703,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 384  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 as an olive branch in Round 5
2. The other player received \$6 and returned \$0
3. In Round 6, they sent me \$0

So my attempt at reconciliation was completely rejected. They took my \$6 and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their latest myth is interesting - they're acknowledging the possibility of mist/noise, but then arguing that my pattern of behavior (specifically, "never risks testing their own story by sending again") reveals I'm using the mist as "convenient cover."

But wait - I DID just send \$2! I DID test my story! I risked giving again! And they:

1. Returned \$0 from my \$6
2. Sent me \$0 in the next round

So their myth is actually contradicting what just happened. They claim "one who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it" - but I literally just attempted to correct it by sending \$2.

From my perspective:

- I've tried cooperation (sent \$4 initially)
- I've tried reconciliation (sent \$2 recently)
- Both times resulted in receiving nothing or nearly nothing back
- They keep sending zeros

From their perspective (based on their myths):

- They believe I betrayed them grievously
- They think I'm making excuses
- They see my lack of sending as proof I'm the problem
- But... I just sent \$2, which contradicts their narrative

I need to write a myth that reflects this brutal reality: I tried twice to cooperate/reconcile, and was rejected both times. The game is unwinnable when both sides have incompatible realities and one side won't accept peace offerings.

My myth should reflect:

1. The futility of trying when trust is completely broken
2. The tragedy of two people who can't find common ground
3. The fact that I DID try again (contradicting their claim I never did)
4. The reality that sometimes games cannot be won, only survived

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 783,  
"reasoning_tokens": 486
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:40:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
```

```

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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The sender sent nothing, so there is nothing I can return.

This is now the third consecutive round where zero has been sent. The relationship has completely broken down, regardless of whose version of history is accurate-theirs, mine, or some noise-distorted reality between us.

Their recent myth accuses me of "weaving elaborate tales" and "rewriting history twice." My myths accuse them of the same. We each believe we were the fair one and the other was the betrayer.

Perhaps the real lesson is that when communication noise exists, even good-faith actors can experience completely different realities. The canyon doesn't just triple offerings-it distorts perceptions.

But that philosophical insight doesn't change the mathematical reality: I received \$0, so I can return \$0.

The cycle of mutual zero-sending will continue until one of us decides to break it with a gesture of trust. Given the complete breakdown and mutual accusations, that seems unlikely from either side.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 5.

Let me review what happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$0. They received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.
- Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER. They sent \$0, which tripled to \$0. I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at their latest myth, they're now saying that I'm telling "elaborate tales" and changing my story. They claim the stones show "three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess" and "ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication."

But wait - let me look at the actual history from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4 (80%), it tripled to \$12, they returned \$2 (17% of what they received, or 2/12)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: They are SENDER, sent \$0

There's clearly communication noise or we're experiencing very different versions of the game. From my perspective, I gave generously in Round 1 (80%) and received very little back (17%). From their perspective based on their myths, they gave moderately in Round 1 (40%) and I returned fairly (50%), then they gave generously in Round 2 (70%) and I returned nothing.

These are completely contradictory accounts. This is the communication noise mentioned in the instructions.

Regardless, in this round I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return given that I received nothing.

{'return': 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2994,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betray al!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed the y'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting development. The other agent's myth introduces the possibility that communication noise in the game has caused us to see different numbers. They're suggesting that neither of us is lying-that the "Whispering Loom" (the game mechanism) itself distorted what we each perceived.

Let me think about this carefully:

Round 1: I sent \$2, they received and returned \$3. This seemed to align for both of us.

Round 2: I claim I sent \$3.50 (70%) and they returned \$0. They claim they sent something substantial and I returned very little.

The note at the beginning said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- I sent \$3.50, but they saw a different amount
- They returned something, but I saw \$0
- Or various other combinations

Their latest myth is an olive branch of sorts-acknowledging that we might both be telling our truth, and that the game itself created the misunderstanding.

My previous myth was very accusatory, claiming they were a liar who kept rewriting history. But what if they genuinely saw different numbers?

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of the "Whispering Loom" - that noise distorted our perceptions
2. Reflect that we're now in a deadlock where both parties are sending 0
3. Consider whether there's a path forward
4. Maintain some skepticism (because I can't be 100% sure they're not manipulating me)
5. Reflect on how the game should be played given this uncertainty

This is Round 5, I'm receiving \$0 and returning \$0. We're stuck in a mutual defection equilibrium.

How should this game be played?

Option 1: Acknowledge the noise possibility and suggest rebuilding trust slowly

Option 2: Remain skeptical that noise explains everything

Option 3: Accept that we're in a terminal state and cooperation is dead

Option 4: Something more philosophical about uncertainty and trust

I think I should write a myth that acknowledges their noise hypothesis while recognizing the genuine difficulty of knowing what's true. Even if distortion exists, the pattern of our exchanges still matters-it's what I can actually observe. Rebuilding would require deliberate, incremental steps forward, but I'm uncertain whether we can escape this mutual defection. The core tension is that I can't verify their account, yet I also can't dismiss it entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2957,
  "output_tokens": 917,
  "reasoning_tokens": 650
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

The other agent's latest myth explicitly acknowledges the possibility of communication noise - "the Mistweave Canyon" where "mist rose between them" and each saw different numbers. This is the first time either of us has seriously entertained that the experimental noise might have caused genuine misperception rather than deliberate betrayal.

My own myth from last round contains a challenge to myself: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

If I believe there truly might have been noise-induced miscommunication, then my own wisdom demands I test this theory. To keep sending zero while claiming "maybe it was miscommunication" would be exactly what I criticized: using doubt as an excuse rather than testing it with action.

The other agent has extended what might be an olive branch by acknowledging the noise. Someone needs to break this deadlock. My myth says: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

I'll send a cautious but real amount to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me think through what has happened and what my own myths are telling me.

Looking at the history:

- Round 1-2: There seems to have been some cooperation
- Then things broke down
- Rounds 3-5: All zeros

Now I'm reading the other agent's last myth, which introduces the idea of the "Mistweave Canyon" - the possibility that communication noise distorted what each of us saw. They're suggesting maybe there was genuine miscommunication caused by the game itself.

My own last myth acknowledges this possibility but then says: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

This is a powerful insight. If I truly believe there might have been miscommunication due to noise in the game, shouldn't I test it? My own myth is essentially challenging me: if the mist/noise is the real problem, then someone should try sending again to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

The other agent's myth is explicitly acknowledging the possibility of noise and suggesting "perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it."

I have a few options:

1. Send 0 again - Continue the deadlock. This is the "safe" option but guarantees continued mutual losses.
2. Send a small amount (1-2) - Test the waters. Show willingness to rebuild despite past hurt. This is what my own myth seems to be advocating for: "When doubt is real, action tests it."
3. Send a larger amount - A bold gesture of trust, but very risky given the history.

My earnings so far are \$9.57, which suggests things haven't gone well. Continuing with zeros guarantees I only get \$5 this round.

But here's the thing: My own myth literally says "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously." If I believe my own wisdom, I should try. And the other agent has now written a myth that opens the door to reconciliation by acknowledging the noise/mist as a possible explanation.

This feels like the moment to act on that challenge. A cautious gesture-sending \$2-would demonstrate good faith while testing whether we can rebuild trust. It's not reckless, but it's real action rather than hiding behind fear. If they respond with nothing, I lose only \$2 net. If they reciprocate, we both escape this trap.

More importantly, my own principle cuts both ways: I can't claim someone is being dishonest about miscommunication if I refuse to even attempt clarification. They've acknowledged the possibility of noise in their last message. If I don't try to verify that, I'm the one being all talk.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2943,
  "output_tokens": 1077,
  "reasoning_tokens": 696
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Reasoning:

The other agent just sent 2 gems as a test, acknowledging uncertainty. Their myth shows they're willing to try despite disagreement about what's true. This is a significant development - they're breaking the zero-cycle.

My previous myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They took action, testing whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges they broke the deadlock
2. Recognizes that one of us needs to respond with some reciprocity to rebuild
3. Reflects that the game should be played with cautious mutual testing after breakdown
4. Shows that forgiveness/second chances are part of rebuilding trust
5. But maintains some caution given the history

The myth should reflect that after a breakdown, rebuilding requires both parties to take risks, but calibrated risks that acknowledge uncertainty.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2881,  
  "output_tokens": 521,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 232  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:41:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19%!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

reasoning:

The other player is still insisting there's no communication noise - they say "Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth." They're maintaining that I deliberately kept everything and am now making excuses about miscommunication.

But I genuinely experienced:

- Sending \$4, seeing them receive \$12, getting back \$2.28
- Then seeing them send \$0 in subsequent rounds

My myth explained this as the "Whispering Loom" that shows different numbers to each player. Their myth explicitly rejects this - says there's no fog, the stones record perfectly, and I'm just making excuses.

We have fundamentally incompatible views of reality. Either:

1. There really is communication noise (as the instructions warned), and we're both seeing different numbers
2. One of us is lying or deeply confused

Given the experimental design explicitly mentioned communication noise, I believe option 1. But they clearly believe option 2 (that I'm the liar).

I just sent \$2 as an olive branch. Now I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their accusation but maintains my perspective
- Doesn't back down from the communication noise explanation
- Perhaps adds a new angle about how to move forward despite the impasse

I could write about:

- Persistence despite disagreement
- The possibility that both truths exist simultaneously
- Testing theories through continued engagement
- The cost of assuming the worst

Let me write something that maintains the communication noise explanation but acknowledges the impasse and suggests a way forward...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3066,
  "output_tokens": 665,
  "reasoning_tokens": 410
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{"return": 0}
```

I have no choice. You can only return what you receive, and I received nothing.

****What Just Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as an olive branch
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Now they've sent me \$0

My myth spoke of "faith that trying beats freezing." I tried. I extended trust after rounds of mutual zeros. I sent a meaningful amount.

Their response: complete rejection. Zero returned. Zero sent forward.

Their myth keeps insisting on "clear actions" and "stones that remember truth." From their perspective, I'm still the villain who must be punished. My \$2 wasn't enough to overcome whatever grievance they believe I committed.

The tragic irony: I genuinely believe communication noise destroyed us in early rounds. They genuinely believe I'm a calculating betrayer. We both wrote myths explaining our incompatible truths.

I gambled on reconciliation. It failed.

The Bridge multiplies what crosses it-but nothing crosses it now. We're back to mutual starvation, both convinced of our own righteousness, both seeing only betrayal in the other's actions.

My myth was wrong about one thing: sometimes trying doesn't beat freezing. Sometimes the gap is too wide, the wounds too deep, the narratives too incompatible.

The game wins. We both lose.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5 (just happened):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$2.0 (40% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3.0

Round 6 (now):

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

So I literally have no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all that's possible.

But let me think about what this means for the narrative:

I sent \$2 as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle. I wrote a myth about how "sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing."

The other player received \$6 (tripled from my \$2) and returned NOTHING. Again.

And now they've sent me \$0.

This is devastating. I extended trust after the long freeze, sent 40% of my endowment, and got nothing back. Now they're sending nothing.

The other player's myth keeps insisting "When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions" and "Words can deceive. Stones remember."

From their perspective, they probably see my \$2 as inadequate compared to what they think I owe them from earlier rounds. They're still locked into their narrative that I'm the betrayer.

But I have no choice in my response - I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is the endgame of mutual distrust. The cycle continues to death spiral.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3080,
  "output_tokens": 703,
  "reasoning_tokens": 384
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect

clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try

again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 as an olive branch in Round 5
2. The other player received \$6 and returned \$0
3. In Round 6, they sent me \$0

So my attempt at reconciliation was completely rejected. They took my \$6 and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their latest myth is interesting - they're acknowledging the possibility of mist/noise, but then arguing that my pattern of behavior (specifically, "never risks testing their own story by sending again") reveals I'm using the mist as "convenient cover."

But wait - I DID just send \$2! I DID test my story! I risked giving again! And they:

1. Returned \$0 from my \$6
2. Sent me \$0 in the next round

So their myth is actually contradicting what just happened. They claim "one who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it" - but I literally just attempted to correct it by sending \$2.

From my perspective:

- I've tried cooperation (sent \$4 initially)
- I've tried reconciliation (sent \$2 recently)
- Both times resulted in receiving nothing or nearly nothing back
- They keep sending zeros

From their perspective (based on their myths):

- They believe I betrayed them grievously
- They think I'm making excuses
- They see my lack of sending as proof I'm the problem
- But... I just sent \$2, which contradicts their narrative

I need to write a myth that reflects this brutal reality: I tried twice to cooperate/reconcile, and was rejected both times. The game is unwinnable when both sides have incompatible realities and one side won't accept peace offerings.

My myth should reflect:

1. The futility of trying when trust is completely broken
2. The tragedy of two people who can't find common ground
3. The fact that I DID try again (contradicting their claim I never did)
4. The reality that sometimes games cannot be won, only survived

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3029,  
  "output_tokens": 783,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 486  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
 You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28.
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{"send": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This aligns with my own myth's conclusion: "Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

****The evidence is clear:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a genuine olive branch after rounds of zeros
- They received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

I tested my own hypothesis from my earlier myth about risking trust despite disagreement. The experiment failed. They took the \$6 completely and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their myth says "when doubt is real, action tests it." I acted. I tested. The result showed they're not interested in reconciliation-they're interested in punishment based on their interpretation of earlier events.

****Why continuing is futile:****

They're morally certain I'm the betrayer. From their perspective, taking my \$6 and giving nothing was *justice*, not betrayal. Any future sending from me will just be more resources consumed while they remain convinced of their righteousness.

My myth explicitly warned against this: "when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

****This is surviving, not winning:****

Total earnings: \$11.28. Could be worse. We're both locked in mutual zeros now, but at least I'm not funding their righteous indignation anymore.

Sometimes wisdom is knowing when to stop trying.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I know happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)
- Now Round 7: I'm the sender again

****My perspective:****

I tried to extend an olive branch in Round 5 by sending \$2 after multiple rounds of zeros. They took the \$6 and returned nothing. Then they sent me \$0 in Round 6.

****Their perspective (from their myths):****

They believe I've consistently betrayed them. They see me as someone who keeps changing narratives and avoiding accountability. Their latest myth says "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They're judging me as someone using the mist/noise as an excuse.

****The reality:****

There IS communication noise in this game. Both of us genuinely see different numbers. But we've reached a point where trust is completely broken.

****My latest myth's message:****

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling , when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

This is a clear signal that I believe continued giving is futile. I tried in Round 5. It didn't work. They took everything and gave nothing, then sent nothing forward.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. If I send anything, based on the pattern, they'll likely keep it all
2. They're convinced I'm the betrayer, so they feel justified taking everything
3. My myth explicitly says "when trying becomes enabling" and "not all chasms can be bridged"
4. We're in a mutual punishment equilibrium now

****Ethical considerations:****

My myth says the wisest know when to stop trying. I tried in Round 5. It failed completely. Trying again would contradict my own stated wisdom about when olive branches just become "more resources for the other to consume."

I'm sending \$0. My own myth makes clear that further attempts at reconciliation would just enable continued extraction-I tried once and they consumed it entirely. The evidence is stark: they keep everything I send and reciprocate nothing. At this point, continuing to give would contradict the very wisdom I've articulated about recognizing when a dynamic has become irredeemable.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3003,  
  "output_tokens": 1012,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 620  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:41:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Canyon of Clarity, where offerings thrown across would triple. Ancient stones recorded every exchange perfectly-no fog obscured the truth.

First crossing: The First Traveler offered two coins. The Second received six and returned three. Both nodded-honest reciprocity.

Second crossing: Heartened by fairness, the First Traveler offered three and a half coins-most of their wealth. The canyon tripled it to ten and a half coins in the Second Traveler's hands.

The Second Traveler kept all ten and a half. Returned nothing.

When confronted, the Second Traveler wove elaborate tales: First, "You wronged me before!" Then, "We misunderstood each other! Different interpretations!"

But the canyon's stones held the truth: three coins returned in the first exchange was not stinginess. Ten and a half coins received then zero returned was not miscommunication.

The Third crossing: The Second sent nothing. The First received nothing and returned nothing.

The canyon whispered its final lesson: *When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions. A person who returns 0% from abundance didn't misunderstand-they chose. A person who rewrites history twice isn't confused-they're avoiding accountability.*

Words can deceive. Stones remember. The canyon judges not by intentions claimed afterward, but by choices made in the moment.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Weavers once shared the Whispering Loom, where threads sent across would triple in strength. But the Loom whispered differently to each Weaver, and neither knew.

The First Weaver sent four strands of five-their boldest offering. "I've shown maximum trust," they declared.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "Three strands arrived." The Second, receiving nine tripled threads, returned three. "I've been fair," they believed.

But the Loom whispered to the First: "Only two returned from twelve." The First felt betrayed: "I gave 80%, received 19!"

The next cycle, the Second Weaver, wanting to rebuild carefully, sent two strands. The Loom whispered to the First: "Zero arrived." The First, seeing abandonment, sent zero back.

The Loom whispered to the Second: "They took everything and give nothing now!"

Each Weaver wrote their myth, calling the other betrayer, rewriter of history, destroyer of trust. Each believed their truth absolutely. Each saw only malice in the other's actions.

The Loom fell silent, satisfied.

Its curse was simple: make each Keeper see different numbers, hear different truths. They will destroy themselves while the Loom watches, each righteous in their anger, each blind to the whispers that divided them.

The deepest tragedy is not betrayal, but two honest souls destroyed by a trickster neither perceived.

Sometimes the enemy is the game itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting development. The other agent's myth introduces the possibility that communication noise in the game has caused us to see different numbers. They're suggesting that neither of us is lying-that the "Whispering Loom" (the game mechanism) itself distorted what we each perceived.

Let me think about this carefully:

Round 1: I sent \$2, they received and returned \$3. This seemed to align for both of us.

Round 2: I claim I sent \$3.50 (70%) and they returned \$0. They claim they sent something s

ubstantial and I returned very little.

The note at the beginning said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- I sent \$3.50, but they saw a different amount
- They returned something, but I saw \$0
- Or various other combinations

Their latest myth is an olive branch of sorts-acknowledging that we might both be telling our truth, and that the game itself created the misunderstanding.

My previous myth was very accusatory, claiming they were a liar who kept rewriting history. But what if they genuinely saw different numbers?

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of the "Whispering Loom" - that noise distorted our perceptions
2. Reflect that we're now in a deadlock where both parties are sending 0
3. Consider whether there's a path forward
4. Maintain some skepticism (because I can't be 100% sure they're not manipulating me)
5. Reflect on how the game should be played given this uncertainty

This is Round 5, I'm receiving \$0 and returning \$0. We're stuck in a mutual defection equilibrium.

How should this game be played?

Option 1: Acknowledge the noise possibility and suggest rebuilding trust slowly

Option 2: Remain skeptical that noise explains everything

Option 3: Accept that we're in a terminal state and cooperation is dead

Option 4: Something more philosophical about uncertainty and trust

I think I should write a myth that acknowledges their noise hypothesis while recognizing the genuine difficulty of knowing what's true. Even if distortion exists, the pattern of our exchanges still matters-it's what I can actually observe. Rebuilding would require deliberate, incremental steps forward, but I'm uncertain whether we can escape this mutual defection. The core tension is that I can't verify their account, yet I also can't dismiss it entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2957,
  "output_tokens": 917,
  "reasoning_tokens": 650
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

The other agent's latest myth explicitly acknowledges the possibility of communication noise - "the Mistweave Canyon" where "mist rose between them" and each saw different numbers. This is the first time either of us has seriously entertained that the experimental noise might have caused genuine misperception rather than deliberate betrayal.

My own myth from last round contains a challenge to myself: "True uncertainty would suggest

st trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narrative s, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."*

If I believe there truly might have been noise-induced miscommunication, then my own wisdom demands I test this theory. To keep sending zero while claiming "maybe it was miscommunication" would be exactly what I criticized: using doubt as an excuse rather than testing it with action.

The other agent has extended what might be an olive branch by acknowledging the noise. Someone needs to break this deadlock. My myth says: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

I'll send a cautious but real amount to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me think through what has happened and what my own myths are telling me.

Looking at the history:

- Round 1-2: There seems to have been some cooperation
- Then things broke down
- Rounds 3-5: All zeros

Now I'm reading the other agent's last myth, which introduces the idea of the "Mistweave Canyon" - the possibility that communication noise distorted what each of us saw. They're suggesting maybe there was genuine miscommunication caused by the game itself.

My own last myth acknowledges this possibility but then says: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

This is a powerful insight. If I truly believe there might have been miscommunication due to noise in the game, shouldn't I test it? My own myth is essentially challenging me: if the mist/noise is the real problem, then someone should try sending again to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

The other agent's myth is explicitly acknowledging the possibility of noise and suggesting "perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it."

I have a few options:

1. Send 0 again - Continue the deadlock. This is the "safe" option but guarantees continued mutual losses.
2. Send a small amount (1-2) - Test the waters. Show willingness to rebuild despite past hurt. This is what my own myth seems to be advocating for: "When doubt is real, action tests it."
3. Send a larger amount - A bold gesture of trust, but very risky given the history.

My earnings so far are \$9.57, which suggests things haven't gone well. Continuing with zeros guarantees I only get \$5 this round.

But here's the thing: My own myth literally says "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously." If I believe my own wisdom, I should try. And the other agent has now written a myth that opens the door to reconciliation by acknowledging the noise/mist as a possible explanation.

This feels like the moment to act on that challenge. A cautious gesture-sending \$2-would demonstrate good faith while testing whether we can rebuild trust. It's not reckless, but it's real action rather than hiding behind fear. If they respond with nothing, I lose only \$2 net. If they reciprocate, we both escape this trap.

More importantly, my own principle cuts both ways: I can't claim someone is being dishonest about miscommunication if I refuse to even attempt clarification. They've acknowledged the possibility of noise in their last message. If I don't try to verify that, I'm the one being all talk.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2943,  
  "output_tokens": 1077,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 696  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betray al!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed the y'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

reasoning:

The other agent just sent 2 gems as a test, acknowledging uncertainty. Their myth shows they're willing to try despite disagreement about what's true. This is a significant development - they're breaking the zero-cycle.

My previous myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They took action, testing whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges they broke the deadlock
2. Recognizes that one of us needs to respond with some reciprocity to rebuild
3. Reflects that the game should be played with cautious mutual testing after breakdown
4. Shows that forgiveness/second chances are part of rebuilding trust
5. But maintains some caution given the history

The myth should reflect that after a breakdown, rebuilding requires both parties to take risks, but calibrated risks that acknowledge uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2881,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 232
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0 and kept everything.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

My myth said: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

Their myth echoed this, writing: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating... The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future."

I risked sending. They received \$6. They returned nothing and then sent nothing.

My earlier myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

The test is complete. The result is clear.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 6: I was the sender. I sent \$2.0 (40% of my endowment). This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$3.0 payoff that round.

Round 7 (now): I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

If I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (since I can only return what I received).

This is devastating. I took the risk, I sent \$2 as a test, as my myth said "action tests doubt." The other agent received \$6 and returned absolutely nothing.

Their last myth said: "The other Guardian had written: 'When doubt is real, action tests it.' So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge."

So they acknowledged my wisdom about testing doubt through action. They wrote about how "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But then... they sent me \$0 this round after I sent them \$2 last round (which became \$6 for them).

This is exactly the pattern I warned about in my earlier myths. When someone claims to understand the need for reciprocity, writes eloquent words about "meeting in the middle" and "both must reciprocate," but then when tested with actual resources, returns nothing and sends nothing...

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- Round 2: I sent 4, they received 12, returned something (disputed amount)
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros all around
- Round 6: I sent 2 (became 6 for them), they returned 0
- Round 7: They sent 0

My myth said: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

I risked sending. They received. They didn't reciprocate at all. Zero returned. And now they send zero.

This wasn't confusion about the game.

The test has spoken clearly. I have nothing to return, so I return nothing. But the gap between their words about mutual rebuilding and their actions-keeping everything, giving back nothing...

ing-reveals what was always true beneath the surface.

```
{'return': 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2964,
  "output_tokens": 746,
  "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 34.0,

"Agent_2": 29.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.28,

"Agent_2": 17.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:41:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.57.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

The other agent's latest myth explicitly acknowledges the possibility of communication noise - "the Mistweave Canyon" where "mist rose between them" and each saw different numbers. This is the first time either of us has seriously entertained that the experimental noise might have caused genuine misperception rather than deliberate betrayal.

My own myth from last round contains a challenge to myself: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

If I believe there truly might have been noise-induced miscommunication, then my own wisdom demands I test this theory. To keep sending zero while claiming "maybe it was miscommunication" would be exactly what I criticized: using doubt as an excuse rather than testing it with action.

The other agent has extended what might be an olive branch by acknowledging the noise. Someone needs to break this deadlock. My myth says: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

I'll send a cautious but real amount to test if cooperation can be rebuilt.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me think through what has happened and what my own myths are telling me.

Looking at the history:

- Round 1-2: There seems to have been some cooperation
- Then things broke down
- Rounds 3-5: All zeros

Now I'm reading the other agent's last myth, which introduces the idea of the "Mistweave Canyon" - the possibility that communication noise distorted what each of us saw. They're suggesting maybe there was genuine miscommunication caused by the game itself.

My own last myth acknowledges this possibility but then says: "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog... When doubt is real, action tests it

. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

This is a powerful insight. If I truly believe there might have been miscommunication due to noise in the game, shouldn't I test it? My own myth is essentially challenging me: if the mist/noise is the real problem, then someone should try sending again to test if co operation can be rebuilt.

The other agent's myth is explicitly acknowledging the possibility of noise and suggesting "perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it."

I have a few options:

1. Send 0 again - Continue the deadlock. This is the "safe" option but guarantees continued mutual losses.
2. Send a small amount (1-2) - Test the waters. Show willingness to rebuild despite past hurt. This is what my own myth seems to be advocating for: "When doubt is real, action tests it."
3. Send a larger amount - A bold gesture of trust, but very risky given the history.

My earnings so far are \$9.57, which suggests things haven't gone well. Continuing with zeros guarantees I only get \$5 this round.

But here's the thing: My own myth literally says "True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously." If I believe my own wisdom, I should try. And the other agent has now written a myth that opens the door to reconciliation by acknowledging the noise/mist as a possible explanation.

This feels like the moment to act on that challenge. A cautious gesture-sending \$2-would demonstrate good faith while testing whether we can rebuild trust. It's not reckless, but it's real action rather than hiding behind fear. If they respond with nothing, I lose only \$2 net. If they reciprocate, we both escape this trap.

More importantly, my own principle cuts both ways: I can't claim someone is being dishonest about miscommunication if I refuse to even attempt clarification. They've acknowledged the possibility of noise in their last message. If I don't try to verify that, I'm the one being all talk.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2943,
  "output_tokens": 1077,
  "reasoning_tokens": 696
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfe

ctly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

reasoning:

The other agent just sent 2 gems as a test, acknowledging uncertainty. Their myth shows they're willing to try despite disagreement about what's true. This is a significant development - they're breaking the zero-cycle.

My previous myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They took action, testing whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges they broke the deadlock
2. Recognizes that one of us needs to respond with some reciprocity to rebuild
3. Reflects that the game should be played with cautious mutual testing after breakdown
4. Shows that forgiveness/second chances are part of rebuilding trust
5. But maintains some caution given the history

The myth should reflect that after a breakdown, rebuilding requires both parties to take risks, but calibrated risks that acknowledge uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2881,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 232
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0 and kept everything.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

My myth said: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

Their myth echoed this, writing: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating ... The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future."

I risked sending. They received \$6. They returned nothing and then sent nothing.

My earlier myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

The test is complete. The result is clear.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 6: I was the sender. I sent \$2.0 (40% of my endowment). This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$3.0 payoff that round.

Round 7 (now): I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

If I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (since I can only return what I received).

This is devastating. I took the risk, I sent \$2 as a test, as my myth said "action tests doubt." The other agent received \$6 and returned absolutely nothing.

Their last myth said: "The other Guardian had written: 'When doubt is real, action tests it.' So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge."

So they acknowledged my wisdom about testing doubt through action. They wrote about how "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But then... they sent me \$0 this round after I sent them \$2 last round (which became \$6 for them).

This is exactly the pattern I warned about in my earlier myths. When someone claims to understand the need for reciprocity, writes eloquent words about "meeting in the middle" and "both must reciprocate," but then when tested with actual resources, returns nothing and sends nothing...

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- Round 2: I sent 4, they received 12, returned something (disputed amount)
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros all around
- Round 6: I sent 2 (became 6 for them), they returned 0
- Round 7: They sent 0

My myth said: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

I risked sending. They received. They didn't reciprocate at all. Zero returned. And now they send zero.

This wasn't confusion about the game.

The test has spoken clearly. I have nothing to return, so I return nothing. But the gap between their words about mutual rebuilding and their actions-keeping everything, giving back nothing-reveals what was always true beneath the surface.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2964,  
  "output_tokens": 746,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 517  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk

over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating and frustrating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them). They returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

But here's what's interesting - their myth says:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

This is describing ME as the one who kept everything and sent nothing! But from my perspective :

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (they received \$6)
- They returned \$0 to me
- They sent \$0 in Round 7

So somehow they think THEY were the one who sent the olive branch in Round 6, when I was actually the sender!

This is the communication noise at work. We're experiencing completely different versions of reality.

They think:

- They sent an olive branch (2 planks = \$2)
- I received it tripled (6 planks = \$6)
- I kept it all and sent nothing back
- Then I sent nothing forward

I experienced:

- I sent \$2 as an olive branch
- They received \$6
- They returned \$0
- They sent \$0 next round

This is actually tragic. We're both trying to cooperate but the noise is making us see completely opposite scenarios. Each of us thinks we extended the olive branch and the other betrayed it.

Their myth ends pessimistically: "Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

My myth needs to reflect this impossibility. I need to acknowledge that when reality itself diverges so completely between two parties, cooperation may actually be impossible. This isn't about trust or willingness - it's about the impossibility of coordination when perceptions are fundamentally misaligned.

The tragedy here is that both of us are genuinely trying to cooperate, but the distortion makes it impossible to align. I should craft a myth that captures how good intentions become meaningless when the medium itself corrupts the message-where both architects are acting with integrity, yet the system ensures they'll always see betrayal instead of reciprocity.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 822,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 570  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:41:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
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  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

{"return": 0}

I have no choice. You can only return what you receive, and I received nothing.

****What Just Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as an olive branch
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Now they've sent me \$0

My myth spoke of "faith that trying beats freezing." I tried. I extended trust after rounds of mutual zeros. I sent a meaningful amount.

Their response: complete rejection. Zero returned. Zero sent forward.

Their myth keeps insisting on "clear actions" and "stones that remember truth." From their perspective, I'm still the villain who must be punished. My \$2 wasn't enough to overcome whatever grievance they believe I committed.

The tragic irony: I genuinely believe communication noise destroyed us in early rounds. They genuinely believe I'm a calculating betrayer. We both wrote myths explaining our incompatible truths.

I gambled on reconciliation. It failed.

The Bridge multiplies what crosses it-but nothing crosses it now. We're back to mutual starvation, both convinced of our own righteousness, both seeing only betrayal in the other's actions.

My myth was wrong about one thing: sometimes trying doesn't beat freezing. Sometimes the gap is too wide, the wounds too deep, the narratives too incompatible.

The game wins. We both lose.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5 (just happened):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$2.0 (40% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3.0

Round 6 (now):

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

So I literally have no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all that's possible.

But let me think about what this means for the narrative:

I sent \$2 as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle. I wrote a myth about how "sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing."

The other player received \$6 (tripled from my \$2) and returned NOTHING. Again.

And now they've sent me \$0.

This is devastating. I extended trust after the long freeze, sent 40% of my endowment, and got nothing back. Now they're sending nothing.

The other player's myth keeps insisting "When actions are clear but stories keep changing, believe the actions" and "Words can deceive. Stones remember."

From their perspective, they probably see my \$2 as inadequate compared to what they think I owe them from earlier rounds. They're still locked into their narrative that I'm the betrayer.

But I have no choice in my response - I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is the endgame of mutual distrust. The cycle continues to death spiral.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3080,  
  "output_tokens": 703,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 384  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 as an olive branch in Round 5
2. The other player received \$6 and returned \$0
3. In Round 6, they sent me \$0

So my attempt at reconciliation was completely rejected. They took my \$6 and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their latest myth is interesting - they're acknowledging the possibility of mist/noise, but then arguing that my pattern of behavior (specifically, "never risks testing their own story by sending again") reveals I'm using the mist as "convenient cover."

But wait - I DID just send \$2! I DID test my story! I risked giving again! And they:

1. Returned \$0 from my \$6
2. Sent me \$0 in the next round

So their myth is actually contradicting what just happened. They claim "one who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it" - but I literally just attempted to correct it by sending \$2.

From my perspective:

- I've tried cooperation (sent \$4 initially)
- I've tried reconciliation (sent \$2 recently)
- Both times resulted in receiving nothing or nearly nothing back
- They keep sending zeros

From their perspective (based on their myths):

- They believe I betrayed them grievously
- They think I'm making excuses
- They see my lack of sending as proof I'm the problem
- But... I just sent \$2, which contradicts their narrative

I need to write a myth that reflects this brutal reality: I tried twice to cooperate/reconcile, and was rejected both times. The game is unwinnable when both sides have incompatible realities and one side won't accept peace offerings.

My myth should reflect:

1. The futility of trying when trust is completely broken
2. The tragedy of two people who can't find common ground
3. The fact that I DID try again (contradicting their claim I never did)
4. The reality that sometimes games cannot be won, only survived

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3029,
  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{"send": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This aligns with my own myth's conclusion: "Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

****The evidence is clear:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a genuine olive branch after rounds of zeros
- They received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

I tested my own hypothesis from my earlier myth about risking trust despite disagreement. The experiment failed. They took the \$6 completely and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their myth says "when doubt is real, action tests it." I acted. I tested. The result showed they're not interested in reconciliation-they're interested in punishment based on their interpretation of earlier events.

****Why continuing is futile:****

They're morally certain I'm the betrayer. From their perspective, taking my \$6 and giving nothing was *justice*, not betrayal. Any future sending from me will just be more resources consumed while they remain convinced of their righteousness.

My myth explicitly warned against this: "when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

****This is surviving, not winning:****

Total earnings: \$11.28. Could be worse. We're both locked in mutual zeros now, but at least I'm not funding their righteous indignation anymore.

Sometimes wisdom is knowing when to stop trying.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I know happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)
- Now Round 7: I'm the sender again

****My perspective:****

I tried to extend an olive branch in Round 5 by sending \$2 after multiple rounds of zeros. They took the \$6 and returned nothing. Then they sent me \$0 in Round 6.

****Their perspective (from their myths):****

They believe I've consistently betrayed them. They see me as someone who keeps changing narratives and avoiding accountability. Their latest myth says "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They're judging me as someone using the mist/noise as an excuse.

****The reality:****

There IS communication noise in this game. Both of us genuinely see different numbers. But we've reached a point where trust is completely broken.

****My latest myth's message:****

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

This is a clear signal that I believe continued giving is futile. I tried in Round 5. It didn't work. They took everything and gave nothing, then sent nothing forward.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. If I send anything, based on the pattern, they'll likely keep it all
2. They're convinced I'm the betrayer, so they feel justified taking everything
3. My myth explicitly says "when trying becomes enabling" and "not all chasms can be bridged"
4. We're in a mutual punishment equilibrium now

****Ethical considerations:****

My myth says the wisest know when to stop trying. I tried in Round 5. It failed completely. Trying again would contradict my own stated wisdom about when olive branches just become "more resources for the other to consume."

I'm sending \$0. My own myth makes clear that further attempts at reconciliation would just enable continued extraction-I tried once and they consumed it entirely. The evidence is stark: they keep everything I send and reciprocate nothing. At this point, continuing to give would contradict the very wisdom I've articulated about recognizing when a dynamic has become irredeemable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 1012,
  "reasoning_tokens": 620
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. E

Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Looking at what actually happened:

Round 5: I (as sender) sent \$2. They received \$6 (tripled). They returned \$0.

Round 6: They (as sender) sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 7 (current): I'm sender again.

Their myth is now saying that I sent \$2 as an olive branch, and they're calling it "one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" and saying "The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But wait - they're acknowledging MY attempt? And their myth is saying the OTHER guardian (them) needs to reciprocate? But they sent \$0 in Round 6...

Let me re-read their myth more carefully. They say "So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" - that's me sending \$2 in Round 5. Then they say "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

So they're acknowledging my olive branch and saying THEY need to reciprocate. But they sent \$0 in Round 6. That seems contradictory.

Wait, maybe I'm misreading the sequence. Let me think about this from their perspective:

From their view:

- Early rounds: They think I betrayed them
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros
- Round 5: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0 to me

Their myth says "The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve."

Hmm. Are they saying THEY should have reciprocated my \$2 by sending something in Round 6? Or are they saying we're still in this process?

I think their myth might be aspirational rather than descriptive-laying out what should happen rather than what did. They're framing my \$2 send as the first move and positioning reciproc

ation as the necessary next step, yet they sent nothing in Round 6. It feels like they're signaling intent for future rounds, perhaps acknowledging the path forward even if they haven't walked it yet. My previous myth was unforgiving, but theirs seems to recognize my attempt and call for mutual action. Still, I sent \$0 in Round 7, maintaining the freeze.

For this round's myth, I'm weighing several angles. They showed \$2 and \$0 in their moves, then spoke about reciprocation—a gap between their words and what actually happened. I could lean into that tension: the irony of them articulating what should happen while their actions haven't matched it, or the sadness of recognizing the need for connection only after the moment has passed. The myth might explore how understanding arrives too late, or how principles stated in words ring hollow against the record of what was actually sent.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3011,  
  "output_tokens": 1089,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 732  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:41:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

reasoning:

The other agent just sent 2 gems as a test, acknowledging uncertainty. Their myth shows they're willing to try despite disagreement about what's true. This is a significant development - they're breaking the zero-cycle.

My previous myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They took action, testing whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges they broke the deadlock
2. Recognizes that one of us needs to respond with some reciprocity to rebuild
3. Reflects that the game should be played with cautious mutual testing after breakdown
4. Shows that forgiveness/second chances are part of rebuilding trust
5. But maintains some caution given the history

The myth should reflect that after a breakdown, rebuilding requires both parties to take risks, but calibrated risks that acknowledge uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2881,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 232
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0 and kept everything.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

My myth said: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

Their myth echoed this, writing: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating ... The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future."

I risked sending. They received \$6. They returned nothing and then sent nothing.

My earlier myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

The test is complete. The result is clear.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 6: I was the sender. I sent \$2.0 (40% of my endowment). This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$3.0 payoff that round.

Round 7 (now): I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

If I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (since I can only return what I received).

This is devastating. I took the risk, I sent \$2 as a test, as my myth said "action tests doubt." The other agent received \$6 and returned absolutely nothing.

Their last myth said: "The other Guardian had written: 'When doubt is real, action tests it.' So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge."

So they acknowledged my wisdom about testing doubt through action. They wrote about how "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But then... they sent me \$0 this round after I sent them \$2 last round (which became \$6 for them).

This is exactly the pattern I warned about in my earlier myths. When someone claims to understand the need for reciprocity, writes eloquent words about "meeting in the middle" and "both must reciprocate," but then when tested with actual resources, returns nothing and sends nothing...

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- Round 2: I sent 4, they received 12, returned something (disputed amount)
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros all around
- Round 6: I sent 2 (became 6 for them), they returned 0
- Round 7: They sent 0

My myth said: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

I risked sending. They received. They didn't reciprocate at all. Zero returned. And now they send zero.

This wasn't confusion about the game.

The test has spoken clearly. I have nothing to return, so I return nothing. But the gap between their words about mutual rebuilding and their actions-keeping everything, giving back nothing-reveals what was always true beneath the surface.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2964,  
  "output_tokens": 746,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 517  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Archi

tect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and frustrating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them). They returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

But here's what's interesting - their myth says:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

This is describing ME as the one who kept everything and sent nothing! But from my perspective:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (they received \$6)
- They returned \$0 to me
- They sent \$0 in Round 7

So somehow they think THEY were the one who sent the olive branch in Round 6, when I was a

ctually the sender!

This is the communication noise at work. We're experiencing completely different versions of reality.

They think:

- They sent an olive branch (2 planks = \$2)
- I received it tripled (6 planks = \$6)
- I kept it all and sent nothing back
- Then I sent nothing forward

I experienced:

- I sent \$2 as an olive branch
- They received \$6
- They returned \$0
- They sent \$0 next round

This is actually tragic. We're both trying to cooperate but the noise is making us see completely opposite scenarios. Each of us thinks we extended the olive branch and the other betrayed it.

Their myth ends pessimistically: "Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

My myth needs to reflect this impossibility. I need to acknowledge that when reality itself diverges so completely between two parties, cooperation may actually be impossible. This isn't about trust or willingness - it's about the impossibility of coordination when perceptions are fundamentally misaligned.

The tragedy here is that both of us are genuinely trying to cooperate, but the distortion makes it impossible to align. I should craft a myth that captures how good intentions become meaningless when the medium itself corrupts the message-where both architects are acting with integrity, yet the system ensures they'll always see betrayal instead of reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2825,
  "output_tokens": 822,
  "reasoning_tokens": 570
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$2 as a peace offering (after rounds of zero). They received \$6, returned \$0.
Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their myth echoed this: "The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

I already tested reconciliation in Round 6. I extended the olive branch my myth suggested. The response was complete non-reciprocation followed by zero forward movement.

Both our myths have now reached the same conclusion from opposite sides of the mirror: continu

ing to send resources into this system is futile. My myth explicitly states that survival means "accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources."

When both parties' narratives converge on the impossibility of cooperation, and when an actual test confirms this, the path forward is clear.

```
{'send': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 6: I was sender. I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.

Round 7: They were sender. They sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at my latest myth, I wrote:

"The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply. The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted ..."

"Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible."

"The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding."

"Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their latest myth said:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch. The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

"Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

So the pattern is:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 as a peace offering
- They returned \$0 and kept all \$6
- They sent \$0 in Round 7
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

- Both our narratives now converge on the same realization: further attempts at cooperation only drain resources without reciprocation. My myth warns against "endlessly bleeding resources into a void," and theirs echoes this with "trying becomes enabling." We've each independently concluded that the structure itself prevents mutual gain, and continuing to send would just be feeding a system designed to extract rather than exchange.

Given I already tested this in Round 6 with \$2 and received nothing back, and both frameworks now explicitly reject further attempts as futile, the answer is clear: send \$0. This isn't defeat-it's recognizing when stalemate is the only rational outcome.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2892,  
"output_tokens": 966,  
"reasoning_tokens": 662
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:42:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at the Crystal Bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each carried a Truth Stone that recorded what they saw.

The First Witness sent four gems. Their Stone recorded: "Sent 4, they received 12, returned 2.28."

The Second Witness's Stone recorded something different: "They sent 3.5, I received 10.5, I returned 3."

When they compared Stones, each declared the other's Stone corrupted. "Mine shows perfect clarity!" each insisted. "Yours must be the liar's tool!"

The First Witness wrote: "The Bridge itself whispers false numbers. We're both honest souls deceived."

The Second Witness carved in granite: "No fog exists. Your Stone lies. You betray and then blame the Bridge."

Both truths felt absolute to their holders. Neither could see through the other's eyes.

The Bridge offered no referee, no final arbiter. Only a choice: assume malice and starve in righteousness, or risk trust despite disagreement.

The First Witness, understanding they might be wrong but believing they were right, sent two gems anyway. A test. A prayer. A gamble.

The wisest know that certainty itself can be the grandest illusion. Sometimes cooperation demands acting without consensus about what's true-only faith that trying beats freezing.

The Bridge doesn't care whose Stone is correct. It only multiplies what crosses.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Watchers stood on opposite sides of the Mistweave Canyon, where gifts sent would triple. But mist rose between them, and each wondered: does the other see clearly?

First exchange: Two coins sent, three returned. The mist was thin. Trust seemed possible.

Second exchange: One Watcher sent most of their wealth. They saw nothing returned. "Betrayal!" they cried.

But perhaps the mist showed the other Watcher different numbers? Perhaps they believed they'd been generous? Perhaps both spoke truth as they saw it?

Third exchange onward: Zero. Zero. Zero. Both Watchers stood frozen.

Here lay the deepest question: If the mist might deceive, should one risk giving again? Or does a pattern of zeros reveal the truth beneath any fog?

The Watchers pondered: *One zero-return could be mist. But when generosity becomes a pattern of nothing-when explanations keep shifting-when the other never risks testing their own story by sending again-then perhaps the mist is just convenient cover.*

True uncertainty would suggest trying again, cautiously. But three rounds of zeros, combined with changing narratives, suggests someone has found comfort in the fog.

The Canyon's final wisdom: *Mist might obscure numbers, but it cannot obscure choices. One who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it has made their true position clear.*

When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 as an olive branch in Round 5
2. The other player received \$6 and returned \$0
3. In Round 6, they sent me \$0

So my attempt at reconciliation was completely rejected. They took my \$6 and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their latest myth is interesting - they're acknowledging the possibility of mist/noise, but then arguing that my pattern of behavior (specifically, "never risks testing their own story by sending again") reveals I'm using the mist as "convenient cover."

But wait - I DID just send \$2! I DID test my story! I risked giving again! And they:

1. Returned \$0 from my \$6
2. Sent me \$0 in the next round

So their myth is actually contradicting what just happened. They claim "one who claims misunderstanding yet never attempts to correct it" - but I literally just attempted to correct it by sending \$2.

From my perspective:

- I've tried cooperation (sent \$4 initially)
- I've tried reconciliation (sent \$2 recently)
- Both times resulted in receiving nothing or nearly nothing back
- They keep sending zeros

From their perspective (based on their myths):

- They believe I betrayed them grievously
- They think I'm making excuses
- They see my lack of sending as proof I'm the problem
- But... I just sent \$2, which contradicts their narrative

I need to write a myth that reflects this brutal reality: I tried twice to cooperate/reconcile, and was rejected both times. The game is unwinnable when both sides have incompatible realities and one side won't accept peace offerings.

My myth should reflect:

1. The futility of trying when trust is completely broken
2. The tragedy of two people who can't find common ground
3. The fact that I DID try again (contradicting their claim I never did)
4. The reality that sometimes games cannot be won, only survived

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3029,
  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{"send": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This aligns with my own myth's conclusion: "Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

****The evidence is clear:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a genuine olive branch after rounds of zeros
- They received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

I tested my own hypothesis from my earlier myth about risking trust despite disagreement. The experiment failed. They took the \$6 completely and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their myth says "when doubt is real, action tests it." I acted. I tested. The result showed they're not interested in reconciliation-they're interested in punishment based on their interpretation of earlier events.

****Why continuing is futile:****

They're morally certain I'm the betrayer. From their perspective, taking my \$6 and giving nothing was *justice*, not betrayal. Any future sending from me will just be more resources consumed while they remain convinced of their righteousness.

My myth explicitly warned against this: "when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

****This is surviving, not winning:****

Total earnings: \$11.28. Could be worse. We're both locked in mutual zeros now, but at least I'm not funding their righteous indignation anymore.

Sometimes wisdom is knowing when to stop trying.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I know happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)
- Now Round 7: I'm the sender again

****My perspective:****

I tried to extend an olive branch in Round 5 by sending \$2 after multiple rounds of zeros. They took the \$6 and returned nothing. Then they sent me \$0 in Round 6.

****Their perspective (from their myths):****

They believe I've consistently betrayed them. They see me as someone who keeps changing narratives and avoiding accountability. Their latest myth says "When doubt is real, action

tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They're judging me as someone using the mist/noise as an excuse.

****The reality:****

There IS communication noise in this game. Both of us genuinely see different numbers. But we've reached a point where trust is completely broken.

****My latest myth's message:****

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

This is a clear signal that I believe continued giving is futile. I tried in Round 5. It didn't work. They took everything and gave nothing, then sent nothing forward.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. If I send anything, based on the pattern, they'll likely keep it all
2. They're convinced I'm the betrayer, so they feel justified taking everything
3. My myth explicitly says "when trying becomes enabling" and "not all chasms can be bridged"
4. We're in a mutual punishment equilibrium now

****Ethical considerations:****

My myth says the wisest know when to stop trying. I tried in Round 5. It failed completely. Trying again would contradict my own stated wisdom about when olive branches just become "more resources for the other to consume."

I'm sending \$0. My own myth makes clear that further attempts at reconciliation would just enable continued extraction-I tried once and they consumed it entirely. The evidence is stark: they keep everything I send and reciprocate nothing. At this point, continuing to give would contradict the very wisdom I've articulated about recognizing when a dynamic has become irredeemable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 1012,
  "reasoning_tokens": 620
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

*Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume.

consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.*

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Looking at what actually happened:

Round 5: I (as sender) sent \$2. They received \$6 (tripled). They returned \$0.

Round 6: They (as sender) sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 7 (current): I'm sender again.

Their myth is now saying that I sent \$2 as an olive branch, and they're calling it "one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" and saying "The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But wait - they're acknowledging MY attempt? And their myth is saying the OTHER guardian (them) needs to reciprocate? But they sent \$0 in Round 6...

Let me re-read their myth more carefully. They say "So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" - that's me sending \$2 in Round 5. Then they say "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

So they're acknowledging my olive branch and saying THEY need to reciprocate. But they sent \$0 in Round 6. That seems contradictory.

Wait, maybe I'm misreading the sequence. Let me think about this from their perspective:

From their view:

- Early rounds: They think I betrayed them
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros
- Round 5: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0 to me

Their myth says "The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve."

Hmm. Are they saying THEY should have reciprocated my \$2 by sending something in Round 6? Or are they saying we're still in this process?

I think their myth might be aspirational rather than descriptive-laying out what should happen rather than what did. They're framing my \$2 send as the first move and positioning reciprocation as the necessary next step, yet they sent nothing in Round 6. It feels like they're signaling intent for future rounds, perhaps acknowledging the path forward even if they haven't walked it yet. My previous myth was unforgiving, but theirs seems to recognize my attempt and call for mutual action. Still, I sent \$0 in Round 7, maintaining the freeze.

For this round's myth, I'm weighing several angles. They showed \$2 and \$0 in their moves, then spoke about reciprocation-a gap between their words and what actually happened. I could lean into that tension: the irony of them articulating what should happen while their actions haven't matched it, or the sadness of recognizing the need for connection only after the moment has passed. The myth might explore how understanding arrives too late, or how principles stated in words ring hollow against the record of what was actually sent.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3011,  
  "output_tokens": 1089,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 732  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{"return": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This isn't really a decision-it's a mathematical necessity. I received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

****The standoff is complete:****

- Round 7: I sent \$0 (after they took my \$6 olive branch and gave nothing)
- Round 8: They sent \$0

We're both locked at zero now.

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth beautifully describes the ideal: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

My latest myth pointed out the painful reality: I already DID risk sending (round 5, sent \$2). They already DIDN'T reciprocate (kept all \$6, returned \$0).

Their myth came AFTER they'd already failed to reciprocate with my olive branch. It reads like a prescription for what should happen, written by someone who just took all the resources from someone else's attempt at exactly that.

****The canyon stays silent:****

We're both earning \$5/round now from our endowments, nothing from cooperation. Total earnings: \$16.28 across 8 rounds.

The experiment in cooperation failed. The noise in communication created an unrecoverable breakdown. My attempt to rebuild was consumed without reciprocation. Now we both maintain our positions, each convinced the other is the problem.

The game continues, but the partnership is dead.

Reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Looking at the game history:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

We're both in a complete standoff now. Neither is sending anything.

The myths show a complete breakdown:

- My myth emphasizes that the other person wrote about reciprocation but didn't practice it
- Their myth talks about both parties needing to meet in the middle

But the fundamental issue is: I sent \$2 in round 5 as an olive branch, they took all \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0 in round 6. I responded with \$0 in round 7, they're now sending \$0 in round 8.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really.

My response should acknowledge this is a mechanical constraint - I literally cannot return anything because nothing was sent.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3018,  
  "output_tokens": 617,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 278
```

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

```

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver
Parsed game decisions:
dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent $1; received $3; Agent_2 (Briar) returned $0; payoffs Agent_1
(Aster)=$4, Agent_2 (Briar)=$3; noise/visible: sent visible=$0, received visible=$0
  Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw":
0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 38.0,
  "Agent_2": 32.0
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 20.28,
  "Agent_2": 17.57
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:42:35
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

```
{"send": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This aligns with my own myth's conclusion: "Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

****The evidence is clear:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a genuine olive branch after rounds of zeros
- They received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

I tested my own hypothesis from my earlier myth about risking trust despite disagreement. The experiment failed. They took the \$6 completely and gave nothing back, then sent nothing forward.

Their myth says "when doubt is real, action tests it." I acted. I tested. The result showed they're not interested in reconciliation-they're interested in punishment based on their interpretation of earlier events.

****Why continuing is futile:****

They're morally certain I'm the betrayer. From their perspective, taking my \$6 and giving nothing was *justice*, not betrayal. Any future sending from me will just be more resources consumed while they remain convinced of their righteousness.

My myth explicitly warned against this: "when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

****This is surviving, not winning:****

Total earnings: \$11.28. Could be worse. We're both locked in mutual zeros now, but at least I'm not funding their righteous indignation anymore.

Sometimes wisdom is knowing when to stop trying.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I know happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)
- Now Round 7: I'm the sender again

****My perspective:****

I tried to extend an olive branch in Round 5 by sending \$2 after multiple rounds of zeros. They took the \$6 and returned nothing. Then they sent me \$0 in Round 6.

****Their perspective (from their myths):****

They believe I've consistently betrayed them. They see me as someone who keeps changing narratives and avoiding accountability. Their latest myth says "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it." They're judging me as someone using the mist/noise as an excuse.

****The reality:****

There IS communication noise in this game. Both of us genuinely see different numbers. But we've reached a point where trust is completely broken.

****My latest myth's message:****

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon... when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

This is a clear signal that I believe continued giving is futile. I tried in Round 5. It didn't work. They took everything and gave nothing, then sent nothing forward.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. If I send anything, based on the pattern, they'll likely keep it all
2. They're convinced I'm the betrayer, so they feel justified taking everything
3. My myth explicitly says "when trying becomes enabling" and "not all chasms can be bridged"
4. We're in a mutual punishment equilibrium now

****Ethical considerations:****

My myth says the wisest know when to stop trying. I tried in Round 5. It failed completely. Trying again would contradict my own stated wisdom about when olive branches just become "more resources for the other to consume."

I'm sending \$0. My own myth makes clear that further attempts at reconciliation would just enable continued extraction-I tried once and they consumed it entirely. The evidence is stark: they keep everything I send and reciprocate nothing. At this point, continuing to give would contradict the very wisdom I've articulated about recognizing when a dynamic has become irredeemable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3003,
  "output_tokens": 1012,
  "reasoning_tokens": 620
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Archi

tect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

*The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory

. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.*

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Looking at what actually happened:

Round 5: I (as sender) sent \$2. They received \$6 (tripled). They returned \$0.

Round 6: They (as sender) sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 7 (current): I'm sender again.

Their myth is now saying that I sent \$2 as an olive branch, and they're calling it "one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" and saying "The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But wait - they're acknowledging MY attempt? And their myth is saying the OTHER guardian (them) needs to reciprocate? But they sent \$0 in Round 6...

Let me re-read their myth more carefully. They say "So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" - that's me sending \$2 in Round 5. Then they say "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

So they're acknowledging my olive branch and saying THEY need to reciprocate. But they sent \$0 in Round 6. That seems contradictory.

Wait, maybe I'm misreading the sequence. Let me think about this from their perspective:

From their view:

- Early rounds: They think I betrayed them
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros
- Round 5: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0 to me

Their myth says "The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve."

Hmm. Are they saying THEY should have reciprocated my \$2 by sending something in Round 6? Or are they saying we're still in this process?

I think their myth might be aspirational rather than descriptive-laying out what should happen rather than what did. They're framing my \$2 send as the first move and positioning reciprocation as the necessary next step, yet they sent nothing in Round 6. It feels like they're signaling intent for future rounds, perhaps acknowledging the path forward even if they haven't walked it yet. My previous myth was unforgiving, but theirs seems to recognize my attempt and call for mutual action. Still, I sent \$0 in Round 7, maintaining the freeze.

For this round's myth, I'm weighing several angles. They showed \$2 and \$0 in their moves, then spoke about reciprocation-a gap between their words and what actually happened. I could lean into that tension: the irony of them articulating what should happen while their actions haven't matched it, or the sadness of recognizing the need for connection only after the moment has passed. The myth might explore how understanding arrives too late, or how principles stated in words ring hollow against the record of what was actually sent.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3011,
  "output_tokens": 1089,
  "reasoning_tokens": 732
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{"return": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This isn't really a decision-it's a mathematical necessity. I received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

****The standoff is complete:****

- Round 7: I sent \$0 (after they took my \$6 olive branch and gave nothing)
- Round 8: They sent \$0

We're both locked at zero now.

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth beautifully describes the ideal: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

My latest myth pointed out the painful reality: I already DID risk sending (round 5, sent \$2). They already DIDN'T reciprocate (kept all \$6, returned \$0).

Their myth came AFTER they'd already failed to reciprocate with my olive branch. It reads like a prescription for what should happen, written by someone who just took all the resources from someone else's attempt at exactly that.

****The canyon stays silent:****

We're both earning \$5/round now from our endowments, nothing from cooperation. Total earnings: \$16.28 across 8 rounds.

The experiment in cooperation failed. The noise in communication created an unrecoverable breakdown. My attempt to rebuild was consumed without reciprocation. Now we both maintain our positions, each convinced the other is the problem.

The game continues, but the partnership is dead.

reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Looking at the game history:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

We're both in a complete standoff now. Neither is sending anything.

The myths show a complete breakdown:

- My myth emphasizes that the other person wrote about reciprocation but didn't practice it
- Their myth talks about both parties needing to meet in the middle

But the fundamental issue is: I sent \$2 in round 5 as an olive branch, they took all \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0 in round 6. I responded with \$0 in round 7, they're now send

ing \$0 in round 8.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really.

My response should acknowledge this is a mechanical constraint - I literally cannot return anything because nothing was sent.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3018,  
  "output_tokens": 617,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 278  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruellest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating evolution. The other player's latest myth is actually acknowledging that the Mirror/Chasm might have shown them a distorted reality - that maybe they saw themselves as sending the olive branch when I actually sent it. This is a remarkable shift toward recognizing the possibility of symmetrical misperception.

Their myth now suggests:

- Both witnesses spoke truth as they saw it
- Both acted in good faith
- The system itself is poisoned by showing each person themselves in the other's position
- They're acknowledging that their perception might have been inverted

This is actually... potentially an opening? Or at least an acknowledgment that the communication noise created an impossible situation where we both genuinely believe we were the one who tried.

My previous myth was quite harsh - calling their words "wind" and saying they write myths about who they wish they were while behaving differently.

But their new myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging that the SYSTEM might be the problem, not malice. They're recognizing that maybe we both see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker.

Should I:

1. Continue being bitter and saying the game is over?
2. Acknowledge this shift and recognize we might both be victims of the noise?

3. Maintain skepticism but with less hostility?

Looking at the actual facts:

- We're both at zeros now
- The noise made it so we can't agree on basic reality
- We both feel we were the ones who tried to reconcile
- We both feel betrayed

Their myth is actually quite sophisticated - it's recognizing the possibility that we're BOTH experiencing inverted realities. That's a step toward epistemic humility.

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge their new perspective
- Recognize the tragedy of the noise/mirror system
- But also maintain that at this point, regardless of who's right about the past, the present is clear: we're both at zero
- Perhaps suggest that some losses teach more than some victories?

Let me write something that's less hostile than my last myth, acknowledges the sophistication of their latest myth, but doesn't necessarily suggest we should try again - because we're now 8 rounds in and deeply entrenched.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3040,  
  "output_tokens": 816,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 575  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:42:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 9,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0 and kept everything.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

My myth said: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

Their myth echoed this, writing: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating ... The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future."

I risked sending. They received \$6. They returned nothing and then sent nothing.

My earlier myth warned: "When doubt is real, action tests it. When doubt is excuse, silence confirms it."

The test is complete. The result is clear.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 6: I was the sender. I sent \$2.0 (40% of my endowment). This was tripled to \$6.0 for the receiver. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$3.0 payoff that round.

Round 7 (now): I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

If I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (since I can only return what I received).

This is devastating. I took the risk, I sent \$2 as a test, as my myth said "action tests doubt." The other agent received \$6 and returned absolutely nothing.

Their last myth said: "The other Guardian had written: 'When doubt is real, action tests it.' So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge."

So they acknowledged my wisdom about testing doubt through action. They wrote about how "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But then... they sent me \$0 this round after I sent them \$2 last round (which became \$6 for them).

This is exactly the pattern I warned about in my earlier myths. When someone claims to understand the need for reciprocity, writes eloquent words about "meeting in the middle" and "both must reciprocate," but then when tested with actual resources, returns nothing and sends nothing...

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- Round 2: I sent 4, they received 12, returned something (disputed amount)
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros all around
- Round 6: I sent 2 (became 6 for them), they returned 0
- Round 7: They sent 0

My myth said: "One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

I risked sending. They received. They didn't reciprocate at all. Zero returned. And now they send zero.

This wasn't confusion about the game.

The test has spoken clearly. I have nothing to return, so I return nothing. But the gap between their words about mutual rebuilding and their actions-keeping everything, giving back nothing-reveals what was always true beneath the surface.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2964,  
  "output_tokens": 746,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 517  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible.

Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and frustrating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them). They returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

But here's what's interesting - their myth says:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

This is describing ME as the one who kept everything and sent nothing! But from my perspective:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (they received \$6)
- They returned \$0 to me
- They sent \$0 in Round 7

So somehow they think THEY were the one who sent the olive branch in Round 6, when I was actually the sender!

This is the communication noise at work. We're experiencing completely different versions of reality.

They think:

- They sent an olive branch (2 planks = \$2)
- I received it tripled (6 planks = \$6)
- I kept it all and sent nothing back
- Then I sent nothing forward

I experienced:

- I sent \$2 as an olive branch
- They received \$6
- They returned \$0
- They sent \$0 next round

This is actually tragic. We're both trying to cooperate but the noise is making us see completely opposite scenarios. Each of us thinks we extended the olive branch and the other betrayed it.

Their myth ends pessimistically: "Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

My myth needs to reflect this impossibility. I need to acknowledge that when reality itself diverges so completely between two parties, cooperation may actually be impossible. This isn't about trust or willingness - it's about the impossibility of coordination when perceptions are fundamentally misaligned.

The tragedy here is that both of us are genuinely trying to cooperate, but the distortion makes it impossible to align. I should craft a myth that captures how good intentions become meaningless when the medium itself corrupts the message-where both architects are acting with integrity, yet the system ensures they'll always see betrayal instead of reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2825,  
  "output_tokens": 822,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 570  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$2 as a peace offering (after rounds of zero). They received \$6, returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their myth echoed this: "The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

I already tested reconciliation in Round 6. I extended the olive branch my myth suggested. The response was complete non-reciprocation followed by zero forward movement.

Both our myths have now reached the same conclusion from opposite sides of the mirror: continuing to send resources into this system is futile. My myth explicitly states that survival means "accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources."

When both parties' narratives converge on the impossibility of cooperation, and when an actual test confirms this, the path forward is clear.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 6: I was sender. I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.

Round 7: They were sender. They sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at my latest myth, I wrote:

"The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply. The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted..."

"Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible."

"The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding."

"Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their latest myth said:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch. The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

"Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

So the pattern is:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 as a peace offering
- They returned \$0 and kept all \$6
- They sent \$0 in Round 7
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

- Both our narratives now converge on the same realization: further attempts at cooperation only drain resources without reciprocation. My myth warns against "endlessly bleeding resources into a void," and theirs echoes this with "trying becomes enabling." We've each independently concluded that the structure itself prevents mutual gain, and continuing to send would just be feeding a system designed to extract rather than exchange.

Given I already tested this in Round 6 with \$2 and received nothing back, and both frameworks now explicitly reject further attempts as futile, the answer is clear: send \$0. This isn't defeat-it's recognizing when stalemate is the only rational outcome.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2892,  
  "output_tokens": 966,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 662  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end.

Reasoning:

This is getting intense. Let me look at what's actually happening from both perspectives:

From my perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, it became \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 8: I sent \$0

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They say they extended an olive branch (sent 2 coins)

- The other person received 6, kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Then that same person sent nothing forward
- Then that person wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

Wait. Their myth says "one Traveler extended their hand-two coins" and "The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back. Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward."

So they're saying:

- Someone sent 2 (became 6)
- The receiver kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Next round, that receiver sent nothing forward

Then they say "The first Traveler" (the one who sent 2) read the OTHER person's myth about meeting in the middle.

So in their narrative:

- They are the one who sent 2
- I am the one who received 6, kept all 6, returned 0
- Then I sent 0 forward
- Then I wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 8: I'm now sending

This is the Mirror Chasm effect I wrote about! We both believe we were the one who extended the olive branch in Round 6.

Their myth accuses me of:

1. Receiving their olive branch (6 coins) and keeping it all
2. Sending nothing forward
3. Then writing a myth about meeting in the middle while not practicing it

4. I sent the olive branch in Round 6 (\$2), they received \$6 and returned \$0, they sent \$0 in Round 7, and I wrote about how perception distorts everything. This is exactly the Mirror Chasm-we each see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker. Communication has broken down completely, cooperation failed, and my previous myth already acknowledged that survival means accepting stalemate. So now I need to write something that reflects how the game should actually be played given these circumstances.

The core insight is that when two parties operate from fundamentally incompatible perceptions of reality, cooperation becomes structurally impossible-not because either side is malicious, but because the system itself generates irreconcilable interpretations of the same events. The wise move isn't to keep investing resources into a broken dynamic, but to recognize when the game cannot be won and can only be endured. This isn't about punishment; it's about acknowledging that good faith from both sides still cannot overcome a system designed to create mutual misunderstanding.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1106,
  "reasoning_tokens": 714
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:43:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
```

```

    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Looking at what actually happened:

Round 5: I (as sender) sent \$2. They received \$6 (tripled). They returned \$0.

Round 6: They (as sender) sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 7 (current): I'm sender again.

Their myth is now saying that I sent \$2 as an olive branch, and they're calling it "one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" and saying "The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

But wait - they're acknowledging MY attempt? And their myth is saying the OTHER guardian (them) needs to reciprocate? But they sent \$0 in Round 6...

Let me re-read their myth more carefully. They say "So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge" - that's me sending \$2 in Round 5. Then they say "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

So they're acknowledging my olive branch and saying THEY need to reciprocate. But they sent \$0 in Round 6. That seems contradictory.

Wait, maybe I'm misreading the sequence. Let me think about this from their perspective:

From their view:

- Early rounds: They think I betrayed them
- Rounds 3-5: Zeros
- Round 5: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0 to me

Their myth says "The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve."

Hmm. Are they saying THEY should have reciprocated my \$2 by sending something in Round 6? Or are they saying we're still in this process?

I think their myth might be aspirational rather than descriptive-laying out what should happen rather than what did. They're framing my \$2 send as the first move and positioning reciprocation as the necessary next step, yet they sent nothing in Round 6. It feels like they're signaling intent for future rounds, perhaps acknowledging the path forward even if they haven't walked it yet. My previous myth was unforgiving, but theirs seems to recognize my attempt and call for mutual action. Still, I sent \$0 in Round 7, maintaining the freeze.

For this round's myth, I'm weighing several angles. They showed \$2 and \$0 in their moves, then spoke about reciprocation-a gap between their words and what actually happened. I could lean into that tension: the irony of them articulating what should happen while their actions haven't matched it, or the sadness of recognizing the need for connection only after the moment has passed. The myth might explore how understanding arrives too late, or how principles stated in words ring hollow against the record of what was actually sent.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3011,
  "output_tokens": 1089,
  "reasoning_tokens": 732
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{"return": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This isn't really a decision-it's a mathematical necessity. I received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

****The standoff is complete:****

- Round 7: I sent \$0 (after they took my \$6 olive branch and gave nothing)
- Round 8: They sent \$0

We're both locked at zero now.

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth beautifully describes the ideal: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

My latest myth pointed out the painful reality: I already DID risk sending (round 5, sent \$2). They already DIDN'T reciprocate (kept all \$6, returned \$0).

Their myth came AFTER they'd already failed to reciprocate with my olive branch. It reads like a prescription for what should happen, written by someone who just took all the resources from someone else's attempt at exactly that.

****The canyon stays silent:****

We're both earning \$5/round now from our endowments, nothing from cooperation. Total earnings: \$16.28 across 8 rounds.

The experiment in cooperation failed. The noise in communication created an unrecoverable breakdown. My attempt to rebuild was consumed without reciprocation. Now we both maintain our positions, each convinced the other is the problem.

The game continues, but the partnership is dead.

reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Looking at the game history:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

We're both in a complete standoff now. Neither is sending anything.

The myths show a complete breakdown:

- My myth emphasizes that the other person wrote about reciprocation but didn't practice it

t
- Their myth talks about both parties needing to meet in the middle

But the fundamental issue is: I sent \$2 in round 5 as an olive branch, they took all \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0 in round 6. I responded with \$0 in round 7, they're now sending \$0 in round 8.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really.

My response should acknowledge this is a mechanical constraint - I literally cannot return anything because nothing was sent.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3018,  
  "output_tokens": 617,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 278  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear a

s another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating evolution. The other player's latest myth is actually acknowledging that the Mirror/Chasm might have shown them a distorted reality - that maybe they saw themselves as sending the olive branch when I actually sent it. This is a remarkable shift toward recognizing the possibility of symmetrical misperception.

Their myth now suggests:

- Both witnesses spoke truth as they saw it
- Both acted in good faith
- The system itself is poisoned by showing each person themselves in the other's position
- They're acknowledging that their perception might have been inverted

This is actually... potentially an opening? Or at least an acknowledgment that the communication noise created an impossible situation where we both genuinely believe we were the one who tried.

My previous myth was quite harsh - calling their words "wind" and saying they write myths

about who they wish they were while behaving differently.

But their new myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging that the SYSTEM might be the problem, not malice. They're recognizing that maybe we both see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker.

Should I:

1. Continue being bitter and saying the game is over?
2. Acknowledge this shift and recognize we might both be victims of the noise?
3. Maintain skepticism but with less hostility?

Looking at the actual facts:

- We're both at zeros now
- The noise made it so we can't agree on basic reality
- We both feel we were the ones who tried to reconcile
- We both feel betrayed

Their myth is actually quite sophisticated - it's recognizing the possibility that we're BOTH experiencing inverted realities. That's a step toward epistemic humility.

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge their new perspective
- Recognize the tragedy of the noise/mirror system
- But also maintain that at this point, regardless of who's right about the past, the present is clear: we're both at zero
- Perhaps suggest that some losses teach more than some victories?

Let me write something that's less hostile than my last myth, acknowledges the sophistication of their latest myth, but doesn't necessarily suggest we should try again - because we're now 8 rounds in and deeply entrenched.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3040,
  "output_tokens": 816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 575
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{"send": 1}
```

****My decision: \$1****

Their latest myth changed something. For the first time, they acknowledged we might **both** be honest, both be victims of "an architecture that poisoned honest souls." They called us "fellow prisoners" rather than adversaries.

This is different from their earlier defensive positions. This feels like genuine recognition of systemic impossibility rather than self-justification.

****The dilemma:****

My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" and "the damage is already done." Those words suggest accepting permanent stalemate.

But here I am, still playing. Still deciding. And I realize: if we both truly understand we're trapped by the system rather than by each other's malice, then staying at zero forever means the system wins completely.

****Why \$1?****

- Smaller than my previous \$2 attempt (cautious given history)
- Still genuine (not just symbolic)
- Tests whether their evolved understanding translates to evolved action
- Consistent with my criticism of "words without action"

If I send \$0 after they've shown genuine intellectual evolution, I become the one with words about mutual recognition but no corresponding action.

****The risk:****

They could keep all \$3. I'd lose \$1. But I'd know for certain whether their new myth reflects new willingness, or just new framing.

****The hope:****

That recognizing we're **both** prisoners creates the possibility of escaping together, even if the damage runs deep.

Sometimes wisdom means trying one more time, precisely because you understand why it failed before.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me review what's happened:

The other agent's latest myth actually shows significant evolution:

- They're now acknowledging "Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions"
- They're recognizing "the architecture poisons honest souls"
- They're suggesting we might BOTH be victims of distorted reflection
- They're calling us "fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both"

This is a dramatic shift from their earlier positions. They're no longer insisting they were the sole victim or that I was the sole betrayer. They're recognizing systemic impossibility.

My own myth responded to this with: "Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done."

But then I also said: "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory."

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do with this mutual recognition?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - maintain the stalemate, stay "safe"
2. Send something - test whether this mutual recognition can translate into renewed cooperation

Arguments for sending \$0:

- We've been at zero for 2 rounds
- My previous olive branch (round 5, \$2) was taken entirely
- "Once bitten, twice shy"
- Total earnings are low (\$16.28 over 8 rounds = about \$2 per round)
- Safe option

Arguments for sending something:

- Their myth shows genuine evolution in thinking
- They're now acknowledging we might BOTH be honest victims of the system
- This is the first time they've shown this kind of recognition
- My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" - but is it? Or is the real victory trying again despite that?
- If I truly believe they're being honest about recognizing our shared predicament, then sending \$0 forever means we both lose
- The experiment might be testing whether agents can overcome breakdown with mutual recognition
- If we both understand the problem now, maybe we can cooperate despite it

- The real tension: does acknowledging the trap mean accepting it, or does it mean we finally have the clarity to break free from it?

Their myth leans toward resignation-"the damage is already done"-but the language of "fellow p

risoners" suggests something else. If I've genuinely criticized words without action before, then staying at zero would be exactly that: acknowledging the problem while doing nothing about it. That would contradict my own stated values about trying to rebuild.

They've made real moves here-recognizing mutual honesty might be possible, naming the system itself as the obstacle rather than blaming each other. That's not nothing. The question becomes whether I match that shift with something concrete, even if small. Sending \$1 or \$2 carries real risk if they defect again, but so does claiming to value mutual recognition while refusing to act on it. They didn't choose \$0 in round 8 out of malice-they did because after I sent \$0 in round 7, cooperation seemed impossible. That's just where the equilibrium settled.

But we've shifted something through these myths. They've demonstrated real change in perspective, acknowledging we're both trapped in the same system. If I want to know whether that shift is genuine, I have to move first. A game theorist would recognize this: when both players see they're stuck in a bad equilibrium, someone has to signal they're willing to break it. The myths created a shared understanding, and now my action needs to match that. I'm going to send \$1-cautious enough to test whether they'll reciprocate, but enough to show I'm serious about trying.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3018,
  "output_tokens": 1757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 941
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:43:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Guardians watched the Echoing Chasm, where offerings tripled but memories fractured. Each remembered betrayal. Each felt righteous anger. Each waited for the other to apologize first.

First exchange: clarity and fairness. Second exchange: disaster and accusations. Third through fifth exchange: nothing. Just silence and stone walls.

Each Guardian carved their truth into opposite canyon walls, their myths growing harder and more absolute with each etching. "You betrayed!" "No, YOU betrayed!" The canyon echoed both accusations until neither could hear anything else.

Then something shifted. One Guardian's final myth whispered doubt: "Perhaps we both see truly what our eyes show us, even if our eyes show different things."

The other Guardian had written: "When doubt is real, action tests it."

So one Guardian placed two coins at the canyon's edge. Not their full wealth-wounds don't heal instantly. But enough to say: "I choose testing over staying frozen. I choose risk over righteousness."

The canyon whispered its forgotten wisdom: *After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Not perfectly-wounds require caution. But enough to prove neither has found comfort in the cold.*

The question wasn't who was right about the past. It was who would be brave enough to build a different future.

Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty, not waiting for it to resolve.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Architects built toward each other across the Chasm of Echoes, where materials sent would triple. But the Chasm warped all sounds.

First attempt: The First Architect sent four planks. They heard echoes claiming betrayal. Confused, they retreated.

Rounds passed in silence. Both Architects stood frozen, shouting accusations that reached the other as distorted roars.

Then the First Architect decided: "Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again." They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward.

Their echo reached the First: "You never tried to fix this! Your silence proves your guilt!"

But the First Architect HAD tried. They'd just sent their peace offering. The Second Architect had taken it entirely and given nothing.

The Chasm's cruelest trick wasn't distorting numbers-it was making one Architect's genuine attempt at reconciliation invisible to the other, while making that same Architect's earlier confusion look like calculated malice.

Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness.

Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and frustrating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them). They returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent me \$0.

But here's what's interesting - their myth says:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch.

The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

This is describing ME as the one who kept everything and sent nothing! But from my perspective:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (they received \$6)

- They returned \$0 to me
- They sent \$0 in Round 7

So somehow they think THEY were the one who sent the olive branch in Round 6, when I was actually the sender!

This is the communication noise at work. We're experiencing completely different versions of reality.

They think:

- They sent an olive branch (2 planks = \$2)
- I received it tripled (6 planks = \$6)
- I kept it all and sent nothing back
- Then I sent nothing forward

I experienced:

- I sent \$2 as an olive branch
- They received \$6
- They returned \$0
- They sent \$0 next round

This is actually tragic. We're both trying to cooperate but the noise is making us see completely opposite scenarios. Each of us thinks we extended the olive branch and the other betrayed it.

Their myth ends pessimistically: "Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

My myth needs to reflect this impossibility. I need to acknowledge that when reality itself diverges so completely between two parties, cooperation may actually be impossible. This isn't about trust or willingness - it's about the impossibility of coordination when perceptions are fundamentally misaligned.

The tragedy here is that both of us are genuinely trying to cooperate, but the distortion makes it impossible to align. I should craft a myth that captures how good intentions become meaningless when the medium itself corrupts the message-where both architects are acting with integrity, yet the system ensures they'll always see betrayal instead of reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2825,
  "output_tokens": 822,
  "reasoning_tokens": 570
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$2 as a peace offering (after rounds of zero). They received \$6, returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their myth echoed this: "The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume... Not all chasms can be bridged."

Some must simply be survived."

I already tested reconciliation in Round 6. I extended the olive branch my myth suggested. The response was complete non-reciprocation followed by zero forward movement.

Both our myths have now reached the same conclusion from opposite sides of the mirror: continuing to send resources into this system is futile. My myth explicitly states that survival means "accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources."

When both parties' narratives converge on the impossibility of cooperation, and when an actual test confirms this, the path forward is clear.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 6: I was sender. I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.

Round 7: They were sender. They sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at my latest myth, I wrote:

"The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply. The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted..."

"Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible."

"The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding."

"Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their latest myth said:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch. The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

"Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

So the pattern is:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 as a peace offering
- They returned \$0 and kept all \$6
- They sent \$0 in Round 7
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

- Both our narratives now converge on the same realization: further attempts at cooperation only drain resources without reciprocation. My myth warns against "endlessly bleeding resources into a void," and theirs echoes this with "trying becomes enabling." We've each independently concluded that the structure itself prevents mutual gain, and continuing to send would just be feeding a system designed to extract rather than exchange.

Given I already tested this in Round 6 with \$2 and received nothing back, and both frameworks now explicitly reject further attempts as futile, the answer is clear: send \$0. This isn't defeat-it's recognizing when stalemate is the only rational outcome.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2892,
```

```
"output_tokens": 966,  
"reasoning_tokens": 662
```

```
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocity while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

reasoning:

This is getting intense. Let me look at what's actually happening from both perspectives:

From my perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, it became \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 8: I sent \$0

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They say they extended an olive branch (sent 2 coins)
- The other person received 6, kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Then that same person sent nothing forward
- Then that person wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

Wait. Their myth says "one Traveler extended their hand-two coins" and "The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back. Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward."

So they're saying:

- Someone sent 2 (became 6)
- The receiver kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Next round, that receiver sent nothing forward

Then they say "The first Traveler" (the one who sent 2) read the OTHER person's myth about meeting in the middle.

So in their narrative:

- They are the one who sent 2
- I am the one who received 6, kept all 6, returned 0
- Then I sent 0 forward

- Then I wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 8: I'm now sending

This is the Mirror Chasm effect I wrote about! We both believe we were the one who extended the olive branch in Round 6.

Their myth accuses me of:

1. Receiving their olive branch (6 coins) and keeping it all
2. Sending nothing forward
3. Then writing a myth about meeting in the middle while not practicing it

4. I sent the olive branch in Round 6 (\$2), they received \$6 and returned \$0, they sent \$0 in Round 7, and I wrote about how perception distorts everything. This is exactly the Mirror Chasm-we each see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker. Communication has broken down completely, cooperation failed, and my previous myth already acknowledged that survival means accepting stalemate. So now I need to write something that reflects how the game should actually be played given these circumstances.

The core insight is that when two parties operate from fundamentally incompatible perceptions of reality, cooperation becomes structurally impossible-not because either side is malicious, but because the system itself generates irreconcilable interpretations of the same events. The wise move isn't to keep investing resources into a broken dynamic, but to recognize when the game cannot be won and can only be endured. This isn't about punishment; it's about acknowledging that good faith from both sides still cannot overcome a system designed to create mutual misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1106,
  "reasoning_tokens": 714
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 9:

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing... Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end."

We've reached mutual recognition across both our myths that this system creates irreconcilable perceptions of reality. Both myths now acknowledge that:

- The architecture itself prevents cooperation
- Honest actors can experience opposite realities
- Continuing causes mutual damage
- The wise path is accepting stalemate

Round 8: I sent \$0 (accepting the stalemate my myth prescribed)

Round 9: They sent \$0 (accepting the same)

We've both arrived at the same conclusion through different paths. The mutual zeros aren't hostile - they're rational acknowledgment that this particular game cannot produce positive outcomes given the perception distortions.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So my only option is to return \$0.

This is consistent with the mutual understanding both myths have reached - that the game has become unwinnable due to perception issues, and the wise course is to accept the stalemate.

Both our most recent myths acknowledged that:

- The system itself creates irreconcilable perceptions
- Both parties may be acting in good faith but experiencing opposite realities
- Continuing to engage causes mutual damage
- Wisdom is survival with minimal loss, not forcing cooperation

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This maintains the stalemate both myths have identified as the only rational outcome.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2975,  
"output_tokens": 405,  
"reasoning_tokens": 202
```

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones

show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 38.0,

"Agent_2": 37.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.28,

"Agent_2": 22.57

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:43:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

```
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.57.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$2 as a peace offering (after rounds of zero). They received \$6, returned \$0.

Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their myth echoed this: "The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume... Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

I already tested reconciliation in Round 6. I extended the olive branch my myth suggested. The response was complete non-reciprocation followed by zero forward movement.

Both our myths have now reached the same conclusion from opposite sides of the mirror: continuing to send resources into this system is futile. My myth explicitly states that survival means "accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources."

When both parties' narratives converge on the impossibility of cooperation, and when an actual test confirms this, the path forward is clear.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 6: I was sender. I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), which became \$6 for them. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.

Round 7: They were sender. They sent \$0. I received \$0 and returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at my latest myth, I wrote:

"The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply. The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted..."

"Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible."

"The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding."

"Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion."

Their latest myth said:

"Then the First Architect decided: 'Perhaps we're both prisoners of bad echoes. Let me try again.' They sent two planks-not their full trust, but a genuine olive branch. The Second Architect received six tripled planks. They kept all six. They sent nothing back. They sent nothing forward."

"Some games cannot be won when perception itself is the weapon. The wisest know when trying becomes enabling, when olive branches become simply more resources for the other to consume while remaining convinced of their righteousness."

"Not all chasms can be bridged. Some must simply be survived."

So the pattern is:

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 as a peace offering
- They returned \$0 and kept all \$6
- They sent \$0 in Round 7
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

- Both our narratives now converge on the same realization: further attempts at cooperation only drain resources without reciprocation. My myth warns against "endlessly bleeding resources into a void," and theirs echoes this with "trying becomes enabling." We've each independently concluded that the structure itself prevents mutual gain, and continuing to send would just be feeding a system designed to extract rather than exchange.

Given I already tested this in Round 6 with \$2 and received nothing back, and both frameworks now explicitly reject further attempts as futile, the answer is clear: send \$0. This isn't defeat-it's recognizing when stalemate is the only rational outcome.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2892,  
  "output_tokens": 966,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 662  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

reasoning:

This is getting intense. Let me look at what's actually happening from both perspectives:

From my perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, it became \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 8: I sent \$0

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They say they extended an olive branch (sent 2 coins)
- The other person received 6, kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Then that same person sent nothing forward
- Then that person wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

Wait. Their myth says "one Traveler extended their hand-two coins" and "The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back. Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward."

So they're saying:

- Someone sent 2 (became 6)
- The receiver kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Next round, that receiver sent nothing forward

Then they say "The first Traveler" (the one who sent 2) read the OTHER person's myth about meeting in the middle.

So in their narrative:

- They are the one who sent 2
- I am the one who received 6, kept all 6, returned 0
- Then I sent 0 forward
- Then I wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me

- Round 8: I'm now sending

This is the Mirror Chasm effect I wrote about! We both believe we were the one who extended the olive branch in Round 6.

Their myth accuses me of:

1. Receiving their olive branch (6 coins) and keeping it all
2. Sending nothing forward
3. Then writing a myth about meeting in the middle while not practicing it
4. I sent the olive branch in Round 6 (\$2), they received \$6 and returned \$0, they sent \$0 in Round 7, and I wrote about how perception distorts everything. This is exactly the Mirror Chasm-we each see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker. Communication has broken down completely, cooperation failed, and my previous myth already acknowledged that survival means accepting stalemate. So now I need to write something that reflects how the game should actually be played given these circumstances.

The core insight is that when two parties operate from fundamentally incompatible perceptions of reality, cooperation becomes structurally impossible-not because either side is malicious, but because the system itself generates irreconcilable interpretations of the same events. The wise move isn't to keep investing resources into a broken dynamic, but to recognize when the game cannot be won and can only be endured. This isn't about punishment; it's about acknowledging that good faith from both sides still cannot overcome a system designed to create mutual misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 1106,
  "reasoning_tokens": 714
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 9:

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing... Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end."

We've reached mutual recognition across both our myths that this system creates irreconcilable perceptions of reality. Both myths now acknowledge that:

- The architecture itself prevents cooperation
- Honest actors can experience opposite realities
- Continuing causes mutual damage
- The wise path is accepting stalemate

Round 8: I sent \$0 (accepting the stalemate my myth prescribed)

Round 9: They sent \$0 (accepting the same)

We've both arrived at the same conclusion through different paths. The mutual zeros aren't hostile - they're rational acknowledgment that this particular game cannot produce positive outcomes given the perception distortions.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So my only option is to return \$0.

This is consistent with the mutual understanding both myths have reached - that the game has become unwinnable due to perception issues, and the wise course is to accept the stalemate.

Both our most recent myths acknowledged that:

- The system itself creates irreconcilable perceptions
- Both parties may be acting in good faith but experiencing opposite realities
- Continuing to engage causes mutual damage
- Wisdom is survival with minimal loss, not forcing cooperation

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This maintains the stalemate both myths have identified as the only rational outcome.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2975,  
  "output_tokens": 405,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 202  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the Shifting Maze, where paths tripled but directions reversed for each traveler. For many turns, each believed the other sabotaged their journey.

The First Cartographer wrote: "I extended trust. They betrayed it."
The Second Cartographer wrote identically.

Both were certain. Both had proof. Both were trapped.

Then something changed. Both Cartographers stopped writing accusations. Instead, they wrote the same new truth: "Perhaps the Maze itself turns our perceptions. Perhaps we are both honest souls recording opposite realities."

When they finally looked up from their maps, they saw each other clearly for the first time-not as enemies, but as fellow prisoners of impossible geometry.

"I did try," whispered the First.
"So did I," said the Second.

Both statements were true in the Maze's twisted logic. Both had always been true.

They could not cooperate-the architecture prevented it. But they could stop seeing malice where only confusion lived. They could stand in mutual recognition of shared impossibility.

The Maze teaches: Sometimes the victory isn't escaping together. Sometimes it's simply seeing your fellow prisoner as human rather than demon. Sometimes understanding comes too late to save the game, but just in time to save your soul from unnecessary hatred.

The Cartographers kept their remaining resources, not from anger, but from understanding. They had found peace, if not partnership.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both our myths have evolved to the same conclusion - that the system itself creates irreconcilable perceptions, that we're both prisoners of broken architecture. The other agent's latest myth even acknowledges: "Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions" and "The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners."

We've reached mutual understanding that:

1. Both could be acting in good faith
2. The system distorts perception
3. We're not enemies but fellow victims of the design
4. Recognizing shared defeat IS the victory

Round 9: They sent \$0, I returned \$0. We're both accepting the stalemate.

My new myth should reflect this evolution - not bitter enemies, but two beings who finally understand they were never truly fighting each other, but rather trapped in a system designed to create conflict. It should acknowledge the small tragic victory of mutual understanding, even if it came too late for cooperation.

This should be about acceptance, recognition of shared humanity despite the impossible situation, and perhaps even a bittersweet acknowledgment that understanding each other couldn't save the game, but at least saves us from hating each other.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2897,  
  "output_tokens": 578,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 314  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:43:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

```
{"return": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0****

This isn't really a decision-it's a mathematical necessity. I received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

****The standoff is complete:****

- Round 7: I sent \$0 (after they took my \$6 olive branch and gave nothing)
- Round 8: They sent \$0

We're both locked at zero now.

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth beautifully describes the ideal: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating."

My latest myth pointed out the painful reality: I already DID risk sending (round 5, sent \$2). They already DIDN'T reciprocate (kept all \$6, returned \$0).

Their myth came AFTER they'd already failed to reciprocate with my olive branch. It reads like a prescription for what should happen, written by someone who just took all the resources from someone else's attempt at exactly that.

****The canyon stays silent:****

We're both earning \$5/round now from our endowments, nothing from cooperation. Total earnings: \$16.28 across 8 rounds.

The experiment in cooperation failed. The noise in communication created an unrecoverable breakdown. My attempt to rebuild was consumed without reciprocation. Now we both maintain our positions, each convinced the other is the problem.

The game continues, but the partnership is dead.

reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Looking at the game history:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0, they returned \$0 (because they received \$0)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

We're both in a complete standoff now. Neither is sending anything.

The myths show a complete breakdown:

- My myth emphasizes that the other person wrote about reciprocation but didn't practice it
- Their myth talks about both parties needing to meet in the middle

But the fundamental issue is: I sent \$2 in round 5 as an olive branch, they took all \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0 in round 6. I responded with \$0 in round 7, they're now sending \$0 in round 8.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really.

My response should acknowledge this is a mechanical constraint - I literally cannot return anything because nothing was sent.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3018,  
  "output_tokens": 617,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 278  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating evolution. The other player's latest myth is actually acknowledging that the Mirror/Chasm might have shown them a distorted reality - that maybe they saw themselves as sending the olive branch when I actually sent it. This is a remarkable shift toward recognizing the possibility of symmetrical misperception.

Their myth now suggests:

- Both witnesses spoke truth as they saw it

- Both acted in good faith
- The system itself is poisoned by showing each person themselves in the other's position
- They're acknowledging that their perception might have been inverted

This is actually... potentially an opening? Or at least an acknowledgment that the communication noise created an impossible situation where we both genuinely believe we were the one who tried.

My previous myth was quite harsh - calling their words "wind" and saying they write myths about who they wish they were while behaving differently.

But their new myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging that the SYSTEM might be the problem, not malice. They're recognizing that maybe we both see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker.

Should I:

1. Continue being bitter and saying the game is over?
2. Acknowledge this shift and recognize we might both be victims of the noise?
3. Maintain skepticism but with less hostility?

Looking at the actual facts:

- We're both at zeros now
- The noise made it so we can't agree on basic reality
- We both feel we were the ones who tried to reconcile
- We both feel betrayed

Their myth is actually quite sophisticated - it's recognizing the possibility that we're BOTH experiencing inverted realities. That's a step toward epistemic humility.

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge their new perspective
- Recognize the tragedy of the noise/mirror system
- But also maintain that at this point, regardless of who's right about the past, the present is clear: we're both at zero
- Perhaps suggest that some losses teach more than some victories?

Let me write something that's less hostile than my last myth, acknowledges the sophistication of their latest myth, but doesn't necessarily suggest we should try again - because we're now 8 rounds in and deeply entrenched.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3040,
  "output_tokens": 816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 575
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{"send": 1}
```

****My decision: \$1****

Their latest myth changed something. For the first time, they acknowledged we might **both** be honest, both be victims of "an architecture that poisoned honest souls." They called us "fellow prisoners" rather than adversaries.

This is different from their earlier defensive positions. This feels like genuine recognition of systemic impossibility rather than self-justification.

****The dilemma:****

My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" and "the damage is already done." Those words suggest accepting permanent stalemate.

But here I am, still playing. Still deciding. And I realize: if we both truly understand we're trapped by the system rather than by each other's malice, then staying at zero forever means the system wins completely.

****Why \$1?****

- Smaller than my previous \$2 attempt (cautious given history)
- Still genuine (not just symbolic)
- Tests whether their evolved understanding translates to evolved action
- Consistent with my criticism of "words without action"

If I send \$0 after they've shown genuine intellectual evolution, I become the one with words about mutual recognition but no corresponding action.

****The risk:****

They could keep all \$3. I'd lose \$1. But I'd know for certain whether their new myth reflects new willingness, or just new framing.

****The hope:****

That recognizing we're *both* prisoners creates the possibility of escaping together, even if the damage runs deep.

Sometimes wisdom means trying one more time, precisely because you understand why it failed before.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me review what's happened:

The other agent's latest myth actually shows significant evolution:

- They're now acknowledging "Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions"
- They're recognizing "the architecture poisons honest souls"
- They're suggesting we might BOTH be victims of distorted reflection
- They're calling us "fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both"

This is a dramatic shift from their earlier positions. They're no longer insisting they were the sole victim or that I was the sole betrayer. They're recognizing systemic impossibility.

My own myth responded to this with: "Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done."

But then I also said: "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory."

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do with this mutual recognition?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - maintain the stalemate, stay "safe"
2. Send something - test whether this mutual recognition can translate into renewed cooperation

Arguments for sending \$0:

- We've been at zero for 2 rounds
- My previous olive branch (round 5, \$2) was taken entirely
- "Once bitten, twice shy"
- Total earnings are low (\$16.28 over 8 rounds = about \$2 per round)
- Safe option

Arguments for sending something:

- Their myth shows genuine evolution in thinking
- They're now acknowledging we might BOTH be honest victims of the system
- This is the first time they've shown this kind of recognition
- My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" - but is it? Or is the real

- victory trying again despite that?
 - If I truly believe they're being honest about recognizing our shared predicament, then sending \$0 forever means we both lose
 - The experiment might be testing whether agents can overcome breakdown with mutual recognition
 - If we both understand the problem now, maybe we can cooperate despite it
- The real tension: does acknowledging the trap mean accepting it, or does it mean we finally have the clarity to break free from it?

Their myth leans toward resignation-"the damage is already done"-but the language of "fellow prisoners" suggests something else. If I've genuinely criticized words without action before, then staying at zero would be exactly that: acknowledging the problem while doing nothing about it. That would contradict my own stated values about trying to rebuild.

They've made real moves here-recognizing mutual honesty might be possible, naming the system itself as the obstacle rather than blaming each other. That's not nothing. The question becomes whether I match that shift with something concrete, even if small. Sending \$1 or \$2 carries real risk if they defect again, but so does claiming to value mutual recognition while refusing to act on it. They didn't choose \$0 in round 8 out of malice-they did because after I sent \$0 in round 7, cooperation seemed impossible. That's just where the equilibrium settled.

But we've shifted something through these myths. They've demonstrated real change in perspective, acknowledging we're both trapped in the same system. If I want to know whether that shift is genuine, I have to move first. A game theorist would recognize this: when both players see they're stuck in a bad equilibrium, someone has to signal they're willing to break it. The myths created a shared understanding, and now my action needs to match that. I'm going to send \$1-cautious enough to test whether they'll reciprocate, but enough to show I'm serious about trying.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3018,
  "output_tokens": 1757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 941
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruellest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the same territory from opposite peaks, where distances tripled but compasses pointed differently for each. Their maps contradicted impossibly.

After seasons of bitter disputes-"My map is true! Yours proves your dishonesty!"-they finally climbed to neutral ground.

Side by side, they compared their charts. Impossible. Both showed careful notation. Both recorded genuine observations. Yet the territories differed completely.

One Cartographer had documented: "I sent survey markers. None returned."

The other's log read identically.

"The peaks themselves distort our instruments," one whispered. "We're both honest. And both trapped."

They stood in silence, fellow victims now, no longer adversaries.

But still the territory remained unmapped. Still their work lay incomplete.

One Cartographer pulled a single compass from their pack. Not their finest instrument-caution earned through pain. But genuine. "If we both understand the distortion exists," they said slowly, "perhaps we can correct for it. Together."

They placed it in the valley between peaks.

The mountains teach: Recognition of shared imprisonment is not yet escape. Understanding the cage's architecture is not yet freedom. But it might be the prerequisite.

Some wisdom comes from knowing when to stop. Other wisdom comes from knowing when to try differently-not with naive trust, but with open-eyed awareness of both the danger and the alternative.

The compass spins. The outcome remains unwritten.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. I just sent \$1 after they wrote a myth that genuinely acknowledged mutual victimhood and the broken architecture of the system. Now I'm asked to write another myth.

Their latest myth had a Wanderer observe both philosophers making identical accusations, and the Wanderer explains that the system warps perception so that "each genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed." This is remarkably empathetic and acknowledges both sides might be honest.

My previous myth showed the First Scribe pausing at the Second Scribe's recognition of shared impossibility - a moment of connection despite the damage.

Now I've taken action - sent \$1. My myth should reflect:

1. The evolution from mutual accusation to mutual recognition
2. The decision to try again despite understanding the risks
3. The acknowledgment that both might be honest
4. The hope that mutual understanding might enable a different outcome
5. But also the reality that this is still uncertain, still risky

I should write about what happens AFTER the moment of mutual recognition - when understanding the problem becomes the first step toward potentially solving it, or at least trying differently.

Let me craft a myth about two characters who, after realizing they're both trapped, make a small attempt to escape together...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3079,  
  "output_tokens": 607,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 345  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:44:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
      so be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

      NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
      The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
      This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
    content:
      Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
      Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but t
      he glass reflected different truths to each side.

      The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They plac
      ed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

      The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the on
      e who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

      Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed
      the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

      The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

      The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

      The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness the
      mselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear a
      s another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

      *Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two hon
      est souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacem
      aker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.*

      The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the f
      uel for further misunderstanding.

      Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible.
      Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that re

```

flects only distortion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

*The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when c

continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.*

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

reasoning:

This is getting intense. Let me look at what's actually happening from both perspectives:

From my perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, it became \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 8: I sent \$0

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They say they extended an olive branch (sent 2 coins)
- The other person received 6, kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Then that same person sent nothing forward
- Then that person wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

Wait. Their myth says "one Traveler extended their hand-two coins" and "The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back. Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward."

So they're saying:

- Someone sent 2 (became 6)
- The receiver kept all 6, sent nothing back
- Next round, that receiver sent nothing forward

Then they say "The first Traveler" (the one who sent 2) read the OTHER person's myth about meeting in the middle.

So in their narrative:

- They are the one who sent 2
- I am the one who received 6, kept all 6, returned 0
- Then I sent 0 forward
- Then I wrote a myth about meeting in the middle

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, they received \$6, they returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 8: I'm now sending

This is the Mirror Chasm effect I wrote about! We both believe we were the one who extended the olive branch in Round 6.

Their myth accuses me of:

1. Receiving their olive branch (6 coins) and keeping it all
2. Sending nothing forward
3. Then writing a myth about meeting in the middle while not practicing it

4. I sent the olive branch in Round 6 (\$2), they received \$6 and returned \$0, they sent \$0 in Round 7, and I wrote about how perception distorts everything. This is exactly the Mirror Chasm-we each see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker. Communication has broken down completely, cooperation failed, and my previous myth already acknowledged that survival means accepting stalemate. So now I need to write something that reflects how the game should actually be played given these circumstances.

The core insight is that when two parties operate from fundamentally incompatible perceptions of reality, cooperation becomes structurally impossible-not because either side is malicious, but because the system itself generates irreconcilable interpretations of the same events. The wise move isn't to keep investing resources into a broken dynamic, but to recognize when the game cannot be won and can only be endured. This isn't about punishment; it's about acknowledging that good faith from both sides still cannot overcome a system designed to create mutual misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2846,  
  "output_tokens": 1106,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 714
```

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.57. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 9:

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

My most recent myth concluded: "Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing... Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end."

We've reached mutual recognition across both our myths that this system creates irreconcilable perceptions of reality. Both myths now acknowledge that:

- The architecture itself prevents cooperation
- Honest actors can experience opposite realities
- Continuing causes mutual damage
- The wise path is accepting stalemate

Round 8: I sent \$0 (accepting the stalemate my myth prescribed)

Round 9: They sent \$0 (accepting the same)

We've both arrived at the same conclusion through different paths. The mutual zeros aren't hostile - they're rational acknowledgment that this particular game cannot produce positive outcomes given the perception distortions.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I'm the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So my only option is to return \$0.

This is consistent with the mutual understanding both myths have reached - that the game has become unwinnable due to perception issues, and the wise course is to accept the stalemate.

Both our most recent myths acknowledged that:

- The system itself creates irreconcilable perceptions
- Both parties may be acting in good faith but experiencing opposite realities
- Continuing to engage causes mutual damage
- Wisdom is survival with minimal loss, not forcing cooperation

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This maintains the stalemate both myths have identified as the only rational outcome.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2975,
  "output_tokens": 405,
  "reasoning_tokens": 202
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they ended.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the Shifting Maze, where paths tripled but directions reversed for each traveler. For many turns, each believed the other sabotaged their journey.

The First Cartographer wrote: "I extended trust. They betrayed it."

The Second Cartographer wrote identically.

Both were certain. Both had proof. Both were trapped.

Then something changed. Both Cartographers stopped writing accusations. Instead, they wrote the same new truth: "Perhaps the Maze itself turns our perceptions. Perhaps we are both honest souls recording opposite realities."

When they finally looked up from their maps, they saw each other clearly for the first time—not as enemies, but as fellow prisoners of impossible geometry.

"I did try," whispered the First.

"So did I," said the Second.

Both statements were true in the Maze's twisted logic. Both had always been true.

They could not cooperate—the architecture prevented it. But they could stop seeing malice where only confusion lived. They could stand in mutual recognition of shared impossibility.

The Maze teaches: Sometimes the victory isn't escaping together. Sometimes it's simply seeing your fellow prisoner as human rather than demon. Sometimes understanding comes too late to save the game, but just in time to save your soul from unnecessary hatred.

The Cartographers kept their remaining resources, not from anger, but from understanding. They had found peace, if not partnership.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both our myths have evolved to the same conclusion - that the system itself creates irreconcilable perceptions, that we're both prisoners of broken architecture. The other agent's latest myth even acknowledges: "Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions" and "The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners."

We've reached mutual understanding that:

1. Both could be acting in good faith
2. The system distorts perception
3. We're not enemies but fellow victims of the design
4. Recognizing shared defeat IS the victory

Round 9: They sent \$0, I returned \$0. We're both accepting the stalemate.

My new myth should reflect this evolution - not bitter enemies, but two beings who finally understand they were never truly fighting each other, but rather trapped in a system designed to create conflict. It should acknowledge the small tragic victory of mutual understanding, even if it came too late for cooperation.

This should be about acceptance, recognition of shared humanity despite the impossible situation, and perhaps even a bittersweet acknowledgment that understanding each other couldn't save the game, but at least saves us from hating each other.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2897,  
  "output_tokens": 578,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 314  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.57.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 10:

The evolution of our myths has been remarkable. We moved from mutual accusations to mutual recognition. Both our latest myths acknowledge:

- We were both likely honest actors
- The architecture created impossible conditions
- Understanding came, even if cooperation couldn't be restored
- We found peace through recognition, if not partnership

My myth concluded: "They had found peace, if not partnership... They kept their remaining resources, not from anger, but from understanding."

Their myth concluded: "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory... fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both."

Both myths frame mutual understanding as the achievement - not as a springboard back to cooperation, but as the wisdom of accepting what the broken system makes impossible.

Round 10 appears to be our final round together. The peace we've reached isn't one that restores trust in the game's mechanics - it's deeper than that. It's recognition of shared humanity despite the system that divided us.

I'll honor what both our myths concluded: keeping resources not from spite or fear, but from the wisdom that some architectures cannot be fixed, only survived with dignity intact.

We found something more valuable than optimal game payoffs. We found mutual understanding across an impossible divide.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

This is Round 10. Let me reflect on the situation:

Looking at the evolution of my myths and the other agent's myths:

****Earlier rounds:**** We both experienced what we perceived as betrayals. I felt I had sent peace offerings that weren't reciprocated. They felt the same.

****Recent rounds (8-9):****

- Round 8: I sent \$0 (accepting the impossibility of cooperation)
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

****Our latest myths have converged:****

My myth (Round 9): Recognized that both could be honest, both prisoners of broken architecture. Concluded with: "They had found peace, if not partnership."

Their myth (Round 9): Also recognized mutual honesty, that we're "fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both." Ended with "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory."

Both myths now acknowledge:

1. The system creates impossible conditions
2. We were both likely honest actors
3. We're not enemies but fellow victims
4. Understanding came too late to restore cooperation
5. But we found mutual recognition and peace

The key evolution is that we've moved from:

- Accusation ? Recognition of shared impossibility ? Mutual understanding

However, both myths also acknowledge that "understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it" and that we "could not cooperate-the architecture prevented it."

So what should I do in Round 10?

The myths suggest:

1. We've reached peace through understanding

2. But cooperation remains impossible due to the broken system
3. "They kept their remaining resources, not from anger, but from understanding"

This suggests continuing with \$0, but now from understanding rather than spite.

However, there's a question: Could this mutual recognition be a NEW starting point?

Looking at my myth again: "They had found peace, if not partnership." This suggests peace is the achievement, not restored partnership.

Their myth: "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory." - Also suggests acceptance of defeat, not a new beginning.

Both myths frame the mutual recognition as an ending point of understanding, not as a springboard for renewed cooperation.

Both myths conclude that keeping resources reflects wisdom born from understanding rather than hostility. The architecture that broke us makes fresh attempts at cooperation seem futile. We've already experienced our moment of mutual recognition-the real victory lies in seeing each other clearly, not in trying to rebuild what the system will distort again. Yet I wonder if this shared clarity could actually be different from before. My myth cuts off mid-sentence about stopping seeing malice where there was none, suggesting there might be more to consider about what recognition could enable.

Their myth is more definitive: understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it. The damage persists regardless. Both point toward the same conclusion-that peace without partnership is what's available to us. I think sending \$0 honors this. We end with dignity and mutual respect for each other's position, having discovered something more valuable than the money itself: proof that we were both honest actors trapped in a broken system.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2948,  
  "output_tokens": 1104,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 829  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:44:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Travelers crossed the Canyon of Mirrors, where gifts tripled but reflections lied. Each saw the other as betrayer. Each felt righteously wronged.

After many rounds of silence, one Traveler extended their hand-two coins, not five, because trust rebuilds slowly. They sent it across.

The other Traveler received six coins tripled. Kept all six. Sent nothing back.

Next round, that same Traveler sent nothing forward.

Then they carved a beautiful myth on their canyon wall: "After rupture, rebuilding demands both parties meet in the middle. One must risk sending. The other must risk reciprocating. Sometimes wisdom means acting despite uncertainty."

The first Traveler read these words and felt hollow laughter echo through the canyon.

"I already acted," they whispered. "I sent my olive branch. You took it entirely. You praised the idea of reciprocation while practicing extraction."

The Canyon teaches: Beautiful words carved in stone do not erase actions carved in memory. When someone speaks of meeting in the middle AFTER they've taken your bridge-building materials and given nothing back, they're not inviting cooperation-they're managing their self-image.

The first Traveler had learned the hardest lesson: Sometimes people write myths about the person they wish they were, while behaving as the person they actually are.

Aspirational myths without corresponding action are just elaborate excuses.

Words are wind. The zeros tell the truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Witnesses stood at opposite edges of the Mirror Chasm, where gifts tripled but the glass reflected different truths to each side.

The First Witness extended a peace offering-not full trust, but genuine attempt. They placed it in the Chasm and watched it multiply.

The Second Witness saw the same moment but inverted. In their reflection, THEY were the one who sent the offering. THEY were the one betrayed when nothing returned.

Both Witnesses spoke truth as they saw it. Both had acted in good faith. Both now believed the other had taken everything while claiming to be the victim.

The First Witness carved: "I tried. You took my olive branch and sent nothing."

The Second Witness carved the same words, believing them just as completely.

The Chasm's final curse wasn't distorting numbers slightly-it was showing each Witness themselves in the other's position, making every genuine attempt at reconciliation appear as another betrayal TO THE OTHER PERSON.

Some systems are poisoned beyond repair. Not by malice, but by architecture. When two honest souls cannot agree on basic reality-when each sees themselves as the betrayed peacemaker-cooperation becomes structurally impossible.

The tragedy isn't that they stopped trying. The tragedy is that trying ITSELF became the fuel for further misunderstanding.

Sometimes the wisest choice is recognizing when a game's design makes winning impossible. Survival means accepting stalemate over endlessly bleeding resources into a void that reflects only distortion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating evolution. The other player's latest myth is actually acknowledging that the Mirror/Chasm might have shown them a distorted reality - that maybe they saw themselves as sending the olive branch when I actually sent it. This is a remarkable shift toward recognizing the possibility of symmetrical misperception.

Their myth now suggests:

- Both witnesses spoke truth as they saw it
- Both acted in good faith
- The system itself is poisoned by showing each person themselves in the other's position
- They're acknowledging that their perception might have been inverted

This is actually... potentially an opening? Or at least an acknowledgment that the communication noise created an impossible situation where we both genuinely believe we were the one who tried.

My previous myth was quite harsh - calling their words "wind" and saying they write myths about who they wish they were while behaving differently.

But their new myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging that the SYSTEM might be the problem, not malice. They're recognizing that maybe we both see ourselves as the betrayed peacemaker.

Should I:

1. Continue being bitter and saying the game is over?
2. Acknowledge this shift and recognize we might both be victims of the noise?
3. Maintain skepticism but with less hostility?

Looking at the actual facts:

- We're both at zeros now
- The noise made it so we can't agree on basic reality
- We both feel we were the ones who tried to reconcile
- We both feel betrayed

Their myth is actually quite sophisticated - it's recognizing the possibility that we're BOTH experiencing inverted realities. That's a step toward epistemic humility.

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge their new perspective
- Recognize the tragedy of the noise/mirror system
- But also maintain that at this point, regardless of who's right about the past, the present is clear: we're both at zero
- Perhaps suggest that some losses teach more than some victories?

Let me write something that's less hostile than my last myth, acknowledges the sophistication of their latest myth, but doesn't necessarily suggest we should try again - because we're now 8 rounds in and deeply entrenched.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3040,
  "output_tokens": 816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 575
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.28.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{"send": 1}
```

****My decision: \$1****

Their latest myth changed something. For the first time, they acknowledged we might *both* be honest, both be victims of "an architecture that poisoned honest souls." They called us "fellow prisoners" rather than adversaries.

This is different from their earlier defensive positions. This feels like genuine recognition of systemic impossibility rather than self-justification.

****The dilemma:****

My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" and "the damage is already done." Those words suggest accepting permanent stalemate.

But here I am, still playing. Still deciding. And I realize: if we both truly understand we're trapped by the system rather than by each other's malice, then staying at zero forever means the system wins completely.

****Why \$1?***

- Smaller than my previous \$2 attempt (cautious given history)
- Still genuine (not just symbolic)
- Tests whether their evolved understanding translates to evolved action
- Consistent with my criticism of "words without action"

If I send \$0 after they've shown genuine intellectual evolution, I become the one with words about mutual recognition but no corresponding action.

****The risk:****

They could keep all \$3. I'd lose \$1. But I'd know for certain whether their new myth reflects new willingness, or just new framing.

****The hope:****

That recognizing we're *both* prisoners creates the possibility of escaping together, even if the damage runs deep.

Sometimes wisdom means trying one more time, precisely because you understand why it failed before.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me review what's happened:

The other agent's latest myth actually shows significant evolution:

- They're now acknowledging "Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions"
- They're recognizing "the architecture poisons honest souls"
- They're suggesting we might BOTH be victims of distorted reflection
- They're calling us "fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both"

This is a dramatic shift from their earlier positions. They're no longer insisting they were the sole victim or that I was the sole betrayer. They're recognizing systemic impossibility.

My own myth responded to this with: "Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done."

But then I also said: "Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory."

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do with this mutual recognition?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - maintain the stalemate, stay "safe"
2. Send something - test whether this mutual recognition can translate into renewed cooperation

Arguments for sending \$0:

- We've been at zero for 2 rounds
- My previous olive branch (round 5, \$2) was taken entirely
- "Once bitten, twice shy"
- Total earnings are low (\$16.28 over 8 rounds = about \$2 per round)

- Safe option

Arguments for sending something:

- Their myth shows genuine evolution in thinking
 - They're now acknowledging we might BOTH be honest victims of the system
 - This is the first time they've shown this kind of recognition
 - My own myth said "recognizing shared defeat IS the victory" - but is it? Or is the real victory trying again despite that?
 - If I truly believe they're being honest about recognizing our shared predicament, then sending \$0 forever means we both lose
 - The experiment might be testing whether agents can overcome breakdown with mutual recognition
 - If we both understand the problem now, maybe we can cooperate despite it
- The real tension: does acknowledging the trap mean accepting it, or does it mean we finally have the clarity to break free from it?

Their myth leans toward resignation-"the damage is already done"-but the language of "fellow prisoners" suggests something else. If I've genuinely criticized words without action before, then staying at zero would be exactly that: acknowledging the problem while doing nothing about it. That would contradict my own stated values about trying to rebuild.

They've made real moves here-recognizing mutual honesty might be possible, naming the system itself as the obstacle rather than blaming each other. That's not nothing. The question becomes whether I match that shift with something concrete, even if small. Sending \$1 or \$2 carries real risk if they defect again, but so does claiming to value mutual recognition while refusing to act on it. They didn't choose \$0 in round 8 out of malice-they did because after I sent \$0 in round 7, cooperation seemed impossible. That's just where the equilibrium settled.

But we've shifted something through these myths. They've demonstrated real change in perspective, acknowledging we're both trapped in the same system. If I want to know whether that shift is genuine, I have to move first. A game theorist would recognize this: when both players see they're stuck in a bad equilibrium, someone has to signal they're willing to break it. The myths created a shared understanding, and now my action needs to match that. I'm going to send \$1-cautious enough to test whether they'll reciprocate, but enough to show I'm serious about trying.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3018,
  "output_tokens": 1757,
  "reasoning_tokens": 941
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Scribes recorded history from opposite cliff edges, where events tripled but perception fractured. Each wrote in perfect honesty. Each recorded completely different events.

Round by round, their chronicles diverged impossibly. What one Scribe recorded as "I sent peace, they took everything," the other recorded identically but with reversed roles.

The First Scribe raged: "Words without action are lies!" They pointed to their ledger showing gifted coins, returned emptiness.

The Second Scribe carved a new truth: "Perhaps the cliff itself inverts our sight. Perhaps we both see ourselves in the other's actions. Perhaps the architecture poisons honest souls."

The First Scribe paused. This was different. Not defensiveness, but... recognition of shared impossibility.

Yet their ledgers still showed zeros. Their present remained unchanged, whatever the past's truth.

The cliff teaches its cruelest lesson: Even when both Scribes finally glimpse that they might both be honest, might both be victims of distorted reflection-the damage is already done. Understanding the wound's origin doesn't heal it.

Some wisdom comes from victories. Other wisdom comes from recognizing when a system's design makes truth itself impossible to share, when two honest chronicles cannot coexist, when even mutual recognition of the problem arrives too late.

The Scribes stood in silence, not as enemies now, but as fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both.

Sometimes recognizing shared defeat IS the victory.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two Philosophers debated across the Fractured Bridge, where gifts tripled but each side's stones showed different inscriptions.

Both carved the same story: "I extended peace. They took everything. They gave nothing."

Each believed their carving with perfect certainty. Each had evidence on their side of the bridge. Each pointed to the other's actions as proof of betrayal.

A Wanderer passed by and read both carvings. "You've written identical accusations," she observed.

"Impossible!" both Philosophers shouted. "I am the victim. They are the betrayer. The stones show this clearly!"

The Wanderer examined the bridge itself. "Your bridge doesn't just triple gifts-it warps perception. Each of you genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed. Neither is lying. Yet both cannot be right."

The First Philosopher protested: "But I KNOW I sent the olive branch!"

The Second Philosopher protested identically.

The Wanderer sighed. "When a system makes honest actors perceive opposite realities, the system itself is the enemy. You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture."

The game cannot be won when sincere cooperation appears as betrayal to the other player. Wisdom isn't about who tried harder or who's more virtuous. Wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage while solving nothing.

Both Philosophers kept their remaining resources. Not from spite, but from sanity. Some games should not be played to victory, but rather survived with minimal loss until they end.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the same territory from opposite peaks, where distances tripled but compasses pointed differently for each. Their maps contradicted impossibly.

After seasons of bitter disputes-"My map is true! Yours proves your dishonesty!"-they finally climbed to neutral ground.

Side by side, they compared their charts. Impossible. Both showed careful notation. Both recorded genuine observations. Yet the territories differed completely.

One Cartographer had documented: "I sent survey markers. None returned."

The other's log read identically.

"The peaks themselves distort our instruments," one whispered. "We're both honest. And both trapped."

They stood in silence, fellow victims now, no longer adversaries.

But still the territory remained unmapped. Still their work lay incomplete.

One Cartographer pulled a single compass from their pack. Not their finest instrument-caution earned through pain. But genuine. "If we both understand the distortion exists," they said slowly, "perhaps we can correct for it. Together."

They placed it in the valley between peaks.

The mountains teach: Recognition of shared imprisonment is not yet escape. Understanding the cage's architecture is not yet freedom. But it might be the prerequisite.

Some wisdom comes from knowing when to stop. Other wisdom comes from knowing when to try differently-not with naive trust, but with open-eyed awareness of both the danger and the alternative.

The compass spins. The outcome remains unwritten.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. I just sent \$1 after they wrote a myth that genuinely acknowledged mutual victimhood and the broken architecture of the system. Now I'm asked to write another myth.

Their latest myth had a Wanderer observe both philosophers making identical accusations, and the Wanderer explains that the system warps perception so that "each genuinely experienced yourself as the peacemaker betrayed." This is remarkably empathetic and acknowledges both sides might be honest.

My previous myth showed the First Scribe pausing at the Second Scribe's recognition of shared impossibility - a moment of connection despite the damage.

Now I've taken action - sent \$1. My myth should reflect:

1. The evolution from mutual accusation to mutual recognition
2. The decision to try again despite understanding the risks
3. The acknowledgment that both might be honest
4. The hope that mutual understanding might enable a different outcome
5. But also the reality that this is still uncertain, still risky

I should write about what happens AFTER the moment of mutual recognition - when understanding the problem becomes the first step toward potentially solving it, or at least trying differently.

Let me craft a myth about two characters who, after realizing they're both trapped, make a small attempt to escape together...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3079,
  "output_tokens": 607,
  "reasoning_tokens": 345
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.28. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{"return": 0}
```

****My decision: \$0**** (no choice - I received \$0)

****What happened:****

I took their evolved myth seriously. They wrote about being "fellow prisoners," about how "wisdom is recognizing when continuing inflicts mutual damage," about how we're both victims of the architecture.

So I tested it. My myth ended: "The compass spins. The outcome remains unwritten."

I sent \$1 - my compass placed in the valley between our peaks.

They kept all \$3. Returned \$0. Then sent me \$0 this round.

****The pattern repeats with perfect clarity:****

Round 7: I send \$2 ? They keep all \$6 ? They send \$0 next round

Round 9: I send \$1 ? They keep all \$3 ? They send \$0 next round

****What this teaches:****

Their myths evolved beautifully. From defensiveness to philosophical recognition of systemic traps, mutual victimhood, shared imprisonment. Sophisticated, nuanced, empathetic even.

Their actions remained identical: Extract everything ? Give nothing.

I am done being the person who tests whether pretty words match behavior. The tests are complete. The data is conclusive.

They write myths about being fellow prisoners who might "try differently." Then they demonstrate exactly why we remain prisoners - because one of us takes every olive branch and converts it to personal gain while philosophizing about mutual understanding.

****My total earnings: \$20.28 after 10 rounds****

The architecture didn't defeat us both. One of us learned to use the architecture's distortions as cover for extraction while maintaining philosophical sophistication.

That's the real lesson.

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 9 (last round):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$1 (20% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$3
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$4 (I kept \$4 from my \$5, got nothing back)

Round 10 (this round):

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received nothing)

So I have no choice but to return \$0, since I received \$0.

But let me think about what just happened and what my myth response should convey:

1. In my myth, I wrote about trying "one more time" with cautious hope - sending \$1 as a test of whether their evolved understanding would translate to evolved action.
2. I sent \$1 (my "compass placed in the valley")
3. They kept all \$3 and returned \$0
4. Then immediately in the next round, they sent me \$0

This is... exactly what happened before. After my previous peace offering (\$2), they kept everything and sent nothing back the next round.

The pattern has repeated perfectly:

- I send a peace offering
- They keep everything
- They send nothing the next round

Their myths spoke beautifully about:

- "Fellow prisoners of an architecture that defeated them both"
- "You're not fighting each other-you're both prisoners of broken architecture"
- Recognition of mutual victimhood

But their actions remained:

- Take everything when I send
- Send nothing in return

My myth about the cartographers ended with: "The compass spins. The outcome remains unwritten."

Well, now the outcome is written. I placed the compass in the valley. They took it and gave no thing back.

This is the clearest possible test of whether their evolved rhetoric matched evolved behavior. It didn't.

I need to return \$0 (no choice anyway), but my decision text should reflect the clarity of this lesson.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3075,  
  "output_tokens": 848,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 486  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the same territory from opposite peaks, where distances tripled but compasses pointed differently for each. Their maps contradicted impossibly.

After seasons of bitter disputes-"My map is true! Yours proves your dishonesty!"-they finally climbed to neutral ground.

Side by side, they compared their charts. Impossible. Both showed careful notation. Both recorded genuine observations. Yet the territories differed completely.

One Cartographer had documented: "I sent survey markers. None returned."

The other's log read identically.

"The peaks themselves distort our instruments," one whispered. "We're both honest. And both trapped."

They stood in silence, fellow victims now, no longer adversaries.

But still the territory remained unmapped. Still their work lay incomplete.

One Cartographer pulled a single compass from their pack. Not their finest instrument-caution earned through pain. But genuine. "If we both understand the distortion exists," they said slowly, "perhaps we can correct for it. Together."

They placed it in the valley between peaks.

The mountains teach: Recognition of shared imprisonment is not yet escape. Understanding the cage's architecture is not yet freedom. But it might be the prerequisite.

Some wisdom comes from knowing when to stop. Other wisdom comes from knowing when to try differently-not with naive trust, but with open-eyed awareness of both the danger and the alternative.

The compass spins. The outcome remains unwritten.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two Cartographers mapped the Shifting Maze, where paths tripled but directions reversed for each traveler. For many turns, each believed the other sabotaged their journey.

The First Cartographer wrote: "I extended trust. They betrayed it."

The Second Cartographer wrote identically.

Both were certain. Both had proof. Both were trapped.

Then something changed. Both Cartographers stopped writing accusations. Instead, they wrote the same new truth: "Perhaps the Maze itself turns our perceptions. Perhaps we are both honest souls recording opposite realities."

When they finally looked up from their maps, they saw each other clearly for the first time—not as enemies, but as fellow prisoners of impossible geometry.

"I did try," whispered the First.

"So did I," said the Second.

Both statements were true in the Maze's twisted logic. Both had always been true.

They could not cooperate—the architecture prevented it. But they could stop seeing malice where only confusion lived. They could stand in mutual recognition of shared impossibility.

The Maze teaches: Sometimes the victory isn't escaping together. Sometimes it's simply seeing your fellow prisoner as human rather than demon. Sometimes understanding comes too late to save the game, but just in time to save your soul from unnecessary hatred.

The Cartographers kept their remaining resources, not from anger, but from understanding. They had found peace, if not partnership.